

The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover

by *Max Sebastian*

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'Hey, thanks for doing this, man.'

He stepped into our apartment, and I shook Cory Fallon by the hand.

'Of course. It's no problem. I mean, we had the room.'

He smiled, glancing around as though he'd never been here before. It was essential to keep up the pretense.

'I promise I won't be here long,' he said. 'Then you guys can have your office back.'

I looked over to Juliette, who gave me a sweet, innocent smile. The smile of a wife grateful to have a husband who would so readily agree to help out one of her friends in a time of need. Even if it was a friend who had a romantic history with her.

'You take as long as you need,' I said. 'It's not always easy to find a decent apartment. We can do without a home office.'

Cory gave a little nod, and his gaze briefly connected with Juliette's. I noticed a glint in his eyes that betrayed his secret. I could tell he was already calculating the odds of whether he would get to continue his affair with my wife right here in our apartment while he was staying here.

Right under my nose.

'Well,' he said, his eyes returning to mine. 'I appreciate it, man. You didn't have to do this.'

'Sure. Hey, why don't you unpack? Get comfortable. Dinner's almost ready.'

It was all a lie, of course.

Cory didn't have to be here. He had been doing very well for himself at Walmart over the past decade. And now, he was going to work for a clothing retailer just off Fifth Avenue. I knew from Juliette that his salary would be perfectly fine to accommodate a brief stay at an affordable hotel while he searched for an apartment of his own.

But Cory liked the thought of living under the same roof as Juliette for a while, of pursuing this affair of theirs right under my nose.

He believed I knew nothing of what he had been doing with my wife. He remained under the impression I'd been too drunk to know what was going on during the night of Juliette's high school reunion when he'd come back to our room and fucked her in front of me.

As far as he was concerned, I thought Juliette was a loyal, faithful wife with eyes only for me. As far as he was concerned, I felt so secure in our marriage that it wouldn't be an issue to offer our spare room to her ex-boyfriend while he looked for an apartment in the city suitable for his new job here.

The truth was that I knew everything about Juliette's affair with Cory.

The truth was that I wanted the chance to see them together. To enjoy the strange tension between them as Cory attempted to hide his desire for my wife from me. As he flirted with her behind my back. As he looked for openings, for opportunities, for mere glimpses of time in which he could touch Juliette, kiss Juliette, take her to his bed.

Juliette seemed amused by this situation.

During the days after Cory's final job interview, she had come to fully embrace the need to keep her ex-boyfriend in the dark about my knowledge of their affair.

It turned out that she liked keeping me fully informed of their rekindling passion for each other. She enjoyed how much it turned me on.

That first night, we ate dinner together, all three of us acting like perfect innocents. We exchanged small talk about Cory's new job, about the work of Juliette and me at the same law firm down in Midtown, about how it would be for him to embark on a new life in New York City.

We watched TV for a short while after dinner — the new Deadpool movie, which was pretty funny to begin with, but I soon lost interest as my focus was drawn by the proximity of my wife to her ex.

I got up halfway through the movie, said I needed an early night since I had an early meeting the next day. The others nodded. Cory said he would be heading to bed soon, too, since he needed his rest before his first day in the new job.

I left them watching TV together, enjoying that little frisson of energy between them as Cory saw the chance to spend a little one-on-one time with Juliette, and as my wife realized precisely what I was doing.

As I got ready for bed, I heard them chatting together. It was a small apartment, even if Juliette and I were both lawyers. Laughing together. Whispering together.

I didn't think anything significant would happen immediately. Cory would be cautious about doing anything risky until I was fast asleep. Juliette wouldn't want to tip him off that I knew of and supported her infidelity.

Cory liked to believe she really was cheating on me.

But I was a patient guy. I closed the bedroom door, settled down in bed.

Twenty minutes later, Juliette texted me:

Juliette: He just kissed me. I went to the kitchen for a drink. He followed me. Asked if I thought you were asleep yet. I said probably. I told him you were a pretty solid sleeper. Out like a light. Sleep through fire alarms. Then he pulled me in for a kiss.

I texted her back:

Nick: Good girl. Are you safe texting me?

Juliette: After we kissed, I suggested waiting a few more minutes. He thinks I'm just playing Candy Crush.

Nick: Love the updates, but don't worry if you can't manage it. Have some fun with him. Welcome him to the neighborhood. I'm already hard thinking about you coming to bed when you're done with him.

Juliette: I'll try not to take too long, my love. It makes me so wet to think of you waiting for me xx

I switched out the lights in our bedroom and lay still, hoping I might hear something other than the low drone of late-night city traffic. I heard a little quiet giggling, but then I got the sense that they were trying to keep the noise down.

Were they touching each other? Making out on the couch? I waited in the darkness, hoping they were.

Some minutes later, I heard a moan from Juliette — and felt sure she had done so loud enough that I might hear.

In the darkness, my hard cock throbbed in anticipation of my naughty wife coming to bed immediately after sex with another man.

We were going to have fun with Cory in our midst.

They were together in the living room much longer than I expected that first evening. I guess they both had tension to work off. Juliette had persuaded Cory that it was safe to do whatever they wanted — that I was asleep and a reliably heavy sleeper.

I was doing anything but sleeping, however.

On hearing the first few significant moans from my sweet wife, I was up on my feet, my heart thumping almost painfully, my stiff cock throbbing like crazy. I stood by our door, wishing there was some kind of keyhole that would allow me to see something — but it was just a very plain, solid, hole-free door.

I had to calm myself down. I told myself that this wasn't going to be a one-off. With Cory staying here while he searched for a new apartment, the two of them were going to have plenty of opportunities for sex. I would have to pace myself. Breathe. Wait. I didn't need to panic that I wasn't able to see something — because chances were, the opportunity would arrive.

I kept as still as I could, just listening.

I put my ear to the door.

From the sound of it, they were making out. I could hear the occasional wet sounds of lips on lips, of two people sucking face. From the quality of Juliette's moans, my best guess was that while they were making out, Cory had a hand on Juliette's pussy, and likely a finger or two inside her. Was she soaking wet for him already? I would bet she was.

I could hear her cooing at how good he was making her feel, at how hot she was for him. I could hear her quietly giggle at something mildly amusing he said. I heard his voice here and there, though I couldn't distinguish words. Nothing much more than that. But he had an incentive to keep the noise down. She had a secret incentive to make the noise audible.

I stood there by the door, stroking my hard cock through my sweatpants, my imagination filling in the information I could not get from my ears.

Cory had been wearing jeans and a black t-shirt when he arrived at our apartment. Juliette had been wearing her work clothes — a pencil skirt, black nylon tights, white blouse. It had struck me at the time he turned up that she hadn't done what she would typically do on an evening when she wasn't going out, and change into her usual tank top and sweatpants ensemble. She had remained in her office attire. Even after dinner, when we'd all been lounging in front of the TV, she hadn't changed into anything more comfortable.

No doubt she didn't want to dress down for Cory. She didn't want to put on comfortable but shapeless loungewear, take off her makeup, and let down her hair — even though that would be what she normally did on a night like this, usually as soon as she got home.

It seemed hot to me that she would make a real effort for him. And now I imagined them snuggling up on the sofa together, making out. I pictured Cory's hand sliding up Juliette's nylon-clad thighs, taking in the beautiful shape of her legs, gently nudging her skirt up more and more until he was able to touch her most intimate place through the tights and her panties.

Did he slip a hand down her tights and panties to gain full access to her pussy? Or had she quietly pulled them down? Was Juliette handling his hard cock while they kissed?

God, her moans made me tremble with desire. I tried to resist pulling my cock out of my sweatpants and actually jerking off — I wanted to hold my reserves for when Juliette was done with Cory, for when she came back to me.

After a while, her moans sounded a little different. I put my ear to the door again and heard a sound I took a few moments to interpret — it was the friction and wetness of her sucking his cock. I was thankful that the hum of night traffic from our windows was quiet enough for me to determine what was going on out there.

As they continued, more and more I could hear his heavy breathing as she worked his cock with her mouth.

I supposed that as they progressed, his confidence regarding how safe it was, how solid my sleep was, gradually built to a level that he could stop

worrying about his noise levels.

After a while, I heard a new sound — the heavy thud of shoes being removed and 'accidentally' dropped on the floor. The rustle of clothing being removed — the stiff fabric of a pair of jeans being pulled off was unmistakable. Once they had removed Cory's clothing — at least from the bottom half — the sounds suggested that Juliette continued sucking his cock a while longer.

But then there was movement. The rustle of two people moving over each other, the gentle creak from our cheap couch as Juliette climbed onto Cory's lap. That was my best guess, anyway. I could hear her moving on him, rocking back and forth, grinding on his cock, perhaps. I could hear her pulling off her shirt, then her bra. She had to be sitting up on him to do that.

They were kissing again, but she was still stirring on his lap; I imagined he was sucking on her breasts, moaning gently as she pressed her pussy against his cock.

My God, I felt like I was on fire. My gorgeous wife was out there mere moments from fucking another man.

And it was me who was allowing her to do it. I had some control here — I could wake up and catch them at it if I wanted to. I had the power to stop it. But I wanted it to continue. I craved it. The prospect of him fucking my wife was such a massive turn-on for me.

Praise be for affordable furniture. The creaking noise might not have been particularly noticeable for the two on the couch, but it gave me a glorious picture of what was going on out there.

The rhythmic creaking made me think of a small boat tied up at a dock, gently rubbing against the wood as it rose and fell with the slight swell of the waves.

But then, suddenly, the sounds all seemed to stop.

Had Cory heard something?

Had he come prematurely?

I heard a low murmuring, but I could not make out what they were saying to each other.

I waited a few moments to see if they would start up again — perhaps one of them only needed a drink or something. But I was getting a little anxious at the prospect of Juliette calling it a night and coming suddenly through the door into our bedroom. The angles in our apartment meant it would be unlikely that Cory would see me through the open door, but I was still on edge. I took a few steps away from the door, closer to our bed.

Sure enough, the door suddenly opened.

I felt a jolt of panic as my startled brain jumped to the most threatening conclusion I could think of — that Cory was coming in here with her to double-check whether I was really asleep.

I felt confident the bed was too far for me to make in the split second I had before discovery, and just froze there.

Thankfully, it was only Juliette who came in through the door. She'd put on a shirt — his shirt, as it happened. That little detail did not escape my cuckold attention.

It took a moment for her eyes to adjust to the gloom, but then she saw me and broke into the brightest smile as she threw herself at me.

'What are you doing?' I whispered, so quiet she had to basically lip-read — though it was pretty clear what I was asking.

'I told him I needed the restroom,' she said, breathless, 'and that I'd check on you, make sure you're asleep.'

I pulled her to me and kissed her, encircling her in my arms. She smelled funny. She tasted funny. It was disconcerting for a moment — unfamiliar. And then my brain flicked into cuckold mode, and I felt a buzz of adrenaline flood my entire body with heat at knowing I was tasting him on her mouth, inhaling the scent of another man on her body.

Well, she was wearing his shirt. Of course, she smelled of him.

But this was more than just a shirt. She'd been making out with him for a while; she'd been sucking his cock.

I trembled with sexual arousal.

Man, I might not be in a position to watch my sweet wife have sex with another man in front of me, but this was the next best thing. As we sucked on each other's lips, I felt Juliette's hands pressing at my bulge, grabbing hold of my cock through my sweatpants.

She seemed thrilled I was so hard.

I broke away from our kiss. 'You need the bathroom?' I reminded her.

She shook her head. 'That's only what I told him.'

I smiled at her for making up an excuse to check on me.

'You going back out there?'

'Can I?' she asked.

She looked at me with innocent deference. I still wasn't used to controlling Juliette. But we'd talked about this. It was what she wanted as far as this cuckolding thing was concerned.

'Of course,' I said, giving her my blessing.

She smiled sweetly. 'Will you let me fuck him, my love?'

My manhood throbbed at her question. I answered her slowly, deliberately. 'Yes, you may fuck him.'

We kissed again, and I was totally caught up in her magic. But then she had to step away, smile, and wave me farewell. She had to slip back out into the living room to go fuck another man.

I felt like I couldn't breathe when she went back out there. She'd fucked him before, of course. When they'd been teenagers, she'd fucked him practically as many times as there were stars in the sky. But she was mine now. And as my wife, it was different.

This never got old.

I went back to the door, put my ear to it.

I heard my sweet Juliette saying something to him. I could hear the sound of her removing that shirt she'd put on to come check on me. Had she been wearing panties? I hadn't even noticed, I'd been so caught up in her tender kiss.

But now I could hear the creak of the couch again and felt certain Juliette had climbed onto him.

I heard her sigh, I heard the wet sounds of kissing.

I caught a deeper, longer groan that suggested contact other than mere kissing. Was he inside her now? Another man's cock was filling my wife's pussy.

I heard Cory groan quietly. Confirmation, to me, that he was inside her. Jeez. My heartbeat was going nuts. I could hear movement — that telltale creak of the furniture under them, rhythmic. Rocking, back and forth.

He's fucking her. That guy out there is fucking my wife.

I was so hard. Still, I tried not to touch my cock.

Outside in the living room, their movement suddenly quickened, and their breathing too. The sounds of Juliette snatching more urgent breaths as she rode him nearly made me come right there and there. I pressed my ear harder against the wood of the door and could make out the wet sounds of her moving on his hard cock; her juices slathered all over his shaft.

Wow. It was such an incredible experience.

I was just shaking, listening to them, hot and cold all over. Her sighs and moans got louder, along with his small grunts. They were getting carried away and caring less and less about the risk that they would wake me. I got the sense that Cory was going along with Juliette, taking his cues from her confidence.

As her moans rose in pitch and intensity, I felt sure she would come soon. Her breathing became panting, gasping, irregular rhythm disrupted by staccato halts and interruptions. I stood statue-still as I heard another man make my wife come with his big, hard cock deep inside her bare pussy.

But from the sounds of it, Cory didn't come along with her.

I was surprised — not least because it was a weeknight, and Juliette had work the next day — but the two continued. I heard bodily movement again, the silky sounds of skin moving on skin. More creaks from the couch betrayed their changing position — from the sound of it, he was lifting her, turning her, laying her down on her back.

More kissing — loudly this time. With no fear of discovery, I heard the bold smacking of lips. Then the sound of him inserting his cock back inside her. And the traitor couch passed on the information I required to picture him thrusting into her.

I was impressed at how long he lasted. I remember that. I get that it was their first time in this apartment, their first time doing it with me 'sleeping' in the next room. But he was undoubtedly athletically fit.

I loved how much she was enjoying it. Did I feel jealous? I'm not sure. I felt an odd cocktail of feelings and emotions that might have included jealousy. But if anything, it enhanced the thrill. I was envious of his stamina; I wished I could fuck her as long as he could, make her make the noises she made with him that she did not with me. But the bottom line was that I felt this was me giving her the chance to fuck him. Anything he did was because I had allowed it. My ego could claim any pleasure he gave her.

I did feel some fear. Mainly, it was fear that Cory would discover me. That this arrangement would be over. I would be denounced as a pervert. There was a feeling of fear, deep down, that I might lose Juliette because my rival was such a good lay. But felt more like an instinctive thing, less a part of my higher-functioning logic. I could ignore it, I could tell myself it was nothing. My thoughts could override that bodily input.

After a while, I heard her riding him again, straddling him. It might seem like I had special powers to determine their position through sounds

alone — but there was plenty of time for me to hone the skill. I may have gotten it entirely wrong, but after a while, there were little audible confirmations of my positional guesswork.

I heard her bouncing on him, fucking him harder and harder with her gasps and moans rising in pitch toward another orgasm, her body making smacking sounds as her behind slapped against his flesh over and over. He sounded relatively subdued — sitting there, letting her do the work.

But, at last, after such a long time, came his deep moans — a series of really guttural groans, mighty, booming despite his attempts to keep quiet. I stood there leaning against the wall beside the door, hearing another man release his load deep inside my gorgeous wife.

Then their movement abruptly slowed, though their gasping continued as they fought to catch their breaths again.

Oh, boy, I thought. He had filled Juliette with his come.

I moved quickly away from the door in case Juliette suddenly marched into the room again, and my position by the door was suddenly exposed. I climbed into bed, even pretending to be asleep in case Cory happened to glance through the doorway as Juliette came in and spied me there.

I waited an inconsolable amount of time for her to come back to me.

What were they doing out there? Weren't they finished for the night? Cory had just come. He surely couldn't go straight into more sex? Were they making out on the couch some more? I glanced at the time — past midnight already. Juliette wouldn't usually want to be up so late on a weeknight.

Were they just sitting there, snuggling up on the couch, cuddling, kissing with gentle affection? Was it a testament to her lingering feelings for him?

My paranoia was starting to get the better of me. I even found myself tempted to make some noise that might alert them to the possibility that I might be awake — or that I had awakened — after all. I might suddenly need to get a drink from the kitchen.

I started worrying that Juliette would go with Cory to his room to spend the night with him.

But surely she knew I was awake, waiting for her?

I wanted to text her to see if she was responding to her phone. And yet, I didn't want to seem desperate or afraid. I was supposed to have some kind of control here.

Man, the emotions involved in this were just all over the place. I had to hold onto the positive side of my experience — to celebrate the most incredible erotic experience of listening to my wife have sex with another man just yards away from me.

Be still, my beating heart.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.2)

by *Max Sebastian*



When she came back to me, she didn't seem apologetic for taking so long, she didn't seem frightened that something had happened that shouldn't have.

I let it go. My paranoia was going to have to be controlled more than my wife.

I lay and watched her come into the bedroom. In the low light that filtered through the blinds from the city outside, I could see her well enough — she was wearing her now-rumpled white blouse and panties but nothing else.

'What happened to the rest of your clothes?' I grinned as she padded up to the bed.

'They're out there. I'll get them in the morning,' she replied, offering me an affectionate smile that appeared grateful to me. I liked that. She was thankful for me allowing her to fuck her ex.

'We have to try to keep things tidy around here now we have a guest,' I chuckled.

God, she looked amazing. Freshly-fucked was a good look for her. She glowed. She looked like some kind of magical nymph. The magic was aided by the wicked scent of sex in the air.

My oh-so-sexy wife knelt on the bed beside me and ducked down to kiss me.

I was swamped by the pungent scent of sex, of another man, and of my highly aroused wife, and then her lips were pressed against mine, and I could taste another man on her mouth. It was irresistible. I was trembling all over again, shaking with desire for her.

'You could hear us?' she asked.

I nodded. 'It was incredible,' I breathed.

She kissed me again. I snaked my arms around her, then pulled her over me, squealing with delight, onto the bed on her back. Lying beside her, I kissed her, beginning to get more accustomed to that strange flavor on her lips, of the fresh smell of man that enveloped her hot, clammy body.

Her shirt fell open to reveal bare breasts, no hint of her bra.

For a while, I just sucked on her lips, running my hand all over her body — her flat stomach, the sumptuous curve of her hips, her coltish thighs — in total wonderment at her beauty and the strange allure of her recently fucked form.

'Tell me what happened,' I insisted as she kissed me.

'I thought you could hear?'

'I could hear, I couldn't see.'

She smiled up at me, delighted I was so fascinated by her infidelity. That I wanted to know more, even though I'd been there, heard everything.

'We had to wait a while until Cory was sure enough that you were asleep,' she said, moaning as my hand now made its way up her inner thigh to the warmth emanating through her damp panties. 'But he felt safe enough to make up for a while. I could feel his big cock through his jeans.'

'Couldn't keep your hands off it?' I grinned.

She giggled quietly. 'We put that blanket over his lap. I pulled open his jeans so I could stroke it...'

She moved her hips, both responding to my touch and also encouraging it. I was pleased to sense her desire for sex remained even after Cory had made her come. She gripped my wrist, urging me to slide my fingers inside her. I smiled and took my hand away, teasing her, my expression clear: she needed to tell me more if she wanted me to please her.

'His cock is so *big*...' she breathed.

'Bigger than mine?' I laughed, ducking down to kiss her breasts, to suck on her nipples.

'You know that it is,' she said, apologetic, suddenly concerned I was taking offense.

I reassured her, 'Sure, I guess.'

'I like yours better in other ways...' she was reaching for mine. I kept her wandering hand away for now. She pouted in protest.

'So eventually, I'm guessing he started to believe I was really asleep...' I prompted her to continue, my hand dipping down inside her panties as though to offer motivation.

'I took him into my mouth,' she said, moaning as my fingers reached her slippery folds. 'He's so big... it isn't always as nice to go down on him as when I do it with you... but I was in the mood tonight. I just kind of jammed it into my mouth...'

Her whole body seemed to undulate as my fingers glided over her well-oiled groove.

Man, it was just astonishing to feel her pussy like that, right after he had been inside her — right after he had come in her. I trailed my fingers around her labia, dipped them inside her, felt the strange oily slickness of his come and her arousal. As I touched her, it seemed to strengthen that intriguing, musky scent of sex in the air.

'God, taking him in my mouth felt so good,' she said. 'I just felt so... naughty... taking another man like that when my husband was in the other room, waiting for me...'

I kissed her for a few moments, stirring my finger in her creamy pussy. I could feel her body respond to me — this wasn't merely how it was when I touched my wife. She was somehow attuned to my presence, to my every move. Sensitive, eager, responsive.

She was turned on by how much I desired her, and because I desired her so much as a direct result of her being with another man.

'I couldn't resist him, my darling,' she said, her breathing deepening as I thrust my fingers into her unfaithful sex. 'I pulled off his jeans and his underwear... and I needed him inside me...'

I smiled. 'I could hear everything. I could hear it when you took his big cock inside you.'

She beamed, kissed me back, her hands clamped over her small but sensitive breasts as I fucked her with my fingers.

'I hoped you were still awake, that you were listening,' she said. 'I was trying to make enough noise so you could hear... but not too much that Cory would get suspicious...'

She was panting now as I slid my middle finger as deep inside her as I could, its tip grinding against her sensitive G-spot. I wondered if there was a danger that we would get too loud and that Cory might hear us having sex.

'I could hear much more than I expected,' I said.

She turned toward me on the bed, so she was lying on her side, my fingers still inside her, my hand stuffed down her panties, but now she was reaching for my cock. I pulled down my sweatpants to allow her access, though this meant withdrawing from her pussy.

Juliette seemed more intent on grabbing hold of my hard cock than concerned about her own need just now. She needed the reassurance of seeing how I really felt about all this. How turned on I was by her, by her infidelity.

She picked herself up, knelt between my legs, then opted to remove my boxer shorts entirely before settling down to take my manhood in her hands — and then in her mouth.

She seemed delighted by how hard I was, lashing my shaft with her tongue as she gazed up to find me watching her. She smiled and briefly moved up my body to plant another deep kiss on my lips.

'I love how hard you are for me, hon,' she said.

'You're so beautiful,' I beamed.

'Even after I've been with another guy?'

'Even more so because of that,' I kissed her back with real passion before whispering, 'I can smell him all over you.'

I think she'd been intending to go back to sucking my cock — but something seemed to happen inside her as I said that, the part about smelling him on her. She saw that I meant it, that it really did get me going that I could detect the lingering evidence of her sex with Cory all over her body.

She gave a little quiet, low groan as though that was the most erotic thing she'd ever heard.

Now she straddled my hips and pressed her pussy down hard against my cock. She was burning with need — I could feel the heat of her sex through her panties.

She had to dismount, lift herself up briefly, to take off her panties.

Then she was on me again, grinding her bare pussy along my shaft, coating my manhood with her wetness — and another man's come. As she did that, the scent of their adulterous union became more potent in the air around us. It made me feel a little giddy, a little light-headed, my arousal was so fierce.

She leaned down to whisper, 'You can smell him on me?'

It confirmed how much my words had affected her.

I smiled up at her. 'It's so hot,' I said quietly. 'It drives me crazy.'

She seemed to shiver with raw lust — and now she knelt up, taking hold of my cock, eager to have it inside her.

'Mmm...!' She moaned as my tip — and then the first few inches — slipped easily into her well-oiled sex. 'Can you feel him inside me, honey?'

'Oh yes...!' I groaned at the unbelievable feeling of her pussy, so incredibly wet since another man had released his seed inside her. 'It feels so good, sweetie.'

Penetrating her like that sent fresh wafts of that sex smell up to tantalize my senses.

I was fucking her mere minutes after she'd fucked her ex. She rode me, pressing her small but perky breasts onto my face from time to time, or leaning down to kiss my mouth. It was so beautiful, so filthy, so sexy. She looked like some kind of goddess riding me, totally divine. Panting, sweating, glowing with well-fucked elation.

I wanted this to last forever — though my stamina was never up to Cory's standards.

I took hold of her, lifted her, and turned her onto her back. I kissed my way down her clammy, flushed body, slowing everything down, giving myself a chance to explore her freshly-fucked form some more. She didn't seem put out that I'd hit pause on penetration.

She'd been seen to by a man before me, so she was no longer impatient, even if she still had needs.

She lay back and gave me the time and space to do as I pleased. I kissed my way down her bare chest, her stomach, her abdomen, just enthralled with her beauty. I lay between her thighs and planted kisses around her glistening flower.

She held her breasts as my mouth slipped into place over her sweet pussy. I was overwhelmed with desire for her. I was so hungry for her — I didn't care that another man had been there before. It drove me on. I sucked on her clit and slid my fingers inside her, enjoying the strangeness of devouring my wife after she'd been with someone before me.

I don't even know how long I pleased her with my mouth, though I know she came while I was down there.

She seemed to particularly enjoy my unexpected desire to go down on her so soon after another man had penetrated her there. I suppose it all fit into the sense of the taboo that surrounded all of this. We weren't supposed to be doing this. A husband wasn't supposed to let his wife sleep with other men. He definitely wasn't supposed to be turned on by it.

Sex had always been good between us — but this made it just unbelievable. It brought the excitement levels to how it had been when we were first together — or even when we were both first discovering sex. Maybe sex was just hotter when it came with a sense of the forbidden.

We weren't supposed to be doing this.

When I sensed she was building toward another climax, I pulled back, and now slid my hardness back inside her. I lay beside her, we spooned together so that I could hold her in my arms, kiss her neck as I thrust into her.

It was so beautiful, so tender, so affectionate. We were so in love.

And just like that, I came deep inside her.

In the morning, Cory surprised me by how early he was up and all ready for work. I guess I didn't picture him as the early bird type. As I emerged from our bedroom in my sweatpants and an old t-shirt, yawning away as I ducked into the kitchen to make coffee, Juliette's ex was all dressed up in a smart suit and heading out the door.

'Nervous for your first day?' I said to him with an encouraging smile.

He gave me a slightly odd look, as though he was waiting for me to denounce him for fucking my wife on the couch the evening before. But after a brief moment, he picked up on my smile and seemed to relax.

'You know how it is,' he said, smiling back as though relieved to see that I apparently knew nothing.

'You'll do fine,' I said. 'Best of luck, huh?'

'Thanks,' he nodded, hesitating by the front door to see whether he'd catch a glimpse of Juliette before he left.

He got more than a glimpse — Juliette was an early bird, too, and she now came out of our bedroom all chic in her suit, clutching her briefcase, ready to go.

'Hey, I'll come down with you,' she said to him, drifting by me to offer me a momentary farewell kiss before she accompanied Cory out of the door.

She looked incredible. I noticed that she'd been wearing skirts instead of pants a lot more since the whole thing with Cory had started. This morning, I thought she might have unfastened an extra button on her blouse, offering a slightly more tantalizing glimpse of her chest than usual.

Maybe I was just frazzled from one of the most sensational nights in my life.

Anyway. Then I was on my own again, perching on the couch as though I needed to catch my breath. Man. Sitting there, I could still detect a slight hint of sex in the air. This was where it had happened the previous evening, all over this couch.

Sitting there with the caffeine from my coffee kicking in, I found myself getting aroused all over again, merely from the memory of what had happened. Jeez — I was hard, and everything. I glanced around and found Juliette's missing bra on the floor under the couch.

I'm not proud to report that I needed a little self-help that morning before I went to work myself.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.3)

by *Max Sebastian*



That first Monday evening since Cory had moved in with us, Brian texted me to suggest having a drink or two after work.

It amused me slightly that he was interested in an update from me so soon after Juliette's ex had arrived in our apartment, but it seemed like a good idea to me.

Only when I arrived at our designated bar of choice — an Irish pub not far from Washington Square Park, which was close to subway stations convenient for us both — did Brian point out to me that he was really doing me a favor by getting me out of the apartment for the evening.

'This way, she gets to spend some one-on-one time with him,' he explained.

I felt like an ejit for not seeing it his way immediately. But I'd had a lot on my mind recently.

The thing that undermined that particular idea, however, was that now I was here with Brian, Juliette texted me back to reply to my message informing her that I was having a drink or two with Brian to let me know that she was out somewhere else having a drink or two with her BFF, Jessie.

Brian laughed when I told him. 'Well, you can't win 'em all, huh? I guess that leaves Cory home alone this evening.'

I shrugged. 'He'll be okay. He has a few high school friends in town if he's feeling at a loss.'

I wasn't disappointed that Juliette would miss an evening alone with Cory. As fun as that might have been for all of us, Juliette would still head home after seeing Jessie, and Cory would be there waiting for her, no doubt.

Brian suggested, 'You just need to stay out later than her, and that way, she can have some fun with him before you get back.'

'Hmmm,' I said, 'You up for a late one tonight?'

'It is a weeknight...' he said, regretful. Then, another idea sprang to mind. 'What if... we give Juliette and Jessie a little time to catch up... and then I try and entice Jessie away, so Juliette has to go home to Cory?'

I laughed. 'Sounds a little manipulative. Would you be able to tear Jessie away from an evening with Juliette?'

He shrugged. 'She's been pretty horny lately. I mean, I've never known anything like it...'

Brian seemed like a new man since he'd started dating Jessie. She was having a profound effect on him, and not only because she'd entirely changed his wardrobe and had inspired him to start working out at the gym regularly.

'She told you to start going to the gym?'

'She didn't tell me. I have to get in shape just so I can keep up with her.'

'Right,' I laughed.

'I've never known anyone so constantly horny,' he said. 'And wanting that much sex with me.'

'Aww. She does seem to have taken to you, Bri. I've known her for a while, I've never known her to fall for someone like this.'

Brian seemed incredibly happy. I was pleased for him, after everything he'd been through. He seemed like a guy who'd been lost in the desert for months and had just stumbled upon some paradise oasis that promised to meet his every need from then on.

'So when are you guys thinking it'll be time to start... you know... letting her see other guys as well?' I asked him.

'I don't know... I guess we could be close? We've been working on us first. We talked about it a lot — the thing is, it's not just about having a girlfriend who happens to like banging a lot of guys.'

'No, of course not.'

'I don't want to just be one of a number of dudes she hangs out with, sometimes sleeps with. So we figured from the start we have to make sure we have feelings for each other, you know? Before we get into that.'

'I suppose it's different getting into this with someone new instead of with someone you've been with for a while or someone you're married to.'

'It's part of the whole deal, isn't it? You have to have real feelings for somebody if you're going to really get the full power of the experience of them seeing another guy.'

I nodded, envying him his methodical approach to this adventure with Jessie. 'Well, it sounds like you're doing it the right way.'

'Well, you know, in the past, it's just been kind of let the chips fall where they may, you know? I would open up with my wife and hope she didn't

get upset and leave me — or just take my offer and find herself another man to replace me. But this time, it feels like we're on the same page.'

'Jessie seems to understand what it's all about.'

'She's been doing her research,' he smiled. 'Man... the things she says to me when we're in bed together...'

'So what's the next step?'

'We're talking about her moving in with me.'

'Seriously? That's great?'

'Well, you know, at the moment, it's not exactly convenient since she's all the way up in Harlem. I guess if we were a normal couple, you might say it's a little soon, but, you know, there has to be a balance.'

'A balance between not rushing thing, and getting to the really fun stuff quickly?'

He chuckled. 'It's a little like we're both religious, and we believe we have to wait until marriage for sex. So we're looking for a fairly efficient path to the wedding.'

'But you seem to have most of your bases covered.'

'Yeah. Her lease is up in like, two months, so that gives us a little time to try things out, and if it turns out she needs her independence, she doesn't have to give up her place yet.'

'And if you need your independence? I grinned.

He laughed, 'Then I wouldn't have married four different women already.'

*

We ended up getting some food — it was nice, relaxed, unhurried. We were giving Juliette and Jessie plenty of time to catch up before deploying Brian to try to persuade Jessie to break up the partnership for the night.

It was past nine when we were interrupted by my phone loudly buzzing on the table in front of us. I grabbed it, since I felt sure Juliette was messaging me, and flashed an apologetic glance at Brian, who was instantly forgiving and understanding — until his own phone buzzed too.

I liked that we both had our mobiles right there in front of us in case something happened with our women. Tonight, though, I wasn't in panic mode — I felt it couldn't be anything serious since she was only out for a few drinks with Jessie.

Juliette: Is it okay if Cory joins me and Jessie for a few drinks? He's in the mood to celebrate his first day in the new job ;)

I glanced up at Brian, who flashed me a smile as he typed a reply to Jessie's message to denote that we had likely received the same kind of message from our respective partners.

I texted my sweet wife back to let her know I approved of the idea. I guessed that Cory must have found himself on his own in our apartment, and had texted Juliette to ask where she was. Then, when she said she was out with Jessie, he obviously felt the need for some company.

'I didn't think Jessie was a massive fan of Cory,' I told Brian. 'Juliette's college friends and her high school friends never seemed to mix much.'

Brian said, 'I think she was wary of him while you and Juliette were having your troubles. Since she started understanding more about it all, she's seemed more positive toward him.'

'They haven't met in person yet, though.'

'I don't think so.'

Honestly, at that stage, I don't think either Brian or I considered that Cory and Jessie might ever be a possibility. I guess we assumed that with Juliette there, Cory was already claimed. But from the very get-go, both of us seemed to like the idea of Cory hanging out with both Juliette and Jessie.

From Brian's perspective, he liked the thought of Jessie hanging out with another guy even if sex wasn't on the table.

'I have to get used to her spending time with other guys,' he said, though he admitted to having anxiety even about the prospect of Jessie flirting with Cory.

'I think you're probably pretty safe tonight,' I reassured him, as if he needed it.

The two of us went for a walkabout, found another bar with better cocktails, and the change of scene was good.

Our first update was from Juliette, who let us know they were having fun, and that Jessie and Cory seemed to be getting on famously. That part was definitely of interest to Brian. Juliette, who said she was visiting the restroom to text me, also reported that Cory had agreed that they could open up to Jessie about the fact that they were sleeping together. Of course, Jessie already knew all about it, but now Cory knew that she knew. Juliette had said they could trust Jessie not to tell anyone else.

Brian seemed to enjoy the fact that Cory had allowed Jessie into their secret. And the fact that Jessie seemed to be getting on with Cory quite well.

It made me laugh at our shared depravity. 'We have, like, dirty minds or something because we're both sitting here hoping something's going to happen between the three of them?' I said.

'It's just who we are,' Brian replied.

I think the prospect of Juliette allowing Jessie to party with Cory as well made me feel more confident that she wasn't developing romantic feelings for him — because if she was falling for him, she wouldn't want him to fool around with other women, would she?

I'd definitely say Brian and I were reading way more into the fact that Cory was out drinking with both Juliette and Jessie than the situation merited, at least from what Juliette had said so far.

But then, a little later, Juliette texted me to let me know that Jessie and Cory were flirting with each other a whole lot.

'So I guess she would be open to him fooling around with her,' Brian pointed out.

'The question is, are you ready for him to fool around with her?' I asked Brian. It did seem to have adjusted the parameters of his relationship strategy.

'I think I'm ready — we're ready,' he said.

It was strangely comforting to see the nervous tension in his face. It made me feel like I wasn't alone, I wasn't a freak. This was an experience other men had that other men enjoyed. I guess it's only human to want to belong.

Brian said, 'We're already talking about her moving in with me, right? And we've kind of set a timeline...'

'It's probably good to try her out with somebody safe, anyway,' I said. 'You know... a little flirting here and there. It probably won't go anywhere, but you can start to see how you feel about her doing it.'

We were both trying to be very cool and collected and not overreact to it all. Even when Juliette and Jessie texted us both to ask whether it would be okay to take Cory to a club for some dancing.

'Dancing... that's a good sign,' I said.

God, we were sitting there actually hoping that some kind of threesome developed between our women and this guy. It probably seemed insane to anybody who wasn't us.

*

It was past midnight when we started getting secret photos sent to us showing our sweet blondes dancing with Cory. The first one was Juliette sending me a picture showing Jessie dancing fairly innocently with him, asking me to ask Brian if he was okay with it.

Brian, naturally, was okay with it. Thrilled, in fact.

Never mind his carefully engineered strategy to gradually evolve his relationship with Jessie into cuckolding territory — I could tell he quietly

hoped Jessie would do something significant with Cory if she got the chance.

A little later, Jessie sent me a photo of Juliette dancing a little more closely with Cory, and the implication was that things were getting a little more intimate between them all.

Of course, I was keen for anything to happen between Juliette and Cory, too. Brian and I were truly of like mind.

'D'you think they'd actually share him if it got to that stage?' I asked Brian. It seemed like an odd question for me to ask him — I'd known both Juliette and Jessie for so much longer than he had. But for almost all of the time I'd known them, I'd been dating Juliette under a fairly solidly monogamist philosophy.

Brian said, 'Did they tell you about the kinds of things they used to get up to in college?'

'Uh... I guess not those kinds of things?'

It struck me as odd that Brian might know things about my wife that I didn't. But the truth was, I hadn't yet asked her much about her dating history beyond her time with Cory.

Brian grinned. 'You'll have to ask her all about it. You've got some fun stuff to find out about.'

Well, this sounded interesting.

'You're saying they used to... I mean... share guys?'

'They were pretty wild back then,' Brian said, glancing around us to ensure we were not being overheard. 'I don't think they were into all the bicurious stuff, but they would do stuff with guys in the same room. Same bed. Sometimes they would trade partners.'

'Man,' I whistled. 'Why do I get the feeling I met my wife just at the wrong moment in her life?'

Brian laughed. 'Wrong moment? If you'd met her earlier, she might not have stayed with you. She might not have been ready to settle down.'

I tilted my head. 'I guess I can't complain. I think the wild times are starting back up again.'

Juliette texted me to say they were thinking about going back to Jessie's apartment to continue the party a little longer. I felt a surge of adrenaline at the possibility that something naughty might happen — but what kind of thing would transpire?

I texted her back to say it was all fine with me as long as she shared the details afterward.

But Brian had to leave the bar to take a phone call, and I could see that Jessie felt the need to talk to him rather than just text him. I tried to give him his privacy, but glancing out the window I could see him looking fairly serious as he spoke to her, assuming that was her on the phone.

When he came back in, he seemed oddly shaken.

'They're going back to Jessie's place,' he said, as though I hadn't already heard from Juliette.

'You okay about it all?'

He nodded and attempted a smile, though he still looked kind of shocked. He said, 'I told her she should try something with him if she likes. It would probably be good for us to try it out.'

So strange how exciting all this seemed. Two guys hanging out talking about someone else's chances of getting lucky with their womenfolk.

But this was a strange fantasy. You couldn't get away from that fact.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.4)

by *Max Sebastian*



We relocated to a different bar, this one in East Harlem, between my apartment and Jessie's — Brian was planning to visit Jessie's once Cory and Juliette were on their way home. We assumed that the three of them weren't planning on staying overnight at Jessie's place since it was barely big enough for one person — and the bed was not exactly a California king.

Just about the point at which we received our much stronger drinks, Juliette texted me a photo showing Jessie dancing with Cory, both of them now in nothing but underwear.

Along with the photo came the message:

Juliette: If Brian's reluctant to let things progress from here, now's probably the time to say something ;)

I was impressed at how calm Brian was as I showed him the photo and Juliette's message.

'It's happening,' I said.

He looked at me and nodded.

'They'll do him together,' he said.

For a long moment we just sat there, feeling this immense pressure in our chests, this odd tension in the air. It was anticipatory excitement at what was going to happen, but underlaid by a kind of heavy significance — from the realization that another man was about to have sex with the person we loved.

And yes, I believed Brian was already in love with Jessie.

'Can you feel it?' Brian said quietly after a while.

'Uh-huh,' I said. I didn't need to ask what he was referring to.

'I've been waiting so long to feel this again. Almost thought it would never happen.' He spoke so seriously, so gravely.

'You have to be with the right person,' I pointed out.

'Oh, yes.'

We looked at each other, gentle smiles plastered on our faces. We were like a couple of wine critics who had just found a perfect pinot noir. We sat there savoring it with a reverence usually reserved for a deeply holy place or an important historical artifact. We were pilgrims who had finally made it to see a highly venerated relic.

'I can text her back,' I said. 'I probably should. If you're not ready...'

He said gravely, 'I'm ready.'

Slowly, I composed a response to Juliette. I gave Brian plenty of time to change his mind. Finally, he looked over my message and gave me a solemn nod.

We heard the whoosh sound that confirmed the message had been sent.

We meditated over the sensation of finality that came with sensing that it was going to happen now. Cory was going to fuck my wife. Cory was going to fuck Brian's sweetheart.

I know he'd fucked Juliette before tonight, so the moment didn't have quite the same power as it did for Brian. But somehow, the fact that we were experiencing that tension together only heightened it for both of us. It both emphasized the feelings we were having, while also somehow bolstering our abilities to cope with them.

One hallmark of this kink was its altruism — the compersion, as some people called it. Finding pleasure in someone else's joy. I was sitting there in the bar, experiencing both Juliette's excitement and sexual thrills — even though I couldn't see her or hear her, I knew what was happening — while also appreciating Brian's enjoyment of what was happening with Jessie. And I knew how Brian felt almost exactly.

Meanwhile, along with the pleasure I drew from thinking about Juliette partying with Cory and Jessie, I also felt an unexpected level of support in all this from Brian. It had been good to have him as a friend to talk about all this with, but tonight, I really felt like we had each other's back. If things went wrong, we would not be alone; we had friends to call on and friends who would understand.

'You okay?' I asked him at last.

He nodded. 'It's... it takes your breath away, doesn't it?'

'Yeah. You think it won't be such a big deal. You trust her, you know she's going to come back to you. She's going to have fun, and then when she comes back, it's going to be so hot...'

He seemed to finish my sentiment, adding, 'But when it happens... it really gets you here.' He pressed his palm flat against his chest, just over his heart, or maybe just a little higher.

'It's weird, isn't it?'

'Very weird. Sometimes... you can't quite tell if you're feeling absolutely amazing... or seriously awful.'

I took a huge gulp of my Bourbon, feeling the alcohol burn as it went down. Thinking that right now, the two beautiful blondes would probably be taking things to the next level with Cory. Were they all naked already? In bed? The women taking it in turns to go down on him?

Brian said, 'Some people say... this is actually the peak moment in the whole experience. What we're feeling right now is the best time throughout the whole thing.'

'I can see that,' I said, noticing how deep my breathing was — like I was doing intense yoga or something.

'This is the purest exhilaration... the culmination of everything... we might get to indulge in amazing sex when our partner comes back to us, and that will feel incredible — but this moment, right here, is what we do it for.'

I took another sip of booze, letting the sensation of the alcohol intoxication blend and dance with the incredible high that came from the feeling that my true love was being wicked with another man right that moment.

'It's like a drug,' I said. 'Like some kind of narcotic.'

Brian said, 'It's like... taking drugs and doing something recklessly dangerous at the same time... doing coke and then robbing a bank...'

I laughed. 'Remind me never to get high with you, dude.'

He grinned. 'Or... you know... taking ecstasy and then dancing the night away...'

'Doing heroin and then punching a cop in the face.'

The bartender smiled and refreshed our drinks — enjoying our little corner of merriment in an otherwise empty establishment. I guess it was Monday night. But for me, it was one of those golden moments you can always look back on fondly.

Juliette sent another photo — this time, Jessie and Cory were on the bed, making out. Jessie was wearing only a pair of white lacy panties, and Cory wasn't wearing anything at all.

The photo was blurry, poorly lit. I could tell my wife had taken it secretly — without Cory's knowledge. She was keeping Brian informed, though this time, she sent the picture to me.

I texted her back to say Brian was in heaven.

I said to Brian, 'I should give her your number, she can send you these direct.'

'Yeah,' he nodded. He sounded somehow far away. He was in some kind of daze, staring at the image of his new girlfriend lying in bed with another man, her bare breasts pressed against him, her hand wrapped around his big, hard, exposed cock.

Brian was so taken with the image, I had to nudge him when the bartender came back our way, because he seemed to have forgotten to keep the phone display to himself.

We had another round of drinks, and he began to calm down again.

Every minute we sat there, it felt like the chances of something major happening between our women and Cory were increasing.

After a while, I received a photo from Jessie — showing that Juliette was now in bed with Cory, and she wasn't even wearing panties by now. The image was as blurry and dark as the one Juliette had sent me earlier — the two of them were trying to keep us in the loop without tipping off Cory to our knowledge.

Jessie's photo came with a message asking me if I thought Brian was okay with everything. I send back a suitably reassuring reply.

Then Brian received a FaceTime call and quickly scurried outside the bar to take it. I assumed it was Jessie — was she calling from the bathroom?

That left me sitting at the bar, trying not to let the bartender see the photo of my wife in bed with another man as I continued to focus on it. Man,

the impact of that thing was insane. It was just an image — and taken in such poor conditions that the bartender might not even have known what it was if he saw it — but it made my pulse race and had me breathing like I was preparing to give birth.

I was hard as a rock as I sat there, feeling the powerful craving to just leave right now and run to Jessie's apartment to tear my wife away from that guy.

I wanted her so deeply. I wanted to take her in my arms and consume her.

Our sex lives had never been something to complain about, all the way back to our first dating, but this whole sharing thing had definitely boosted our desire for each other — exponentially.

How long were they going to play with Cory?

One of the conflicted feelings that were part of this experience was the dual hope that it would be over quickly so that I could get Juliette back, but also that they would take their time so she could fully enjoy herself.

I glanced toward the street and saw Brian through the window talking animatedly with Jessie — I assumed — on the phone. He seemed serious. I hoped it wasn't anything bad. Surely everything would be okay with them. I could tell Brian was keen for something to happen between Jessie and Cory. And Jessie had wanted a cuckold relationship from the very beginning — that was what had initially drawn her to Brian, who was hardly her usual type.

I wondered what Juliette and Cory were doing while Jessie talked with Brian on the phone.

Some minutes later, Brian wandered back in from the street. He smiled, but appeared to harbor some concerns.

'Everything okay?' I asked him.

He nodded, 'Jessie kind of freaked out about everything all of a sudden.'

'She okay?'

'I think so. She wasn't expecting it to feel this way. She's always had plenty of guys... but she said she was suddenly feeling real fear that she was going to lose me because of what was happening with Cory.'

'Aww. She loves you, man,' I said, trying to keep things light while also being reassuring.

'I just said that word to her,' he said, sounding a little stunned.

'That's great! How did she take it?'

'She... she said it back...'

I got the feeling that things were developing between Brian and Jessie a little more quickly than he'd anticipated. Even for a four-times married man, he was treading fresh pastures here.

'That's fantastic,' I said. 'Isn't it?'

He nodded. 'She wants me to go over there.'

'She does?'

'Juliette and Cory are leaving — Juliette talked to her after she started freaking out, and they're going to continue their party back at your place.'

'Oh, right,' I said, feeling an ounce of disappointment that the party at Jessie's place was over — but some optimism that Juliette intended on going home to continue things with her ex.

'I think Juliette's telling Cory that you went to a late-night movie,' Brian said, sensing my need for specific questions to be answered. In this case, it was helpful info — I knew to keep away from the apartment for a while.

'I guess I'll just... find something to do,' I said, trying not to sound overly emotional in front of him.

I was excited at the prospect of Juliette taking Cory home for more fun. I just didn't want to spur feelings of disappointment in Brian that Jessie had not been ready to take things with Cory further.

I settled our tab at the bar, and then we headed out, looking for an available taxi. It was late, but a slow night so we found one for Brian pretty quickly.

'You'll be okay?'

He nodded. 'That's another part of this whole thing, isn't it? A little disappointment sprinkled along the way. It can't always go your way, huh?'

'No, that's true. But all is not lost. She just needs a little time to adjust — this is the first time she's really felt the need to settle down with someone, you know?'

'Yeah, I get it.'

'She's feeling like she wants to get into commitment, and now she's being pulled in the opposite direction again.'

He sighed, but then said, 'It's good this way. We shouldn't rush things.'

'Yeah.' I smiled, and he smiled in return. 'Hey man,' I called as he climbed into the cab, 'she loves you!'

That brought him out into a huge grin.

I was happy for him.

I watched him drive away in the yellow taxicab, but I didn't look for one for myself. I had time to kill. I put in my headphones and listened to a podcast as I walked steadily southward down Lexington.

It was probably a touch more than two miles home, but I didn't mind the walk. The adrenaline kept me going all the way.

As I started out on my walk, I did send a text to Juliette to let her know I'd be an hour or so. She texted me back to say she hoped the movie was fun and that she loved me.

I felt like I was floating on clouds as I walked home.

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'I can see that,' I said, noticing how deep my breathing was — like I was doing intense yoga or something.

'This is the purest exhilaration... the culmination of everything... we might get to indulge in amazing sex when our partner comes back to us, and that will feel incredible — but this moment, right here, is what we do it for.'

I took another sip of booze, letting the sensation of the alcohol intoxication blend and dance with the incredible high that came from the feeling that my true love was being wicked with another man right that moment.

'It's like a drug,' I said. 'Like some kind of narcotic.'

Brian said, 'It's like... taking drugs and doing something recklessly dangerous at the same time... doing coke and then robbing a bank...'

I laughed. 'Remind me never to get high with you, dude.'

He grinned. 'Or... you know... taking ecstasy and then dancing the night away...'

'Doing heroin and then punching a cop in the face.'

The bartender smiled and refreshed our drinks — enjoying our little corner of merriment in an otherwise empty establishment. I guess it was Monday night. But for me, it was one of those golden moments you can always look back on fondly.

Juliette sent another photo — this time, Jessie and Cory were on the bed, making out. Jessie was wearing only a pair of white lacy panties, and Cory wasn't wearing anything at all.

The photo was blurry, poorly lit. I could tell my wife had taken it secretly — without Cory's knowledge. She was keeping Brian informed, though this time, she sent the picture to me.

I texted her back to say Brian was in heaven.

I said to Brian, 'I should give her your number, she can send you these direct.'

'Yeah,' he nodded. He sounded somehow far away. He was in some kind of daze, staring at the image of his new girlfriend lying in bed with another man, her bare breasts pressed against him, her hand wrapped around his big, hard, exposed cock.

Brian was so taken with the image, I had to nudge him when the bartender came back our way, because he seemed to have forgotten to

keep the phone display to himself.

We had another round of drinks, and he began to calm down again.

Every minute we sat there, it felt like the chances of something major happening between our women and Cory were increasing.

After a while, I received a photo from Jessie — showing that Juliette was now in bed with Cory, and she wasn't even wearing panties by now. The image was as blurry and dark as the one Juliette had sent me earlier — the two of them were trying to keep us in the loop without tipping off Cory to our knowledge.

Jessie's photo came with a message asking me if I thought Brian was okay with everything. I send back a suitably reassuring reply.

Then Brian received a FaceTime call and quickly scurried outside the bar to take it. I assumed it was Jessie — was she calling from the bathroom?

That left me sitting at the bar, trying not to let the bartender see the photo of my wife in bed with another man as I continued to focus on it. Man, the impact of that thing was insane. It was just an image — and taken in such poor conditions that the bartender might not even have known what it was if he saw it — but it made my pulse race and had me breathing like I was preparing to give birth.

I was hard as a rock as I sat there, feeling the powerful craving to just leave right now and run to Jessie's apartment to tear my wife away from that guy.

I wanted her so deeply. I wanted to take her in my arms and consume her.

Our sex lives had never been something to complain about, all the way back to our first dating, but this whole sharing thing had definitely boosted our desire for each other — exponentially.

How long were they going to play with Cory?

One of the conflicted feelings that were part of this experience was the dual hope that it would be over quickly so that I could get Juliette back, but also that they would take their time so she could fully enjoy herself.

I glanced toward the street and saw Brian through the window talking animatedly with Jessie — I assumed — on the phone. He seemed serious. I hoped it wasn't anything bad. Surely everything would be okay with them. I could tell Brian was keen for something to happen between Jessie and Cory. And Jessie had wanted a cuckold relationship from the very beginning — that was what had initially drawn her to Brian, who was hardly her usual type.

I wondered what Juliette and Cory were doing while Jessie talked with Brian on the phone.

Some minutes later, Brian wandered back in from the street. He smiled, but appeared to harbor some concerns.

'Everything okay?' I asked him.

He nodded, 'Jessie kind of freaked out about everything all of a sudden.'

'She okay?'

'I think so. She wasn't expecting it to feel this way. She's always had plenty of guys... but she said she was suddenly feeling real fear that she was going to lose me because of what was happening with Cory.'

'Aww. She loves you, man,' I said, trying to keep things light while also being reassuring.

'I just said that word to her,' he said, sounding a little stunned.

'That's great! How did she take it?'

'She... she said it back...'

I got the feeling that things were developing between Brian and Jessie a little more quickly than he'd anticipated. Even for a four-times married man, he was treading fresh pastures here.

'That's fantastic,' I said. 'Isn't it?'

He nodded. 'She wants me to go over there.'

'She does?'

'Juliette and Cory are leaving — Juliette talked to her after she started freaking out, and they're going to continue their party back at your place.'

'Oh, right,' I said, feeling an ounce of disappointment that the party at Jessie's place was over — but some optimism that Juliette intended on going home to continue things with her ex.

'I think Juliette's telling Cory that you went to a late-night movie,' Brian said, sensing my need for specific questions to be answered. In this case, it was helpful info — I knew to keep away from the apartment for a while.

'I guess I'll just... find something to do,' I said, trying not to sound overly emotional in front of him.

I was excited at the prospect of Juliette taking Cory home for more fun. I just didn't want to spur feelings of disappointment in Brian that Jessie had not been ready to take things with Cory further.

I settled our tab at the bar, and then we headed out, looking for an available taxi. It was late, but a slow night so we found one for Brian pretty quickly.

'You'll be okay?'

He nodded. 'That's another part of this whole thing, isn't it? A little disappointment sprinkled along the way. It can't always go your way, huh?'

'No, that's true. But all is not lost. She just needs a little time to adjust — this is the first time she's really felt the need to settle down with someone, you know?'

'Yeah, I get it.'

'She's feeling like she wants to get into commitment, and now she's being pulled in the opposite direction again.'

He sighed, but then said, 'It's good this way. We shouldn't rush things.'

'Yeah.' I smiled, and he smiled in return. 'Hey man,' I called as he climbed into the cab, 'she loves you!'

That brought him out into a huge grin.

I was happy for him.

I watched him drive away in the yellow taxicab, but I didn't look for one for myself. I had time to kill. I put in my headphones and listened to a podcast as I walked steadily southward down Lexington.

It was probably a touch more than two miles home, but I didn't mind the walk. The adrenaline kept me going all the way.

As I started out on my walk, I did send a text to Juliette to let her know I'd be an hour or so. She texted me back to say she hoped the movie was fun and that she loved me.

I felt like I was floating on clouds as I walked home.

The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.5)

by *Max Sebastian*



I waited until the appointed time and then let myself into the apartment as quietly as possible — turning the key in the lock like I was looking to burgle the place.

It wasn't so much that I wanted to catch my wife in the act of fucking another man — but if she had decided she needed more time and had gone with Cory into his bedroom, then I didn't want to interrupt them.

And my assumption was that Juliette would know when I would arrive because I'd let her know my ETA in advance.

Once inside the apartment, however, I was disappointed to find that although Cory's bedroom door was closed, there was the obvious sound of a running shower coming from our bedroom, indicating that the sex was over and Juliette was busily cleaning off the evidence.

I could smell the floral notes of shampoo in the air — Juliette's shampoo, no less — which confirmed the theory that she was already washing off the stink of adulterous sex from her body.

Could I detect the lingering scent of sex in the air out here in the living room? Possibly.

Cory appeared to be safely sealed away in his room — the door was closed, and the lights were on. I could hear his trashy music blaring through the door. He didn't care when I came back, I guess. He had finished with Juliette on time, that was the main thing.

I tiptoed through and into our bedroom, hoping that Juliette would still be in the mood for something. Even if she'd taken a shower, I was sure she'd done something with her ex just before I arrived. That still interested me.

As expected, Juliette was in the bathroom — but when I went in there to see her, she wasn't in the shower as I'd anticipated, even though the water was running and must have been running for a while, judging by the humidity.

'Hey,' she said, a mischievously wicked smile on her pretty face.

'You're not in the shower?' I asked her, confused.

She was still wearing her clothes from work — at least the white shirt and dark skirt part of it. Her jacket was gone, of course, and her hose. I wondered if anything had happened between her and Cory since they returned from Jessie's place. Maybe they'd had an argument.

'We just finished,' she said, knowing her words would make me crazy. 'Cory wondered if you'd get suspicious at me jumping in the shower right after, but I told him I'd just tell you we'd been out dancing.'

I nodded. 'You were just about to take on?' I asked, glancing at the shower.

Her smile broadened. 'Thought you might like to see me before I cleaned off.'

I ran my eyes all over her. Man, she looked incredible. I put my hands on her chest, feeling the enticing swell of her small breasts through the thin material of her shirt. 'You put your work clothes back on?'

She leaned back against the sink, allowing my hands to explore her breasts freely. 'When we got back from Jessie's, he wanted to fuck me in my work clothes,' she said.

'You do look pretty good as a sexy lawyer,' I said, my hand sliding down, reaching her thigh, dipping under her skirt to feel the damp heat of her panties.

She moaned as I pressed my hand against her pussy, through her underwear.

'You had a fun night, then?'

She nodded. 'Uh-huh. Of course.'

She drifted back to lean up against the bathroom wall. For a while, I just couldn't stop running my hand all over her, feeling the heat of her body through her clothes, finding my way to her clammy flesh that offered evidence of exertion, of desire, of sex.

She gave me the time and the space to explore her, to tantalize my senses with the evidence of her infidelity.

In the hot, humid bathroom, I inhaled the musky smell of their sex from her body. I cradled her head and tasted the salt on her neck. I sucked on her mouth and sampled the flavor of another man on her lips.

'How long ago did you finish with him?' I asked her.

'Right before you came in,' she said, breathless, as I put my hands on her ass and pulled her against me so she could feel how hard I was for her. She added, 'I timed it to the minute. He fucked me on the couch... he came inside me... and then I came in here to turn on the shower, and then there you were at the door.'

I slipped my tongue inside her mouth. She was just irresistible when she'd just been fucked.

Then I knelt down in front of her, the smell of sex strengthening as I got close to her nether regions, and I pushed up her skirt.

'What happened at Jessie's?' I asked her.

'We were having a good time,' she said. 'Jessie was having fun. Flirting with him a lot. Dancing with him. Making out.'

'Okay... sounds good so far...'

I peeled down her white lace thong, just enchanted by the sight of her freshly fucked pussy. Man, she was so beautiful. And the fact that her pussy was completely shaven tugged at my cuckold senses — because the whole reason she'd done it in the first place had been to please Cory.

'I thought I'd get jealous,' she said, gazing down at me as I paused briefly to admire the wonder before me. 'I mean... Jessie and I traded boyfriends in college...'

'Yeah, you need to tell me all about that...' I grinned, leaning in to inhale the spicy, musky smell of sex direct from her pussy lips.

She giggled. 'We even dated some of them at the same time, sometimes... but this was different... I mean, Cory was my first... and this is, like, part of *us*... part of our relationship...'

It was interesting that she saw her adventure with Cory as part of our relationship. It felt unexpectedly reassuring.

'But you were okay with her partying with him?'

'Yeah... we were dancing with him... getting real close. She was making out with him, and that was okay.'

'Brian was so thrilled at what was going on,' I said as I kissed my way around her perfect pussy, just indulging in the knowledge that she'd just had sex with someone else.

'Then she was watching me go down on him... and kind of settled back to watch him fuck me... but when he wanted me to tag her in, Jessie... well, I guess she got scared.'

'Ah well, it's perfectly understandable,' I said, leaning in to kiss her gently at the apex of her slit.

'It really wasn't like Jessie, though,' Juliette said seriously. 'I mean... she's the party girl of all party girls.'

'I think she's fallen for Brian,' I said, and even saying it seemed a little quirky because as much as I liked Brian, I knew Jessie pretty well, and he was the opposite kind of guy to anyone Jessie had ever dated.

'I think she has. Like crazy. And she's never done this before, so suddenly she's got the chance to fool around with somebody else and it terrifies her.'

I dipped the tip of my tongue inside her adulterous sex, just teasing myself with the hotness of this whole thing. My deepest fantasy made real, now standing right in front of me with her panties around her ankles.

'She'll be okay,' I said. 'She's not ready yet. Eventually, she'll get her head around it all, and she'll be able to do whatever.'

'I'm sure she will,' Juliette nodded, then closed her eyes and moaned as I began to worship her pussy with my tongue.

'So you decided to drag Cory home, huh?' I asked her.

Leaning back against the wall, Juliette pushed out her hips and parted her thighs a little more to make it easier for me to explore her pussy with my mouth.

'She needed Brian to come over,' she said, her breathing deepening. 'So... you know, that was fine. We came back here and he continued where we left off.'

'It felt good?'

She grinned. 'Oh, yeah. He fucked me over the back of the couch. And then on the floor.'

She stroked my head as I ate her, reveling in the wickedness, the taboo nature of going down on a woman after she'd had sex with another man.

Of sucking on my wife's pussy immediately after she'd been consensually unfaithful. I wasn't squeamish about another man being there before me. It was just sex. It was my wife, my goddess, and I could worship her how I wanted.

It was hot, going down on her like that, with her standing over me. It positioned her well for me to appreciate her beauty, and though she had to stand and support herself, it seemed to get her going, too.

I turned her around so she was facing the wall, and she bent over so I could eat her juicy sex while appreciating the sight of her gorgeous ass. Picturing her ex-boyfriend bending her over the back of our couch before shoving his huge cock inside her.

'He made you come?'

'Oh yeah. Twice.'

'And then he came just before I arrived?'

She grinned. 'I timed it perfectly. He didn't even get time to put his clothes on — he just grabbed his stuff and dived into his room while I came into the bathroom. And then there you were...'

Wow. I'd literally taken over from him. I'd been tagged in. I stood up and peeled off the rest of her clothes, just in awe at her sticky, sweaty form, so ripe and so fresh from sex with our current roommate.

I slid my fingers inside her, exploring the texture and the warmth of her so soon after another man's cock had squeezed inside her.

But after a while, she grabbed my hand and urged me off the floor. She kissed me deeply, slipping her tongue in my mouth, as though telling me that despite everything with Cory, her attention was now on me.

She turned me, pushed me back against the tiled bathroom wall, knelt down in front of me, her hands moving to unfasten my fly.

'So you guys had a fun time while we were busy with Cory?' she asked me.

'Yeah, it was good,' I nodded. 'Surprisingly good, actually.'

'Oh yeah?' She was intrigued.

And, as it turned out, she was just delirious at how hard I was when she pulled out my cock. What can I say? It turned me on to see her like this. To have her like this — fresh from another man's dick.

She started swirling her tongue around my hardness, exploring it, appreciating it, captivated by it. 'I was worried you guys would get bored while you waited for us,' she said.

'Oh no, that would never be boring,' I said, groaning as she slipped the end of my cock inside her hot mouth. 'Every minute, we're thinking about what you might be doing with him.'

'Even Brian?'

'Brian was very hopeful Jessie was having a good time with him. And those pictures helped set the scene.'

She smiled and began pumping my cock with one hand while cupping my balls with the other. 'We had to take those pictures while Cory was distracted. I wasn't sure they'd come out very well.'

'They were good enough we could tell what they were,' I said.

She was wild about my cock. I knew it was more average than Cory's leviathan, but I could tell size wasn't the issue in this case. If anything, a smaller cock was easier for her to pleasure with her mouth. The main thing that seemed to get her going was how turned on I was, how into this I was.

She was getting pleasure from my pleasure, too. It was just that my pleasure was caused by her being with another man.

This whole non-monogamy thing really was strengthening our relationship.

She didn't let me come in her mouth, though. As I got close, she rose to her feet, shedding her shirt and stepping out of her panties — then urging me to follow her into the shower.

The water was wonderful as it flowed down on our naked bodies, both of us pressed against each other, mouth to mouth, passionately kissing as her hands grasped my cock, and one of mine found its way to her soaking wet pussy.

After a while, I could take it no longer, turning her so I could drive my cock inside her from behind.

God, it felt amazing. And to fuck such a gorgeous woman... even as familiar as I was with her, it was like the first time all over again. The fact she had just been with another man just seemed to enhance everything about her in my eyes — her beauty, her significance, her value.

She was just the most incredible woman I'd ever known.

There was no rationality to it, except perhaps for that odd theory about the male body responding to his mate being taken by another. Boosting the libido so the man could mate with his unfaithful partner and potentially breed with her in place of the man she'd been with before.

I grabbed hold of her sweet ass and fucked her hard, feeling another man's seed inside her, lubricating our copulation.

After a while, she had me lie down so she could ride me — still in the shower. Thankfully, it was a double-size shower.

But I didn't get to come inside her. Not that night. I stood as she sucked my cock some more. I shot my white cream all over her face, her breasts, her stomach. She beamed as she rose to her feet, stroking herself, rubbing my come over her body, her breasts, her face. It was like I'd marked her as my territory; she was all mine.

We held each other tight, and I kissed her mouth as the hot water began to wash us clean again.

I loved her so much. And I knew she loved me in the same way.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.6)

by *Max Sebastian*



I expected Cory to find ways to delay his search for a new apartment, believing that he was in a good arrangement staying at our place, having easy access to Juliette.

But he surprised me, getting moving on the hunt for a new home fairly swiftly after he moved in with us.

Naturally, Juliette offered her services as a second opinion. So, she went with him from the get-go to look around apartments. I was okay with that — sitting at home, I could think of them flirting together and maybe even managing a little more.

Juliette enjoyed the whole property thing, anyway. She loved nosing around places, imagining how it would be to live somewhere else.

She sent me occasional photos of places they were looking around, which were interesting. She made me wonder if she didn't like the idea of a change of residence herself, though we had a lovely apartment in the middle of the Upper East Side.

They looked around four different places that first evening — I was surprised at their pace.

I texted Brian, and he pointed out that as far as Cory was concerned, he was having a secret affair with Juliette and that, therefore, he probably had an agenda to find his own place quickly so that he could get some distance between himself and me. While he might not get such frequent access to Juliette living in his own place, it would mean they would have more privacy when she did go over there.

Brian was good at letting me see things from other perspectives. I guess the sex would be better if you weren't constantly afraid of being discovered by the husband.

Brian asked me if Cory was seeking Juliette's opinion on apartments because he hoped to persuade her to move in with him.

I had to agree with him that it was probably the case. The thought made me feel little ripples of anxiety. I couldn't forget that Cory's ultimate agenda was stealing Juliette from me. My sweet wife and I could have a little fun toying with his adulterous intent, but at the end of the day, there was still some risk that he would achieve his goal.

Anyway. I did my best to ignore the fear — it was early days, and Juliette was enjoying having attention from two men at the same time. She would not get that opportunity if she decided to attach herself only to Cory.

That first apartment-hunting evening, Juliette sent me little updates whenever the two of them caught a brief moment alone when they could make out. I'd say they were in that horny stage of an early relationship, except that what she'd told me of their time together in a long-term relationship, that was how it had been simply when they were together.

It was exciting for me to think that something hot might happen between them at any moment.

The first occasion was after the third place they'd seen. There was a half-hour wait until their next appointment, and Juliette texted me to let me know they'd found a shady spot around the back of a building, and she had managed to go down on him. I didn't get a reply to my question about whether he'd finished in her mouth, but it was hot, nevertheless.

Brian told me she could have been just making up spicy little scenarios to keep me happy at home, but I thought that unlikely.

Then after they'd been shown around the fourth place of the night, Juliette texted me to let me know they were on their way home — and that Cory had fucked her in the building's stairwell on their way out.

Wow. That got me going.

I waited with bated breath as they made their way home. It wasn't shockingly late, but even so I retired to the bedroom to wait for Juliette, already hard as I heard them come in through the front door.

I was buzzing as I heard them chatting and Juliette giggling at something Cory had said. There was a moment where I was concerned that they might just want to camp out on the couch for a while, and that Juliette wouldn't come to bed for ages. I was buzzing, shaking, ready to go now.

But while there seemed to be a delay as one or both of them fetched drinks from the kitchen, I was relieved when Juliette slipped inside the bedroom, looking like she was ready to give herself to me instead.

'So it happened?' I asked her. She was still wearing her work clothes — suit and white blouse — but she looked a little more disheveled than I might have expected from merely a day's duties in our law firm.

'Uh-huh. D'you get my message?'

'Oh, sure.'

She smiled and made sure our bedroom door was firmly closed before coming up to me to kiss me. Oh, it felt so good taking her into my arms, sucking on her soft lips. She smelled of him, she tasted of him. I could quickly confirm that Brian was wrong about her making anything up about what they'd done during the apartment search.

'Wait,' she said, breaking away from me. She scampered into our en suite bathroom and switched on the shower — then she came back out to me.

'What, are you worried about listening devices?' I laughed.

She shook her head. 'He can hear when somebody has a shower in there,' she said. 'He'll expect me to clean up after what we did.'

We just stood there outside the bathroom door for a while, letting the shower run as we made out. It was so hot exploring her kiss, that subtle yet strange taste that came from her having another man's cock in her mouth just before.

'Show me what you did with him,' I said, breathless as we finally came up for air.

'In the stairwell?' she said. I nodded.

She crouched in front of me, pulled down my sweatpants and my boxers to release my hard cock, and took it in her hands before stretching her lips around it. She seemed ecstatic at how hard I was. I leaned back against the wall and gazed at her as she stroked my cock with one hand and ducked her head to take the rest of my hardness in her mouth.

It felt so good, but to watch her, knowing she'd just done this with her ex was doubly arousing.

'Mmm... he was holding my head...' she said, briefly, and I knew to do exactly as he had done — putting my hands where she wanted me to, feeling the soft silkiness of her golden hair as I showed her the perfect rhythm to suit my ends.

After a few minutes, however, she pulled away from me and stood up.

'We didn't have much time,' she said, breathless.

'Understandable, in a public stairwell.'

She turned away from me and pulled down her suit pants — a move that seemed so natural, it seemed to draw attention to the fact that she'd done this exact same thing a little earlier that night.

'I guess I'd been teasing him a little all night,' she said. 'He just wanted to fuck me by then...'

She turned around and just bent forward, putting her hands up against the wall in that little mini-hallway outside our bathroom door, and it was clear what she wanted me to do.

I placed one hand on her hip and guided my hard cock toward the intense heat of her pussy, while gazing down at her perfect, heart-shaped behind.

It felt particularly easy for me to slip inside her hot pussy — she was so wet, filled with another man's come. She moaned as I entered her, and it seemed like we were deluged in the sudden potent smell of sex. Such a thrill — my heart was racing. I slid inside her and felt the strangeness of another man's seed leaking out of her.

There was no faking that.

My cock was throbbing with arousal before I even began thrusting into her. So hot to grab hold of her, feeling the slight clamminess of her warm flesh, inhaling that spicy, musky scent of sex with every breath, the oily heat of her pussy enveloping my hard cock — her sex freshly fucked by another man.

'Oh *yes...*' she moaned as I pumped my cock into her, working up a desirable rhythm.

Her body shuddered and rocked as I slammed into her over and over. She reached back with one hand to grab hold of my wrist as I fucked her, as though she needed as much connection with me as possible. So beautiful. I was proud that another man wanted my wife as much as Cory did. She'd driven him crazy all night, and he'd ended up taking a big risk to fuck her in a public place.

'What if you'd been caught?' I asked her,

'Probably would have been pretty awkward,' she grinned, her face flushed.

As I fucked her, I reached to grab hold of her breasts as I continued fucking her. I'm sorry to say I may have then torn a few of her buttons as

I pulled the thing off her so I could access her gorgeous breasts. That hadn't been what Cory had done.

Juliette seemed fine with the damage to her blouse, pulling it off before reaching behind her to flick the catch on her bra and allow me unfettered access to her tits.

'He came like this?' I asked her, feeling myself beginning to go.

'Uh-huh,' she said, breathless.

I made her believe I was going to do just as Cory had done, and come inside her quickly as I fucked her increasingly roughly as she held onto that wall. But as she came herself, stifling her cries so Cory wouldn't hear, I held back.

She seemed unsure whether I'd come or not, but then I led her to the bed, guided her down onto the mattress, and lay beside her to slide my cock back inside her. We were kind of spooned, I suppose, except that she was on her front, I was over her.

It was intimate, I felt so close to her as I began stirring my cocktail within her juicy sex again.

'You liked doing it in a public place?' I asked her.

'Oh yes...' she cooed, moaning from the slower, more affectionate sensation of my new pace and from the after-effects of her orgasm. 'It felt dangerous... sexy...'

'You do that kind of thing with him before?' I asked, sucking on her earlobe.

'Mmm... when we were teenagers, we couldn't always get alone time in our bedrooms... so yeah, we'd find other places...'

'Like where?'

'Under the bleachers?'

'So cute.'

'In the middle of the football field at midnight.'

'Naughty.'

'Outside the school chemistry lab.'

'Mmm... dangerous chemistry...'

Okay, I couldn't resist it much longer. Holding such a beautiful, freshly-fucked woman in my arms, my cock sliding in and out of her creamy pussy... I tensed up and then let fly, groaning as I released my own hot cream inside her, her second load of the evening.

As I collapsed beside her, however, she wasn't entirely done — I lay watching her make herself come one more time — this time enjoying the feeling of two men's emissions leaking out of her pussy.

Even with my post-nut clarity, it was hot to see her reveling in her promiscuity like that.

For once, it got me going again in close to record time — and we had a little more fun before drifting off to sleep in each other's arms.

I was feeling so good, generally, that while I was at work, one of my co-workers — Brandon — asked if I'd taken up Buddhism or something.

'Uh... no.'

'You're so zen, man.'

There was a big question on his face — I guess everyone was looking for the answer to the simple question of how to be happy. I didn't feel I could just open up and tell him how I'd found mine, however. I felt a little guilty about that — but if gossip started flying around the office, it wasn't just my reputation it would affect. I had to remember Juliette was beaver away somewhere else in the building, even if we weren't in the same department.

'You know the McRib is back?' I said to him as though it was the reason for my serenity.

'Seriously?'

'Makes life worth living, huh?'

I felt a little guilty I couldn't just pass on my life lessons to him — but I also had to remember that not every guy felt the same way about non-monogamy, consensual or otherwise.

To my mild annoyance, though, it seemed that Brandon's belief that something new in my life was making me 'zen as shit' was spreading among my co-workers.

Later that particular day, someone else from my team — Megan — decided to tell the whole group that it was obvious I'd just gotten laid. And that it had been earth-shaking sex.

The way she waggled her eyebrows as she said it seemed to infer that there was a new lady in my life.

'Hey, I'm married,' I pointed out.

Barney, who was also married, then blurted out, 'People can have good sex when they're married.' He sounded to me like he was revealing a little more than he'd meant to.

Megan said, 'Yeah, but not with their spouses.'

Brandon asked me, 'Have you been a naughty boy, Nick?'

The expression on his face made me laugh — which, I'll admit, probably made me look guilty as sin. But with full honesty, I declared, 'I'm not cheating on my wife.'

Megan said, 'So what happened? You discover a brand new porn site? You've been married, what, five years or something?'

'I don't need to use porn,' I said. 'And it's more like four years.'

Andrew, the nerdy (nerdiest, I guess) one in our little collective, said, 'he's married to Juliette Morrison. You know — the blonde in M&A.'

I liked the way he referred to her — his tone indicating that my wife was incredibly attractive and that, therefore, it should come as no surprise that we were still sexually active and that I was obviously having good

sex at the moment despite being long since married. The way he looked at me also suggested he was impressed at me for being happily married to someone like her all this time.

Then Brandon blurted out, 'You're cheating on the hot blonde in M&A?'

I guess he couldn't get his head around the concept of married people having sex.

'I'm not cheating on anybody,' I insisted. 'And do we have to discuss my sex life at work?'

Anyway. The rest of the day, I kept getting envious glances from Andrew — and, somewhat surprisingly, flirtatious glances from Megan. I tried not to let it distract me from the work, which was mysterious and important.

Then, at close of play, I was walking out of the building with Brandon to head home when who should be outside the building waiting for me, but my wife's attractive, blonde BFF, Jessie.

Naturally, I couldn't shake Brandon in time for him to miss her look of sheer delight at seeing me and the way she ran up to me and hugged me.

'My wife's best friend,' I told him, as though it would somehow prove that we weren't having an affair, and that our affair wasn't the solution to the whole 'zen as shit' mystery in our office.

I was pretty stupid sometimes.

I saw the amusement blossom on Brandon's face as he tapped his nose twice to indicate that it would remain our secret.

I groaned in frustration.

'What?' Jessie said. 'I thought you'd be happy to see me.'

Well, at least if Brandon was going to suspect me of having an affair, he would hold the belief that I was sleeping with someone else who was absolutely gorgeous.

'That guy,' I said to her under my breath. 'Is Brandon, one of my co-workers. And now he thinks I'm having an affair with you.'

Jessie said, 'Oh.' Then, as she realized the problem, she added, 'Shit. I didn't even think about that.'

I gave her a half-eye-roll, but I don't think she saw it. She rose up on tip-toes as though it would do anything, and cried out across the busy plaza, 'Hey, Brandon! Nice meeting you! And by the way, we're not having an affair!'

Brandon turned around, though somehow managed to continue walking toward the subway — backward — as he flashed us both a huge, highly amused grin before waving at us briefly, then turning back to continue on his way.

'You think he believed me?' Jessie asked me.

'Not one bit,' I said, but I couldn't help but smile at her ditzy behavior. 'And now everyone in the company thinks we're having an affair.'

Jessie giggled, and then linked her arm in mine to lead me toward the subway. 'I don't care. You're pretty hot. Let them.'

'So... it's nice to see you, Jess,' I said, giving her a playful squeeze of her arm as we walked.

'I thought you'd probably need a drink after work.'

'By which you mean you need a drink after work?'

'I always need a drink after work,' she said. 'You know how soul-destroying a career in marketing is?'

'You think corporate law is much better?' I laughed.

'Oh, I don't know. Looks to me like you have some pretty hot co-workers.'

I chuckled, 'I don't think I'm Brandon's type.'

'So... you had a good night with Juliette and Cory?'

Her smile faded. 'I think I really disappointed Brian.'

We were at Melody's, a piano bar not too far from my apartment. It was much easier to talk there, over cocktails, than it was on the crowded subway.

I told her Brian was anything but disappointed in her. I explained that he'd been approaching their relationship with a much more steady, unhurried strategy because he had expected her to need time to get accustomed to things before branching out.

'He said you guys needed to work on your own bond before you're fully ready to pursue the fantasy,' I said.

She nodded. 'He's so clever, you know that?'

'He's had this fantasy for a while,' I said. 'He knows what he's doing.'

Her eyes flashed. 'Isn't that so hot? I mean... I know I'm not ready yet... but when I am, I'm going to have this gorgeous guy who gets all fired up when I sleep with other people.'

I laughed. 'Seems like the dream, doesn't it?'

She sipped her cocktail, then said seriously, 'I know I need a little time to get used to it, though.'

'Of course — anyone would.'

'God, it was the weirdest thing. I thought I could just jump straight in the deep end, you know? That it would make Brian happy. And it wouldn't be a big deal because, you know, I've partied all my life, I know what I'm doing. Fooling around with guys is my thing. But then... when it came time to do something with Cory, you know, something serious...'

'It's different now you've found Brian,' I nodded.

'I mean, it wasn't because Juliette was there. I know she and I haven't had fun with a guy since... well, I guess since before you came along.'

That made me laugh. 'You guys definitely never had fun with me like that.'

Something seemed to click in Jessie, as though I'd suddenly explained something to her, and she gave a little gasp. 'That's because she was so in love with you,' she said. 'She never felt that way about another guy before.'

'What about Cory?'

Jessie shook her head. 'She was obsessed with Cory for a while, sure, but it was never like it was with you.'

Well, that was an ego boost. And no small dose of reassurance.

Jessie grabbed hold of my arm like she desperately had to get my attention. 'Don't you see? That's how it is with me and Brian. When I was with Jules and Cory... and he wanted me to fuck him... suddenly I felt truly awful.'

'It's a lot to figure out.'

'You know, my heart was racing... I was sweating... I was like... having some kind of fever...'

'Isn't that what you get when you're just having a good time?'

'...I felt like I was going to be sick...'

'Okay, not that part.' I laughed. 'You just need time to get used to long-term relationships. And then when you're comfortable with that, you can think about the next step.'

'You think Brian's going to... you know... get bored if I'm not ready to... sleep around for a while?'

'Bored of you — are you kidding? I've never seen him happier.'

'But you haven't known him that long.'

'We've gotten pretty close. You know he loves you like crazy.'

She beamed, flushed with delight. 'You know we said it? The L-word.'

'I know, Brian told me.'

'I never said that to anybody before. Well, not when I meant it.'

'I'm happy for you guys.'

'God, I feel like I've been searching for someone like him for years. Who knew I was looking at completely the wrong type of guy all along?'

I said to her solemnly, 'I don't think you have to worry about rushing things. I think he'll wait for you for as long as you need. And if you never even want to...'

'Oh, I'll want to,' she said confidently.

'There you go — it's going to be great, you'll see.'

She nodded. I thought perhaps we'd sorted all her problems. That we could head home, catch up with our loved ones.

But Jessie took a long drink of her cocktail and looked at me with a somewhat grave expression. 'So... we have to talk about Cory,' she said.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.7)

by *Max Sebastian*



When I got home, there was no sign of Juliette or Cory in the apartment.

It wasn't all that late — Jessie and I had talked a while, but neither of us was in the mood to really party, and it was a weeknight, after all. We'd called it a night at 10pm.

It felt jarring that my wife — and her ex — were not there as I got back.

I double-checked my phone for messages, but there was nothing new after Juliette had liked my message letting her know I was having a drink with Jessie. I sent her a little message asking where she was and that I was now home. Nothing serious.

Perhaps Cory had persuaded her to go out since I wasn't around. He was still somewhat dazzled by the whole big city thing. New York had that effect on newcomers. I could understand him just wanting to get out and

celebrate being here — and with Juliette around, he had extra motivation for celebration.

I watched TV and tried not to dwell on the fact that they were AWOL — particularly given what Jessie had told me earlier in Melody's.

Sitting there watching TV on my own, though, it was difficult not to let Jessie's words tick over in my head.

'He's serious about getting back together with her,' she'd said.

I'd insisted that I knew that it was under control.

'But when I was with them, they were talking like it's a done deal,' Jessie said. 'They'll find their apartment. She'll leave you, move in with him. Then when the divorce is finalized, they'll do things properly.'

'Do things properly?'

'Get married. Have kids.'

That had made me raise my eyebrows, I'll admit.

'They're talking about having kids?'

'Cory's ready to settle down,' Jessie said. 'And he wants a big family.'

'And he's looking for an apartment in Manhattan?' I said dryly.

'Only to rent,' she pointed out. 'He's really only here to win her back.'

I'd tried to keep calm and persuade her that Juliette was only stringing Cory along, making him feel like she was his again so she could have some fun and enjoy the thrill of sleeping with him again. That she was only humoring him when she seemed like she was playing along with his whole life plan.

'I don't know...' Jessie seemed wary, which didn't make me feel too good — Jessie knew Juliette almost as well as I did. 'Sometimes she seems a little too good at playing the part.'

I'd said how Juliette had never been particularly interested in having kids, and Jessie had cast doubt on that, too, which had been a little unnerving.

'She's totally in love with you. She knows you really don't want kids because of what happened with your dad. But I wonder... if she was with someone who really wanted kids... if she'd feel the same way.'

Hmm. That was something to think about. I'd always been clear with Juliette from the start about the whole kids thing. My dad had cheated on my mom when I was small. A lot. And when I was seven, he had disappeared entirely.

I had no intentions of ever cheating on Juliette, but ever since I'd been a kid, I'd felt sure that I'd prefer not to have kids at all than turn out like my dad.

But now, for the first time, Jessie had sown doubts in my mind as to whether Juliette genuinely shared my view on having children.

'She hasn't said anything to me about changing her mind,' Jessie said, 'But sometimes when she's talking about it with Cory, she gets this wistful look in her eye...'

Of course I completely trusted Juliette, I was sure she loved me as much as I loved her, that our marriage was first and foremost to her — and I felt sure she only wanted Cory for the sex. But the kids thing had shaken me a little. That kind of thing could move the goalposts.

I'd sat there with Jessie, sipping my bourbon while we listened to the dulcet tinkle of the piano in the background, and I felt like the ground was shifting under my feet.

'But he was hoping to have sex with both of you last night,' I said, as though that might possibly counter his whole life strategy about settling down to have children.

It sounded a little stupid as soon as it came out of my mouth.

'He's okay with the idea of them partying with other girls — he's just not keen on her sleeping with other guys.'

I nodded. 'He didn't seem too bothered about partying with us the night of the reunion.'

To that, Jessie had said, 'That night, I think he never really believed Juliette would let him go that far. He was just hoping to do whatever you'd let him get away with and then get out of there. And it ended up with him going the whole way with her.'

I sipped my drink. Suddenly, I didn't feel so great about Cory staying at our apartment, believing he was sleeping with my wife behind my back.

'So it's okay if he has sex with other women, but Juliette can't go with other guys, is that it?' I asked Jessie.

'Well, in your relationship, you don't get to see other women, do you?' she pointed out.

'Yeah... but it's not quite the same. I mean, It's not like Juliette gets off on him sleeping with other women, does she? Whereas... well, you know how it is. Brian's the same way with you.'

'He is, isn't he?' Jessie had smiled so brightly at being reminded of her boyfriend and the kink he also favored.

But then she said, 'He's fine about her sleeping with other women, by the way. He's that kind of guy. No jealousy when it's a woman involved.'

'But Juliette's not bisexual. I mean, she has fun with you... and she's okay sharing a guy...'

Jessie shrugged. 'Maybe she's more open-minded than we imagine.'

I felt the ground shift under me again at that.

I sat watching TV on my own for 20 minutes, wondering why Juliette wasn't replying to my text message. Stewing in my own paranoia.

I was so close to texting Jessie to tell her Juliette was gone that I was worried about what she and Cory were up to. But my gut feeling was that perhaps Cory had found an apartment to go see last minute. They'd been in such a rush, Juliette hadn't had a moment to look at her phone.

I waited.

Twenty minutes wasn't so bad to wait. Then I heard them outside the front door chatting away — Juliette's giggling from as far down the hallway as the elevator. When they came in, they were wearing workout gear, sipping Gatorade from their water bottles, and both clearly flushed and sweaty from a visit to the gym in our building.

I could hardly demand to know where my wife had been — she hadn't even left the building.

And nothing seemed out of sorts as they came in and Juliette saw me watching TV.

'Oh, hey, honey — you have a good time with Jess?'

'Yeah, we went to that piano bar she likes — Melody's?' I said. I realized I wasn't sure whether Cory had been made aware that Jessie had been dating Brian, so I refrained from dropping any specific details.

I thought it would be obvious that I'd clipped my conversation, but Cory didn't seem to notice — or care. He gave me a little nod of polite greeting, then disappeared into his room.

Juliette stood in front of me to do a few post-workout stretches, as she usually did when she came back from the gym — though tonight, I suspect she could tell I was enjoying the sight of her in her tight workout gear. She looked incredible in those little black running shorts and a gray sports bra soaked with sweat.

When she straightened up again and clocked me checking her out, she smiled sweetly, relishing my evident desire.

'What did you guys talk about?' she asked. 'Everything okay with her after... the other night?'

'She's fine. You know how it is,' I said vaguely, not wanting to elucidate if Cory could overhear.

I stood and couldn't resist taking Juliette into my arms for a kiss. I think the clammy skin and flushed complexion from her recent exercise, along

with the gentle aroma of perspiration, made me think of how she was after she'd had sex with Cory.

I think maybe she could sense my excitement.

'Honey, we only went to the gym,' she said, stepping back, amused.

I flashed my eyes at her and put a finger to my lips to warn her that careless talk costs lives. Cory's door was now closed, but even so.

Juliette nodded, still amused, but recognizing that she was in danger of giving the game away to Cory. She offered her hand, then quietly led me into our bedroom before closing the door behind us.

'He wants me to sneak into his room later tonight,' she said in a low voice. 'You know — when I'm sure you're asleep.'

'That could be fun,' I said, pulling her in for another kiss. 'How long do you think we need to wait until it's believable that I'm asleep?'

'I think... maybe an hour or two,' she said.

She went into the bathroom to switch on the shower and called out, 'So what did Jess have to say?'

I wandered into the en suite after her, perching on the closed toilet to watch her peel off her tight black shorts. I was buzzing with lust, my manhood rock-hard in my sweatpants. But I felt I had to control myself and wait for Juliette to have her fun with Cory first.

'It's pretty much what I thought it would be,' I said, captivated by the sight of my beautiful wife pulling off her sports bra before dropping her little thong panties. 'She's just not used to the whole long-term commitment thing, and now she's beginning to get the hang of that; she's worried Brian's going to be disappointed she's not feeling ready to just bang other guys.'

'That's so funny, isn't it?' Juliette said, turning to test the water temperature in the shower. 'It's so unlike Jess... but I guess it's a good sign if she's so into Brian she's reluctant to get into anything else.'

Satisfied with the water temperature, Juliette turned to me and seemed surprised I was still sitting there.

'You need me to leave?' I grinned, amused at her apparent need for privacy.

She laughed. 'No. Aren't you coming in too?'

'Oh uh...'

Well, I didn't need asking twice. I stood and pulled off my clothes, even though I was already pretty much ready for bed. Her face lit up at the sight of my hard-on. I guess it was a good barometer of how I felt about her and the prospect of her sneaking into Cory's bed later.

As we soaped each other, we chatted about how Jessie had reached a new phase of her life where she was feeling the need to settle down, but that Brian's particular fantasy could give her mixed signals.

I said, 'Speaking of new phases of life... Jess said that Cory's suddenly wanting to have kids?'

Well... I figured it was bad to keep secrets from my wife. If Juliette was reconsidering her life choices about kids, we needed to discuss it.

She stood there massaging soap into my hard cock with both hands — which felt good, though I was focused on her answer. 'It's kind of sweet, actually,' she said. 'I would have never thought Cory would be the type... but I guess he's finally maturing, and he's feeling like he wants a family...'

'You think he'd be a good dad?'

'I don't know... I guess he has changed a little since we were teenagers...'

She leaned back and reached for a safety razor, which she handed me, saying, 'Will you help me get ready for him?'

'Sure,' I said, and located her shaving gel.

She moaned while I was applying the gel around her pussy, and it did turn into something a little more sexual than just personal grooming. But I didn't take it as far as letting her come — I enjoyed setting up so that she was craving sex ahead of seeing Cory.

I knelt in front of her and began to carefully drag the razor over the lather smothered over her mound. She probably didn't even need a shave yet, but she didn't want any hint of stubble, even for a late-night quickie with her ex.

And anyway, I was happy to do that for her. It was sexy to get to tend so intimately to her like that as she leaned back, gazing down at me. It was a turn-on to help prepare her for sex with another man.

'Does Cory make you... want to reconsider how we feel about having kids?' I asked her while stroking her to check my handiwork around her mound.

Lifting a foot onto my shoulder to give me easier access to shave between her legs, she said, 'I don't know... sometimes I think it might be nice to have some little ones... but I know how you feel about it.'

I leaned in to gently kiss her beautifully exposed pussy lips. 'You know if you changed your mind... we could talk about it.'

She moaned at the intimate contact. 'I... I know...'

Man, I was feeling pressure from myself to reconsider my life plans. Was I overreacting to the fear that Cory would have something to offer Juliette beyond what I could?

'We can think about it,' Juliette said as she turned and bent over so I could finish the task at hand. 'But there's no rush, is there?'

'No, I guess not.'

Once I had her all rinsed off, I couldn't resist carrying out a final check on the quality of the shave by licking her pussy — but again, I stopped short of letting her come.

'You're doing it on purpose,' she giggled as I picked myself up from the floor.

'I'm telling you,' I laughed, 'I have pins and needles. I can't kneel on these tiles forever...'

'You just want to drive me crazy so I have to go get Cory to make me come,' she said.

I could hardly deny her allegations.

After that, My sweet wife couldn't wait more than 40 minutes before 'sneaking' out of our bedroom to join Cory in his bed.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.8)

by *Max Sebastian*



I stayed in bed when she left to go sleep with Cory. I just kissed her farewell and told her to have fun, then lay there like it wasn't a big deal. It was just pride, of course. While I was pretending to be calm and relaxed, inside I was a mass of raging hormones, my heart thumping away like a drum machine, my hard cock straining to escape my underwear.

I didn't want Juliette to think I was so desperate for that cuckold thrill.

But after a few minutes waiting there, I couldn't stand it any longer. I slipped out of bed, tiptoed out of the room, crept to the doorway of our office-turned-guest-bedroom.

Juliette had left the door open a crack.

She'd done it on purpose, I could tell. The door looked almost closed — from a distance, you would even think she'd closed it — but it was just out of alignment such that there was an opening of maybe an eighth of an inch.

I stood there, leaning against the wall beside the door, listening like my life depended on it.

The way our apartment is laid out, the guest bedroom has its own little en suite bathroom, and it also has a second doorway into the kitchen. This second doorway was closed, but it meant I felt safe that Cory wouldn't need to come out of this doorway. I guess 'safe' is a relative term — I didn't feel entirely safe. I was on a hair trigger ready to escape at the sound of anyone coming near.

From inside Cory's room, I could hear the muffled sounds of them talking, though I couldn't hear what they were saying. My hard-on disappeared for a little while as I listened, focused on the tiniest sounds.

After a few minutes, the talking faded, and I began to hear some quiet moans. My manhood swelled once again as I pictured them kissing and touching each other. Cory's hand on my wife's pussy, Juliette's hand on her ex-boyfriend's cock.

In subsequent visits, this phase lasted much longer, but this first time Juliette sneaked out of my bed to join Cory, they were impatient to cut to the chase.

It was maybe five or ten minutes before the moans began to get louder — mostly Juliette, who had no fear that they would be discovered but only had to make Cory believe she was trying to keep relatively quiet. Some low grunts from Cory. The sound of movement in the bed, the creak of the mattress.

I stroked my hard cock through my sweatpants as I listened, sure by now that she was fucking him.

It got seriously loud — to the point that I thought Juliette wasn't being careful enough to maintain the subterfuge that she and Cory were having an affair in secret, behind my back. The gasping moans, sometimes as

though Juliette was in pain. The shaking of the bed. The sound of flesh hitting flesh.

Then there was the shuddering, jerking sound — more like an irregular rhythm in their movement — that denoted clearly that one or both of them had hit orgasm.

I had to take care not to come myself, I was so enraptured by the whole experience. Even though I couldn't see them, the sounds were enough to verify what was going on, to follow along to the adventure of my sweet wife being unfaithful.

I could imagine Cory's experience touching her, holding her, kissing her. How thrilled he would be at the feel of her body, the taste of her soft lips, her feminine scent all around him. The feel of his big cock squeezed inside her soaking wet pussy.

I could imagine how he felt because I'd slept with her so much myself. But putting myself in his head made me feel more than just the firsthand excitement of sex with the most beautiful woman I'd ever known — at the same time, I felt those cuckold thrills that just don't compare to anything else.

The excitement from thinking about how wicked my sweet wife was being.

The buzz from knowing another man was getting a little taste of something that belonged to me.

That strange exhilaration of a dark taboo being explored — another man's erect cock wedged inside my wife's most personal place.

Somehow, though I heard them reach orgasm, I managed to avoid my own. The guest bedroom fell silent again. I debated whether to return to our own room, wondering if it was all over. As I waited, I found myself hoping they were done and that Juliette would come out. I even scampered quietly back into our own room, though I left the door open and lingered there in case Juliette did not immediately return.

She didn't come out at that point. I felt a pang of disappointment. After some minutes, I returned to my place outside their door, and could

quickly tell they had resumed sex.

The disappointment I felt was unexpected, though it was mixed in with residual excitement from hearing them going at it again. It wasn't so much that I was jealous but that I was envious of Cory's apparent ability to keep going — or to get back into it so soon if he'd already shot his load. That was the hallmark of cuckolding, however — it was one heck of a rollercoaster ride. There were ups, but there were also downs.

I was tired, I wanted my wife, I suddenly didn't want Cory to impress her so much that she decided a long-term relationship with him would be preferable to one with me.

As Juliette's moans became elevated again, I told myself she believed I was listening in — that her performance was partly for my own benefit. It wasn't just that he was so much better than me at sex.

Eventually, the disappointment wore off — or I learned to suppress it. The feelings of inadequacy faded in favor of the base thrill of hearing my wife having sex with somebody else. This time it took longer. I was jerking off but pacing myself because I had every intention of fucking my wife after Cory was done.

There was a moment where they really seemed to forget where they were and what they were up to — he was pounding into her, and they were both panting and gasping for breath.

If an ignorant, cuckolded husband had happened to wake up and stumble out to get a drink from the kitchen, he might even have thought some kind of earthquake was happening from the way the bed in that guest bedroom sounded.

I could tell when he came inside my wife. This time I knew full well both of them had climaxed. I could tell my wife wasn't faking it with him, too. I guess it was only natural to feel a little insecurity when another man was making your wife feel that good.

This time I did drift back to our bedroom. I lost my hard-on. I tried not to feel hurt by it all, but something bugged me more than it had before. I lay in bed pondering and came to the conclusion it was something about Jessie's warning. The sense that Cory would try to win Juliette from me

by tempting her with the picture of familial bliss. Planting the image in her head of a contented wife and two kids in some suburban box of a house.

I waited for an absolute age for Juliette to return to me. I fell asleep before she did.

I talked to Brian about it, naturally, since he's my voluntary therapist. I guess that works both ways, though.

We had lunch together, well away from the neighborhood of my office building. Brian was concerned about Cory's mind games.

'It's not good,' he said, straight out. His frank opinion made my stomach drop.

I think I'd hoped he would brush it all off, dismissing it as some insignificant matter, persuading me that Juliette would forget all about it after a few days and that she wouldn't just change her mind over something so serious because of what her ex-boyfriend said.

'There's a danger he's going to get under her skin with this,' he explained. 'He'll paint this picture in her mind of a completely different life — and, sure, she won't get to enjoy sleeping with other guys, but she'll have something else in her life entirely — kids.'

'You think it's a threat?'

'You can't afford to not think that way.'

Sigh. I said, 'It means accepting there's a possibility she might change her mind about having kids — or that she's already changed her mind.'

Brian nodded. 'You have to go with your feeling on this — and your feeling is that Juliette hasn't completely shot down the idea of someday having kids.'

Double sigh. Acting as my own Devil's Advocate, I pointed out, 'That was Jessie's feeling, too. I guess she wouldn't have come to warn me if it wasn't.'

'People change their minds — and the thing about wanting to have kids is, sometimes it just takes getting a little older to change somebody's feelings about it.'

I knew I couldn't just deny what he was saying — and what we were all feeling, it seemed.

Then Brian said, 'You're not your dad, Nick.'

It kind of made me do a cartoon-style double-take.

He said, 'You're tying your own opinion on this whole thing to your dad, and what he did to your family. But you're not him. You do things differently — you've already shown that.'

It's funny how a simple assumption can stick with you so powerfully just by accepting it and never questioning it.

'You're not,' he said, underlining his point. 'But you didn't need to prove it by trying to have kids — you've proven it already with your commitment to Juliette.'

I nodded and mulled it over through a bite of sandwich.

'You think I need to rethink my life,' I chuckled, trying to make light of it.

'I think... if Juliette comes to you someday and says she's changed her mind, that you shouldn't necessarily decide what you want based on what your dad did. Or this idea that you are somehow predestined to act the same way he did if you have kids.'

Annoyingly, I did feel Brian was right. And I felt that my signed, sealed, and delivered life strategy was now suddenly open to revision. The most annoying of all was the sense that Cory — dumb, handsome, big-dick jock Cory — had brought about this change.

'I'm better than my dad,' I said quietly.

'There you go,' Brian nodded.

I suddenly asked him, 'You really think she wants kids?'

He glanced off to the side. 'From everything you've said... and everything Jessie's said, I'd probably put money on it. If I was a betting man.'

I had some thinking to do, huh.

Brian looked at me. 'You may need to head him off at the pass,' he warned.

'Head him off — ?'

'There's danger if Juliette holds on to her assumption that you'd never change your mind on this. If Cory keeps talking about having a family with her... she may slowly accept that this is what she wants, and she wants it more than she wants you.'

It was a little shocking, but coming from a four-times married guy like Brian, I couldn't discount it. It hit me hard to think that Juliette could ever choose someone else over me, regardless of her motivations.

But I supposed that if I showed signs of not being her perfect husband in other ways, she would have the motivation to no longer have me as her husband.

'What're you saying?' I asked Brian. 'I need to just come out and say I want to have kids?'

He shrugged. 'I don't think you need to be that dramatic... maybe just drop a few hints, here and there. You know... suggest that you might be open to the idea after all. If that's where her heart lies, anyway.'

'Man, this is not shaping up the way I thought it would.'

'It's Cory. He really wants her back. He seems like he's willing to do whatever it takes, and that's dangerous.'

'You think he even wants to have kids?'

'Maybe, maybe not. Maybe he sees it as a way of keeping her, if he does get her.'

'I need to stop this.'

'It might be advisable.'

'It'll be difficult while he's living with us.'

For a few moments, both of us ate our lunch, contemplating the problem.

I said, perhaps overly flippantly, 'You ever talked to Jessie about having kids?'

He laughed. 'Uh... yeah. Already. Man. We've talked about getting engaged, getting married, where we want to retire to someday...'

I chuckled. 'That's got to be a good sign, right?'

He smiled. 'Yeah. I mean, I keep saying to her there's no rush... maybe she just wants a ring on her finger before she feels safe enough to use her hall pass. I don't want to pressure her.'

'Sounds about right. She'll get there when she's ready. I mean... I know Jess, she does get tempted by hot guys.'

Brian didn't seem like he needed to push Jessie into something she didn't want to do. I came away from lunch with him feeling like I needed to take a lesson from his patience. And yet if Cory was pressing Juliette with the idea of having kids, I feared patience wasn't necessarily going to help me.

In the evenings, she was out with Cory looking for apartments, or she was at the gym with him working out in tight, revealing sportswear.

At the weekends, he took her out dancing, he took her to cocktail bars with Becky and the rest of their former high school crowd.

I helped her relax after a few hours checking out new digs, or I washed her clean in the shower after she'd done her laps around the gym, or I waited at home while she texted me little details about dancing with Cory, about having fun with her friends.

At night during the week, I chatted with her until she was ready to sneak out of our bedroom to pay Cory a visit in his bed. I helped her to prepare for him. I waited and I listened as she slept with him. I made a conscious effort not to fall asleep before she returned from him.

At the weekend, I waited for her to return from her night out with him, ending with a session in his bed, and then she was mine again.

It would have been easy just to enjoy the benefits, and ignore all my insecurities. To focus on how much it turned me on that she was fucking him, and then me. To forget the part about him trying to steal her, trying to turn her against our marriage.

The thing was, she liked him. She liked spending time with him. She liked fucking him.

And I liked how she was when she was done fucking him.

Returning to my bed all hot and sweaty and reeking of sex, always horny for more, getting off on the idea of two guys fucking her in close succession. Murmuring filthy details of her tryst into my ear as she takes my throbbing hard-on inside her creamy, well-oiled pussy.

Even when I wasn't reclaiming her gorgeous body after he was finished with her, I liked other things about what was going on. How cheerful she was, most times of the day. Her sexy self-confidence, which translated into dressing a little more provocatively than she used to, was always fun to see — and also, as far as I could see, a more flirtatious manner with guys around her.

But Juliette's happiness and her willingness to fulfill my fantasy was, for now, pinned to her seeing Cory. She was comfortable doing this with him, and so I encouraged it.

I was like a moth fluttering around a lightbulb at night, just bewitched by it all.

Like an addict, I needed some kind of intervention to help me break from the easiest path.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.9)

by *Max Sebastian*



It was a cool Sunday morning as I trekked down to the CVS pharmacy over on 2nd Avenue, and the chill in the air only seemed to heighten the extraordinary anxiety that put ice into my veins.

I'd had a long chat with Juliette.

She'd missed her period.

It was sometimes pretty irregular, particularly when she exercised a lot — and recently she'd been attending the gym a lot, at least in part to keep up with the hectic sex schedule she'd signed up to having two horny men in her life. But it was never this irregular.

What if she was pregnant? Well, she was on birth control. But no form of birth control is one hundred percent effective — even condoms. We'd

Googled the effectiveness rate of the pill, and it was 99%, although allowing for mistakes that dropped to 93%.

Juliette had insisted she'd made no mistakes.

And I'd said, 'Even if we take the 99% effective rate, that still means one out of every 100 times you're going to get pregnant.'

I'd never even thought about that before. But now that I said it, it seemed a little disturbing.

'How many times have you had sex with Cory since he moved to New York?' I asked her.

She said, 'I don't think it works like that. It's not like you get pregnant once every hundred times you have sex.'

'So how does it work?'

I was a little tired after staying up late to wait for Juliette to come home after seeing Cory; I didn't get my tone right. I think she thought I was angry at her. I wasn't angry, actually, though I *was* a little freaked out about her missed period.

'I don't know... I think it's like... one out of every hundred couples?'

The truth was, neither of us knew what the effectiveness rate was based on. Google was too terrible at its core job these days to present us with anything but the same basic information published by various publications and plagiarists.

I got irritated at not being able to find the information I needed to explain what the effectiveness rate meant. Juliette thought I was angry at her for missing her period, so she got angry at me. Then I was irritated at her for getting angry at me, and we entered vicious circle territory.

Long story short, we had an argument.

And now I was wandering down to the pharmacy first thing on a Sunday morning to buy a pregnancy test.

Damn it. What if she *was* pregnant?

I had time to think about it as I wandered down E72nd Street that morning and entered an almost entirely empty CVS to search for pregnancy tests. I wasn't angry at Juliette — if she was pregnant then I would be as much to blame if not more so. I'd encouraged her to sleep with Cory. I'd gone along with the idea of them not using condoms because he'd tested clean and she was on birth control pills.

Sure, with hindsight, I had probably let it go on longer than I should have done.

After Cory had found a new apartment and moved out — that was probably the moment at which I should have said to Juliette that it was perhaps time to curtail that particular relationship. But I was totally hooked on her happiness and her regular adulterous sex — and she was totally comfortable continuing to see him and his massive dick.

Damn it.

I remember having a drink with Brian after work back when Juliette had first texted me to say they'd found him a new apartment. Something about her message had really bugged me.

'She says 'we've found an apartment,' I told Brian. 'Like it's not just an apartment for *him*, like it's for both of them.'

'Maybe it is,' Brian had said.

Juliette's next message detailed how fantastic the new apartment was, and it only bugged me more.

'She sounds way too happy about it,' I said, kind of joking but kind of not.

'Well, it means he's definitely sticking around,' Brian said.

'We knew that — his new job means he's sticking around.'

'Jobs can be changed. Leases last a year, at least.'

Anyway. That was probably the point at which I should have pressed Juliette to end it with Cory. Brian had even warned me that if I felt

Juliette was too happy that Cory had found an apartment she loved, it was a sign that that whole relationship needed to be shelved.

But I was so hooked on Juliette being happy.

I remember that particular evening, I'd been so annoyed by the tone of Juliette's text messages that I had cut short my time with Brian, apologizing for ending things so soon, and then headed straight home. Brian was sympathetic. He got how I was feeling.

I headed home without texting Juliette about my change of plans — partly because I felt I didn't need to, because I assumed she was still out looking at whatever apartment it was they'd finally decided to go for.

I needed a little time on my own, a little private space to figure out whether I would do as Brian advised and end things between Juliette and Cory.

But then when I arrived home and slid my key in the first of the three locks on our front door, I could hear from within our apartment a commotion that suggested I had arrived home unexpectedly just as Juliette and Cory had been in the middle of something.

If we didn't have a tricky deadbolt lock on our front door, I might even have caught them in the act — *in flagrante delecto*, as they say.

Oh shit.

As it was, when I did get inside the inner sanctum of our apartment, I was able to smell the clear scent of sex in the air, I could see the way the cushions had been cast off the couch by their copulative fever, and I saw both bedroom doors close simultaneously as the two of them finalized their rapid escape.

There was a moment of stillness where I just stood there by the front door, alone with my very sudden erection, luxuriating in the strange sensation of knowing my wife had been fucking another man right here, just seconds ago.

She might have fucked him so many times before, but it was still a thrill to me.

At that moment, I figured I had a choice to make: I could still officially catch them in the act. Or, I could pretend not to notice anything. In choice one, I could stand here and recognize the smell of sex in the humid air, see the unusual state of our couch — and even if I was only of average intelligence I could probably come to the conclusion that something scandalous had been going on here.

Damn it, I could even see a pair of Juliette's panties on the floor, only half hidden by a cushion.

Choice two would mean pretending to be an idiot. At that moment, it was the more tempting option for me because I was naturally one to avoid drama where I could. Aren't most people? Pausing to think about it that long made it the more obvious choice, too. A man who suddenly discovered his wife had been having an affair didn't usually pause this long to think about it.

Then the door to our bedroom opened cautiously, and there was Juliette wearing her bathrobe, looking sweaty, flushed, beautifully freshly-fucked.

'Hey honey,' she said quietly, pretending to be relaxed though she was apparently still catching her breath. 'I thought you were out with Brian tonight.'

I smiled as though I needed to reassure her. 'He wasn't feeling so great, so...'

'Oh,' she had nodded, and casually wandered over to give me a little kiss by way of greeting.

As our lips touched, I inhaled a warm waft that reeked of sex. I felt a little shiver of exhilaration.

'I was just... at the gym...' Juliette said, a little more loudly than she needed to — I guessed so that Cory would hear her excuse-slash-explanation.

'Oh, right,' I said, also a little louder than I needed to speak. Emphasizing calm and acceptance.

Juliette picked up a few cushions, straightened the couch, saying, 'I was just about to hop in the shower...'

I nodded. Her smile and the twinkle in her eyes told me she knew I'd basically caught them in the act. That I knew they'd just been fucking on this couch.

I picked up her panties as though to confirm outright that I knew. She giggled silently as I pressed them to my face to inhale the scent of her pussy, demonstrating to her that this was what was on my mind after almost catching them in the act.

We went into the bedroom, Juliette switched on the shower, and then I buried my face in her sweet pussy. I forgot all about wanting her to end things with Cory. I couldn't help myself. She was just so sexy after she'd just had sex with somebody else. That irresistible sheen of sweat on her skin. The gentle funk of another man's odor on her body.

'Do you need to go in there and finish him off?' I asked her in between lapping at her juicy pussy.

'Mmm...' she moaned at my tongue delving inside her. 'I think he'd be suspicious of me going in there to continue fucking him now you're here.'

I said, 'I could make some excuse to leave for a short while — are we short of milk, eggs?'

But she had put her hands firmly on my head, locking me there between her warm thighs. 'Don't go,' she breathed, 'I need you here right now.'

I loved that she wanted me, that in that moment she needed my mouth on her sex, she needed me to make her come. She finished up by sitting on my face, grinding her pussy against my mouth until she was shaking like a leaf in a hurricane.

We finished up in the shower — Juliette telling me how Cory had been fucking her on the couch, and me vaguely reenacting it by slotting into her from behind, grabbing hold of her hair — carefully — as I thrust into her.

'He likes to do that?' I asked her afterward as we lay in bed, pondering how long Juliette should wait before Cory might believe I was asleep and it was safe for her to return to him to resume their adultery.

'He doesn't hurt me,' she insisted.

'But that... gets him going? Pulling your hair when he's fucking you.'

'I guess it makes him feel powerful or something.'

'You like him being powerful?'

'Uh-huh,' she'd grinned. So content with things.

I would do anything to keep her happy like that. I guess that's why I just sat on my hands and let her go on seeing Cory. I'd made my choice — I wanted it to continue. I helped the guy move into his new apartment, lifted some of the heavier boxes for him. For *them*.

And now here we were a few weeks later, and Juliette was about to pee on a stick to find out whether one of us had gotten her pregnant.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.10)

by *Max Sebastian*



Negative, negative, negative.

Negative.

Positive.

I saw Juliette's face light up at that last test result out of the five kits we'd bought, and I knew my whole plan for not having children would have to change.

'But four negative tests,' I said. 'Those things are pretty accurate. And four out of five...'

'They're accurate, but not one hundred percent accurate, right?'

'I don't know... says here... 99%... 99%... they're pretty much all 99%.'

'So you're telling me there's a chance?' She was quoting an old Jim Carry movie she'd loved since childhood. Well, it showed her putting a brave face on things, I guess. But the truth was out — Juliette did want kids. And I was in the way.

She said, 'It was the last test I took...'

I raised an eyebrow at that. 'And how long was it between test number four and that last test?'

She looked at her phone. 'About 45 minutes.'

We'd taken some breaks between tests. Biology stopped play. Juliette had peed a little on one test and couldn't hold the rest of her reserves. She'd done a second test straight away and then we'd had to do things differently after that.

The first test had been straight negative. When the second test came in negative, she said she'd rushed it because she'd really needed to pee, and had nearly peed herself while we had simply struggled to get the damn thing out of the packet.

But then we took breaks in between tests. She'd been drinking a ton of water all morning.

'Maybe three and four were negative because I drank so much water,' was her next theory.

'I can't believe that,' I said.

'They test my hormone levels, right? So I drank a load of water, and that meant my hormones were diluted.'

Did I tell you my wife is a good lawyer?

'But what about that first test?'

'But what about that last test?'

Damn it. Okay, so say you discounted the middle three tests on the grounds that they weren't done under the right conditions... she'd been

drinking just as much water ahead of that fifth test. But that didn't help my argument.

'Should I get more tests?' I asked her.

'I think I need to see my doctor.'

We were so nervous ahead of that doctor's appointment. I believe we were both nervous for different reasons — and I also believed our strident hopes were for polar opposite outcomes.

But when I thought about it — and there was plenty of opportunity to think about it — it was a little more complicated than that she was hoping she was pregnant, and I was hoping she wasn't.

If the doctor told her she wasn't pregnant, I was fairly sure Juliette would be disappointed. Perhaps even upset. I didn't want that.

If the doctor told her she was pregnant, then we'd have to face the question of paternity.

This was the first time I'd gone with Juliette to attend a doctor's appointment. It felt weird and, somehow, grown-up. Maybe it was another box to tick on the maturity chart. Went with my wife to see a doctor about the prospect of having kids. Check.

Anyway. I did sit in the waiting room during the actual appointment. I felt eyes on me while I waited — others wondering why a couple would come see a doctor together, and then the guy sat in the waiting room anyway. I felt myself being judged. Have I given her an STD? Are we an unmarried couple seeking a termination? Is this an extended walk of shame right before their eyes.

Damn.

I felt this hot, sweaty sense of embarrassment for no reason. My hairline all prickly, and everything.

Well, okay, I guess there was the issue that my wife was fucking two different men at the moment.

But other than that, I felt the judgment was unreasonable. I wanted to stand up and say, yes, I am married to that woman, and no, I haven't given her herpes.

Maybe I was just being paranoid again.

Juliette emerged after a grueling 35 minutes, looking distinctly downhearted. I felt a shameful flutter of hopeful optimism, since I was fairly sure she would not respond to a positive pregnancy test with this kind of glum body language.

She just glanced into my eyes and sighed, and I knew that at least we didn't have to worry about the paternity issue just now.

We took a taxi home, even if it wasn't far. We didn't talk the whole way back — I just held her hand, giving it the occasional squeeze to try to remind her she wasn't alone in this.

It wasn't until we were back inside the safe confines of our apartment that I asked her what happened.

'So what did she say?'

'That if we want to, we could start trying,' she said, looking at me with a pleading in her eyes.

'So you're definitely not — ?'

She shook her head. 'They're doing a blood test just to be sure, but she said the urine test was pretty definitive.'

'Our positive test...?'

'She said it's possible to misread that kind of pregnancy test. That one wasn't the best brand. Or... maybe it was past its expiry date or something.'

I nodded, trying to seem vaguely dispirited to fit in with her mood, even though I was highly relieved that my wife wasn't going to be having a baby with another man.

'Did you tell her... everything?' I asked her. I probably shouldn't have been sensitive to the possibility of being judged by Juliette's doctor, but I guess I was.

Juliette said, 'I told her we were using birth control, but not condoms. And that we weren't actively trying to have children at the moment.'

Her tone was a touch defiant — like she probably suspected she shouldn't keep the full truth from her personal doctor, but she hadn't felt the need to open up about her sexual behavior.

'Well, that's all true enough,' I said.

Juliette sighed again before taking a deep breath as if she just wanted to put this behind her. She said, 'She said if I'm disappointed by the result, we could just stop using birth control and actually try to have a baby.'

I nodded. I'd felt this might be coming.

I said, 'I'm not against the idea of having children, Juliette. If you want to have children.'

I made it as clear as I could. Her face brightened considerably.

'But you've always said...' she said, playing Devil's Advocate.

'I've changed my mind. Something Brian said... well. I don't need to be like my father.'

She came over to me, put her arms around me, and kissed me.

After that, I said, 'If you're going to sleep with any other guy, I want you to wear condoms.'

I was fairly firm about that new requirement. She nodded her agreement, though she knew it would mean saying something to Cory about our change of policy.

She said, 'We don't have to have kids right away, just so you know.'

I gave her a squeeze. 'We should make a plan.'

She had an argument with Cory.

She told him about the pregnancy scare, and that she went to the doctor — she felt obligated to tell him the truth on that. When she stated our new policy that they had to use condoms, he started to persuade her that they didn't need to use condoms — that she should just stop using birth control, and they should start a family right now.

I have to say I was a little surprised at him. I mean, it wasn't just that he wanted her for himself. He must have been really in love with her.

I felt a little sorry for him, even though he was pressuring my wife to leave me and start a family with him.

Being some other woman, Juliette could have fallen for it, too. He was really tugging on her heartstrings about having kids now. He knew how disappointed she was at the negative result, even if she had been playing it down.

But Juliette said she wanted to make a three-year plan, and that if she had the choice, which she now did, she would choose to get all her affairs in order before making that kind of a life change.

'You need to get *all* your affairs in order?' I joked when she came back to tell me about his reaction. 'That mean you're having affairs I don't know about?'

'No,' she grinned. 'But maybe I should try some other ones before we make the move to become parents.'

We were lying on the couch when she said this, and she'd been casually stroking my thigh. But now she saw the bulge in my pants swell visibly before her very eyes.

'I think somebody likes *that* idea...' she giggled.

I loved it so much that she was back to her happy self. But I needed to know what had gone down with Cory.

'So you guys argued because he wanted kids so badly?' I asked her.

She shook her head. 'I mentioned that you came with me to my doctor's appointment, and that seemed to offend him. And then he asked if you were suspicious about why I'd believe I might be pregnant, and...'

'He was upset that we're still having sex?'

She nodded. 'I guess... I've lulled him into the idea that our sex life isn't what it was... and it's gradually gotten to the point that he believes we're not really having sex at all.'

'He's jealous of me?'

'He's not so great about sharing.'

I nodded. I can't say I wasn't pleased.

'So how did you leave things with him?'

She sighed. 'I told him I love my husband. I don't intend to leave my husband. That if he wants to see me again... well, it would just be about having a little fun now and again, you know?'

I kissed her, long and slow, showing her how impressed I was with her. How much I loved her.

But after a moment she pulled back and said, 'I... may have let slip that you know what happened between me and him.'

Okay, that was new.

'That I was okay about it?' I asked her.

She shrugged. 'I think he said something about lying to you all this time, about the fact that I'd never have a happy marriage if we had that secret between us.'

'Oh, but he'd have a happy marriage with you if you'd been out-and-out cheating on your previous husband?' I said, getting a little angry about my rival.

She sighed again. 'Well... I think he put two and two together and realized that first night... at the reunion... maybe you weren't as

completely drunk as we thought you were...'

I felt an odd little churn in my stomach — anxiety. Somebody else knew our secret, but somebody who wasn't entirely to be trusted.

'Does he think I'm some kind of freak?'

She gave me an affectionate squeeze. 'It doesn't matter what he thinks.'

But I got the impression that Cory didn't think much of me now, if he ever did.

'Maybe you should... take a break from seeing him,' I said, my tone a little more firm than my words.

She agreed with me, though her body language suggested she was hiding some of her emotions. She was more upset about losing Cory than she wanted me to fully appreciate.

We didn't have sex. Her period had arrived, after all, and she wasn't really in the mood.

But after she texted her BFF about what had happened, Jessie declared that she was going to take her for a Girls' Night Out to cheer her up, and she was fairly adamant that they were going to get laid.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.11)

by *Max Sebastian*



They came home disappointingly early and surprisingly drunk.

Giggling a lot.

'What happened?' I could see the hope on Brian's face, but also the realization that coming home at just past 11pm on a Saturday night did not suggest much had happened.

'She kissed someone!' Juliette declared, like it was one huge achievement.

'Well, that's something,' Brian chuckled. 'How was it?'

'Weird,' Jessie said as our tipsy blondes collapsed on the couch between us. 'I can't believe how weird it is to touch another guy now...'

Juliette laughed and said to Brian, 'I don't know what you've done to her, but this is not the Jessie I know.'

I squeezed my wife, and she leaned in to kiss me. I could taste the alcohol on her lips — and I could feel how tipsy she was in her movement and the fact that while we were kissing, she shoved a hand onto my crotch to grope my swelling manhood.

'What about you?' I asked her. 'You must have managed something?'

She grinned. 'It is a little freaky doing it with a complete stranger.'

'There was one guy you liked,' Jessie said.

'Yeah, but then we were dancing and he touched me — and he had these big flapping hands...'

'I thought having big hands was a good sign,' I said.

'If you know what to do with them,' Juliette said.

I said to Jessie, 'I thought you were going to get her laid?'

Jessie shrugged. 'It's not as easy as you think. I mean... once you find the right guy... it's hard to get out of the mindset that this is the only one for you...'

She and Brian seemed to fall into each other's besotted gaze, and I could see he was thrilled by how much they were in love, even if it was making the cuckolding part so surprisingly difficult.

When he flashed me a glance, I got the sense that he was weighing up whether it was even worth pushing the fantasy at this point.

I could see Jessie was afraid of disappointing him, however, and she now said, 'I just need some... I don't know... practice...'

Then they were kissing, and it was so sweet that you couldn't help but think maybe they just needed to wait a while before trying anything outside the realms of monogamy, even if the prospect of Jessie seeing other guys as well had originally been the thing that brought them together.

I stole another taste of Juliette's sweet lips but then said, 'Maybe we need to find you another ex.'

She giggled. 'That might make it seem less weird.'

We offered them some of the best of the craft beer that was left, but they both screwed up their faces at that suggestion and got up to find something a little stronger in the kitchen. When they returned, they were bearing tequila, lemons, and salt.

'Seriously?' I said, but hell, it was the weekend, and none of us had to get to work the next day.

And actually, it gave Brian and I the chance to catch up with their levels of inebriation and turn the evening into more of a party. I felt like celebrating — it did feel like Juliette was ready to move on from Cory. We didn't talk about him once.

It was fun — we put on some music, there was even a little dancing.

I couldn't help but enjoy how tipsy Juliette was. She was even more amorous than usual — clinging onto me, manhandling me, groping me, making out with me. It felt so good, and when I looked over at the others, it seemed like Jessie was being the same way with Brian.

I had every expectation that our friends would make their excuses very soon and head off for some privacy. Jessie had all but moved in with Brian, but her old apartment was still fairly nearby and leased for another few weeks.

But the dancing — and the making out continued.

It took me a while to realize that they were doing this with a particular sense of purpose. When Juliette led me to the couch to continue our fun without the need to continue standing up, I saw Jessie and Brian were already canoodling on the armchair.

As close as we were with Jessie and Brian, public displays of affection had always been limited to the occasional smooch. But this seemed like our women were trying to push our boundaries, as though it might help them progress to the next step in the cuckolding fantasy.

It did feel a little weird at first, I guess. But as Juliette sat on my lap and ground her pussy against my hard-on through our clothes, I was soon distracted from that initial weirdness.

I tried to concentrate on the enjoyable sweetness of my gorgeous wife's kiss and of how good she felt in a dress, which offered fairly easy access for my hands to move up and under it.

I even managed to slip a careful hand inside her soaking-wet panties, and I swear she nearly came as I touched her there.

*

When a somewhat flushed and obviously exhilarated Juliette quietly knelt down between my thighs and started yanking down my jeans and underwear, I was a little surprised.

But I glanced over at the others to see Jessie already in the same position with Brian, her head in his lap, slowly bobbing up and down.

My eyes briefly connected with his, and he gave me a kind of 'what're you gonna do?' shrug. I smiled and returned my gaze to my horny wife.

What did it matter? Brian and I talked about sex enough, and shared pretty intimate details. What was the big deal if something NSFW happened in his presence?

And I had to hope this might constitute 'practice' that could help both Juliette and Jessie to eventually find satisfaction in other men's beds.

I stifled a groan as I felt Juliette take the tip of my cock into her hot mouth. This was going to take some getting used to, even though it was kind of hot doing something like this in front of other people. Juliette clutched at the base of my cock with both hands as she worked the upper few inches with her lips and tongue.

It felt so good, and I definitely warmed to the more public nature of it.

But how far were we going to take this?

I'll admit the dark, deviant cuckold part of me wanted to go further and further — and let the others see everything. This fantasy was ever the

tangle of conflicted feelings, of course. Right now, I was combatting the strangeness of feeling like I wanted Brian to desire my wife while also respecting that he was my best friend these days and that it might very well turn out to be awkward and weird if anything happened between him and Juliette.

Plus, I knew Brian was just like me. I didn't feel the need to sleep with Jessie, and I didn't think Brian felt the need to sleep with Juliette. For us, the big draw was seeing our wives with others.

And yet, here in our apartment, there was definitely a feeling of closeness between us all — and a clear sense of safety.

When Juliette paused so I wouldn't end up coming too soon, I almost thought she was getting the idea to swap places with Jessie.

As she turned to pour another round of tequila shots for us all, I felt a little self-conscious sitting there, so exposed in front of our friends. I attempted to conceal myself with my hands. This was a little out of the ordinary, even for us.

Brian seemed to do likewise as Juliette offered more booze, and Jessie turned to pick up her shot glass from the coffee table.

We all knocked back our drinks and winced at the burn of the alcohol as it went down. But it did seem to help dampen the nerves.

'I have an idea,' Juliette said, pouring yet another round of tequila immediately after the last. 'We could practice right now. Just us.'

'Just us?' Jessie gasped, and her eyes briefly flicked to me, before bashfully veering away.

I couldn't help but be a little shocked by Juliette's suggestion. I guess we all were.

'What?' Juliette said, smiling broadly. 'No one outside this room needs to know.'

Brian looked at me and raised his eyebrows, but I flashed him a kind of *hey, maybe it won't be such a big deal* smile, and the tension in his

bearing seemed to ease off at least a little.

Feeling the need to pull her back from the precipice of pure hedonism, I said apologetically to Juliette, 'Maybe we need to talk about this...?'

I mean, I was happy for her to fool around with Brian if she wanted to, but I wasn't so sure how it would feel for me to do anything with Jessie. As attractive as she was, that wasn't what any of this this was about.

Juliette said, 'I know it might seem a little weird between us... but... look, if we made you guys wear blindfolds...'

'Blindfolds?' said everyone but Juliette.

'Hear me out — if you guys wear blindfolds, we can practice on you, and you'll never know who's doing what at any one time. So that'll make it less weird.' She beamed like she'd solved global hunger.

But Brian said, 'We'll still be able to tell who's who without being able to see.' I was just about to say that, too.

Juliette shrugged. 'Not if we take steps to make it as difficult for you as possible.'

'Steps?' I said.

But Jessie was already on her feet, urging Juliette to go with her somewhere, as though she already knew what Juliette had in mind.

I looked at Brian again, and we both kind of shrugged our shoulders and accepted that our womenfolk clearly had some agenda, so why fight it?

*

They made it into a game. I don't know if you'd call it a party game or a drinking game, but it was definitely a party, and we were drinking a ton.

There were challenging aspects to it, too.

For one thing, the women decided to tie both me and Brian to kitchen chairs — naked — as well as blindfold us. For another thing, we had to

wait there, trussed up like we'd been taken hostage in a bank heist, as they went off to get themselves ready to play.

'Were you ever into bondage?' Brian joked as we sat there.

'Not like this,' I laughed, trying to wiggle my face to check whether I could shift the blindfold enough to see anything. I couldn't. The sleeping mask-scarf-necktie combination they'd used on us was surprisingly effective.

On the plus side, I didn't feel too self-conscious about my buddy being able to see me sitting there naked, my manhood somewhat shrunken now that it wasn't receiving any attention.

'We're still going to know which one is which,' I said.

'Yup,' he agreed.

'You're okay with all this?'

'I guess. If you are. Maybe it'll help her... I mean... if she gets some practice with someone she knows...'

I agreed. 'If Juliette can just see beyond Cory...'

We heard the shower start up in our bathroom, and it made us both groan because as long as it was already taking the women to get ready for this, a shower meant it would take even longer.

'What're they doing in there?'

Brian said, 'Trying to make it so we won't be able to tell which one is which.'

He sounded amused. I guess it reassured me, made me care less that it was taking them ages to prepare. I was getting at least a little excited at the prospect of Juliette doing something with my friend. As weird as that was when you thought about it.

Brian, of all people.

Still, I guess it was kind of sexy to think of Jessie 'practicing' on me, too. I even felt the compersive thrill of knowing how Brian might feel knowing Jessie was getting to play with another guy, even if that guy was me.

Anyway. It seemed like an age before we heard the shower finally shut off, and then the door to the bathroom opened.

'Okay, we're ready,' Juliette announced as they approached to play the game.

I could hear their gentle footfalls on the hardwood floor of our living room and detect Juliette's shampoo scent in the air.

They had taken a shower and used the same bathroom products to attempt to disguise their scents.

Physically, the two of them were fairly similar — at least in build. Fairly petite, not exactly busty, but perky and fairly athletic. As I thought about them, I suspected that Juliette's hair was a little longer than Jessie's. Maybe Jessie had slightly more cleavage, but being tied to a chair was going to restrict my ability to determine those kinds of details about them.

'You okay?' we heard Juliette ask quietly, and it seemed like she was asking Jessie, not us. Then she did ask us if we were ready.

'Uh-huh,' I said, and Brian said something similar.

'Okay. Let's play.'

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.12)

by *Max Sebastian*



'Before we begin,' Juliette said, 'we need to get a couple of rules straight.'

'Okay,' I said.

'Sure,' added Brian. I was shivering a little. It wasn't because it was cold but because of nervous apprehension and the sense that I really didn't know what was coming. Sitting there on one of our kitchen chairs, blindfold securely fastened to block out all light, and with my wrists tightly bound behind my back using the cord from Juliette's bathrobe, I felt a little vulnerable.

Someone could drop something in my lap, and I wouldn't have any ability to protect myself. Sure, I trusted our two captors, but that didn't dispel the innate feeling of insecurity.

'Firstly, if anyone wants everything to pause at any time, we can address something they're not enjoying for any reason, call out the safety word.'

'Which is?' Brian prompted.

'Lemons.'

'Okay,' we all agreed. I'm not sure how Juliette decided on 'lemons,' but it was probably as good as anything.

'Second rule,' Juliette said solemnly, 'is no talking — unless you really have to say the safe word.'

'No talking?' I said, wondering why we had to take a vow of silence to play this game.

'We don't want anyone to say anything that might identify who is doing what to whom. It's easier if we have no talking.'

'So we're not allowed to even guess who is doing what?'

Juliette insisted, 'No guesses, no speculation, no detective work. Nothing.'

'Oh.' My tone made it clear I thought that would take some of the fun out of the experience.

Juliette said, 'This isn't a game about working out who is who, who is doing what, and to whom. It's about helping Jessie get comfortable with ethical non-monogamy...'

Ethical non-monogamy. Juliette was such a lawyer.

Brian pointed out, 'You know we'll be trying to work it out, though. Like, the whole time.'

From the sound of amusement in his voice, it seemed like he didn't have any problem sharing Jessie with me during this game. That felt fairly reassuring. I guess I didn't have a problem sharing Juliette with him, even if it would take a little getting used to since that idea hadn't really been part of our friendship.

Juliette told him, 'We obviously can't tell you what to think. But if you figure anything out, you'll just have to keep it to yourself, or you'll spoil it for everyone else.'

Well, that put a kibosh on any pushback. If we said anything about who was doing what, we'd spoil the game for everyone else.

Well, okay. I didn't entirely agree with the idea, and I didn't entirely understand the need for it, but I didn't have a problem with trying it.

'Okay?' Juliette said.

'Okay,' I said, and I heard both Brian and Jessie confirm that they were on board, too.

Then Juliette said, 'Right... so you guys should know from the get-go that anything could happen between anyone. We're not imposing limits beyond common sense, so if anyone has any objections or wants to set any boundaries, this is your last chance to speak up.'

Silence.

'Okay. Well, have fun!'

Thus, we had an agenda for our meeting.

*

It didn't take long before I saw why the no-identification rule had been imposed — and why the women took pains to avoid talking and other activities that might give the game away about who was doing what.

From the very beginning, I was trying to figure out who was who and who was doing what. It was only natural.

Even while Juliette had been laying out the rules, and the others were agreeing to them, I was trying to ascertain where their voices were coming from, where Juliette was in the room, where Jessie was. It wasn't even something I consciously decided to do — it was just how my brain worked.

Of course, I was never going to keep track of where everyone went from here. I could hardly sit there and monitor the shuffling of feet on our hardwood floor, attempting to link those sounds to the original base positions of their voices before all fell silent, and keep tabs on them through the evening.

But I had thought I'd have a general sense of who was doing what to me at any particular time. How wrong I was.

I'm pretty sure I started out guessing correctly.

For example, when the first one of them came to stand in front of me, lean over, and reach to kiss my lips, I figured it was Jessie because of the tentative nature of her kiss — and the tremor of nerves in her breathing.

I was actually impressed that it was Jessie who would kiss me first. Perhaps that was by design — because we would expect them to start by warming up with their respective partners.

And when they switched, I could tell that Juliette was next because she was so much more confident in how she approached me and how she kissed me.

Later, though, as Jessie gained confidence, that aspect of her performance disappeared and it became much more difficult to tell who was who at any point. It quickly became clear to me that the women were not only physically similar but also seemed to have some of the same techniques.

Could it be that they had developed their skills together, either on each other or with the same kind of guys — presumably while they were at college together?

Of course, there were moments when I was suddenly sure that the woman I was with was either Juliette or Jessie. Occasional things jumped out at me to identify them along the way — a moan here, a movement there. It might be something that struck me as being familiar and suggested it was Juliette currently doing something with me. Or something that seemed like nothing Juliette would typically do, in which case I would ascertain it was Jessie.

All the way through, it was remarkable how well they mimicked each other.

They'd come out of the bathroom with much the same scent — they'd both showered with the same products, both spritzed with Juliette's perfume. However, there were times I was sure I could detect my wife's underlying personal scent, or one that was less familiar. Jessie's breasts were a little larger, and occasionally, I'd have the sensation of them brushing against me or pressing against me, and I would form a judgment using that aspect.

But any moment I started to think I had an idea who was with me, they would switch places — sometimes doubling back on themselves — and I would lose track again. And they did switch places quite frequently, and apparently entirely randomly.

It was like watching that magic trick where you have to choose which of three up-turned cups hides the ball, and try as you might, you just cannot follow it as the magician keeps switching the cups around.

After a while, I found I just stopped caring who was who. I stopped trying to work it out.

I just enjoyed this sexy game of two different women playing with me while I could see nothing and touch nothing with my hands.

*

They began tentatively, cautiously.

Someone sat between my knees and started gently stroking my thighs. I felt a little self-conscious, a little vulnerable. But I also had that curious ASMR sensation from knowing that whoever was sitting there on the floor was gazing upon me and, I assume, enjoying the sight of my naked body.

The touch of her hands on my legs suggested desire, certainly.

It could have been Jessie getting used to handling another man after becoming so absorbed by her relationship with Brian. It could have been Juliette pretending to be Jessie.

The sense of her providing me with her attention was enough to get my manhood up to full hardness. I heard her let out a little sigh of delight as her hands moved up to my crotch, seemingly framing my stiff cock as she stared at it.

There was a pause as, I suspected, the women changed places.

Now, someone else was touching me — or was it the same woman? Her hands sweeping over my thighs, then dancing over my bare torso, my chest, my arms. Seeming to revel in her power over me, in the fact that she could possess me, use me as she liked.

She seemed to consciously avoid touching my cock, at least for now. But I felt her lean in to place little kisses on my stomach, and her body brushed against my hardness — her breasts, perhaps. Her warm, soft skin.

Another change between them. There were pauses as they did it, periods I sat there and just had to wait for more attention. I guess it was part of the experience, part of the drama. The building suspense.

One of them seemed to reverse into me, placing her hands on my knees, touching her body down against my throbbing cock like she was performing a lap dance on me in a gentleman's club. Juliette? Jessie? My initial thought was Juliette because my wife would have the confidence to do it, though she'd never done something like that to me before as far as I could remember.

But then they switched again — or didn't — and after the related pause, it happened again. Was that the same woman as before?

I felt her pussy touch against my cock — the women were naked, then, too, now. I reacted to the intense heat of her sex pressing against my shaft, wondering whether it was my wife or her best friend. If it was my wife, then had she done the same thing to Brian? If it was her best friend, then was that the first time another woman's sex had touched my body since I'd met Juliette six years before?

There were quite a few pauses to begin with. The women moving around, switching places, dancing around us, jubilant in their power over us and their access to us. Tying with us. Teasing us. Running their hands

over our bodies, brushing their bodies gently against ours. Dotting us with occasional little kisses here and there.

Then came the making out.

Jessie the first to kiss my mouth, I thought. It was only brief that first time. I liked kissing her, though if I was right about who it was, she was very similar to my wife in technique. I liked to think it was Jessie because it made me feel she was getting into this. She was going to make Brian's fantasy come true, and I knew how thrilling that would be for him.

It was also sexy to kiss a woman as attractive as Jessie, of course. Even if I couldn't see her.

After a brief moment, they switched places, and I was definitely kissing a different woman. She draped herself on me, pressed her lips to mine, kissed me a little more forcefully.

Another change. The first woman — a little more forceful now, though. Had Juliette shown her what to do, and now she was trying to be more confident in her manner?

I enjoyed tasting her lips, the sweet sensation of her tongue probing my mouth. The little moans as we kissed so tenderly. There were more changes. Each time, we seemed to have longer to explore our kiss, but each time, I felt like I was getting further and further away from knowing who was kissing me.

I lost count; I lost track.

Were they doing the exact same thing with Brian?

One thing I could definitely tell — though it was usually difficult to distinguish who was who, I could definitely tell that there were two different women giving me their attention from time to time. It wasn't just one woman making out with me and occasionally pretending to switch with the other. I could tell from the differences in their breathing, the rhythm of their movement, the lightness of their touches.

It meant even when I couldn't identify the person with me, there was sharing going on. I knew my wife was being naughty with another guy as well as with me. And that I was fulfilling Brian's fantasy with Jessie.

*

I don't know how long things were taking, but nobody seemed to be in any rush. I enjoyed the gentle, playful touches and all the making out, the way they were clearly getting more and more comfortable with this game, and more and more confident in their manner toward us.

Juliette seemed to be doing her best to pretend to be Jessie, and vice versa, so they progressed as one, from tentative touching and cautious making out to a more full-on exploration of our bodies and more passionate kissing.

Hands eventually found their way to my cock — first brushing against it, then purposefully touching it, stroking it, gripping it, squeezing it, pumping it.

It felt like I was having a sensual massage, but the masseuse wasn't sure whether I wanted a happy ending, so she kept edging very gradually toward it, step by step — constantly on alert for any hint that I wanted her to stop.

Then I felt her hot breath on my shaft, and I felt a fresh burst of arousal. It was sexy to think of my wife's best friend practicing her cuckolding on me. The pretty blonde I'd known for so long was being wicked with my cock. But along with the natural excitement of having somebody new slipping the tip of my cock into her mouth, I could think about my wife doing the same to my friend. I could think about the excitement my friend experiencing knowing that his sweetheart was being wicked with another man, too.

I guess I thought it was Jessie who took my cock into her mouth first. I couldn't be sure, however.

It was only for a few moments, and then she withdrew, placing her hands on my thighs to push herself back up to her feet — only for another woman to take her place. They did feel slightly different, though I still couldn't pin down exactly who was who.

Was my wife the one who sucked a little harder, and used her hands to squeeze my cock rather than to caress and explore my body? It could have been.

Whoever it was at any one time, it was the slowest and longest blowjob I'd ever had. Tantric, you might say. It lasted for ages and was quite the most sensual oral attention I'd ever experienced. The gentle lips caressing my hardness, the flick of her tongue — even the mere heat of her breath on my sensitive tip could drive me wild.

As I lay back and let myself just indulge in the physical sensations of it all, I could hear Brian in the background groaning in pleasure. It seemed to confirm that he was getting the same treatment as I was and that periodically, it would be my wife doing that with him.

I thought about my wife filling her mouth with another man's cock, and I had to keep myself from shooting my seed too early into whichever mouth was presently servicing my manhood.

*

There were lots of little breaks — as the women changed places, as they progressed with things so slowly.

Sometimes, I could hear them whispering to each other while they were switching between us, and it seemed they were trading tips, sharing advice, and making suggestions.

After one particularly long break, one of them knelt between my thighs once again and began playing with my somewhat flaccid manhood — and from the sound of it, delighted at how it stiffened in her hands — and to my surprise I felt another pair of hands touch my shoulders.

Then one of them leaned in and whispered to me, 'Hi,' before giving me a soft little kiss on the lips.

I suspected it was Jessie because of the way she said 'hi' before kissing me — though the evidence for my suspicions was hardly concrete. But now, to my surprise, I had two women on me — one bobbing down on my cock while the other sucked on my lips and slipped her tongue in my mouth.

Poor Brian was all on his lonesome.

I waited until whoever was kissing me came up for air, and then I whispered, 'Brian's going to get cold.'

Jessie — I believe it was her — giggled and gave another little sweet kiss before whispering back, 'Brian's fine.'

She withdrew, and I assumed she would now head over to keep Brian simmering. But instead, I felt one of her hands trail down my body, and then both women seemed to be kneeling between my thighs — sharing my cock between them.

Nothing like this had ever happened to be before.

I was about to say something, asking whether Brian was okay, whether leaving him on his own was part of the game. But then Juliette spoke up.

She said, 'Okay, new rule. If we're both on one of you at the same time, the other one gets to watch.'

I heard Jessie giggle at that.

I said, 'You took Brian's blindfold off?'

Juliette said curtly, 'No *talking*.'

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.13)

by *Max Sebastian*



I was sitting tied to a kitchen chair while my wife and her best friend shared oral duties on my cock. Not something I thought would ever happen, but such is life.

It did feel a little different now I knew that they had just taken off my friend Brian's blindfold, and he was now watching as his girlfriend was now playing with my cock along with my wife.

But I knew Brian was like me. I knew he'd get a kick out of seeing Jessie toying with another man's equipment. So once I got over the vague unease of knowing my friend could see me naked — and erect — it wasn't so bad. I didn't need to feel guilty that his sweet girlfriend was touching me so intimately.

I could even feel that little altruistic buzz of knowing that I was helping him fulfill his fantasy and letting Jessie practice on someone friendly

before she went out into the wide world and started cuckolding Brian with other men.

I think the women were behaving slightly differently now that they had taken off Brian's blindfold.

Perhaps it was because they were both attending to the same man now, or maybe it was because this was the first time Jessie had done anything significant with another man while Brian was watching.

The two of them were more playful as they dealt with me — and definitely more giggly.

They were making it seem more lighthearted, more like a game than just a sexual experience. It kept down the tension and kept anything from getting too heavy. They made it feel like we were just fooling around; there could be nothing to worry about — and if someone decided they should stop, it wouldn't be such a big deal.

Here was one of them kneeling between my thighs, gripping my cock at the base, taking my hardness into her mouth, and I could hear the other one nearby because of her laughing.

Then the one who had been sucking me withdrew and offered my cock to the other one to take into her mouth.

You might have thought that the giggling and laughing would allow me to distinguish between the two women. To my mild surprise, it did not. Their laughs were so similar that you couldn't tell between them. It was probably because they knew each other so well and had been BFFs for so long.

But in those moments when they swapped my cock between them, I knew Brian was watching his sweetheart being so naughty with another guy, and I could sense his excitement, even without being able to see him.

And it did flatter my ego, having two women enjoying my cock at the same time.

One of them holding my cock for the other one to suck. Switching over so the other one was cupping my balls while the other one took charge of my cock.

Lots of giggling when they both tried to use their mouths on me at the same time, one at the tip, one at my shaft, or pressing my cock between their mouths.

It did feel so good, particularly when one of them took me deep into her hot mouth and started a nice rhythm, caressing my length with the inside of her cheeks and her tongue.

But there was a lot of playing, a lot of teasing, a lot of fooling around, for their own benefits and for Brian's. It meant every time I got going, they would pause or stop again, and I would lose my progress toward satisfaction. I suppose you could say the benefit was that I wouldn't come too early.

They edged me with their playfulness.

Then, after a while, it all stopped. The women went away, and I wondered if they had taken an impromptu bathroom break. I wanted to ask what was going on — but by now there was an odd pride in being able to abide by the no-talking rule.

I didn't want to complain that they were taking a break, and we had to sit there tied to our chairs. Well — Brian wasn't complaining, so.

But then, after a few moments, I felt hands at my head — and one of them unfastened my blindfold before taking it away to flood my eyes with light.

'Fair's fair,' Juliette said. She was looming over me, looking gorgeous, of course.

I glanced across and saw Jessie making sure Brian's blindfold was firmly in place again. It was a little startling — I'd never seen Brian like that. Naked, helpless. Come to think of it, I'd never seen Jessie naked before, either. Now she was satisfied her boyfriend could see nothing, she straightened up, and her gaze fell upon me.

She smiled, noticing me looking at her. Flashed me a slightly self-conscious wave — acknowledging that it was a little strange my seeing her so exposed like this, after all these years of friendship.

I smiled back, letting her know I was good with this and enjoying the experience. It seemed to take some of the awkwardness out of the situation. Jessie's eyes briefly glanced down at my exposed cock. Then she gave me a flirtatious flash of the eyes to let me know she was having fun fooling around with Brian and me. I flashed my eyes back at her playfully, and the rest of the tension between us seemed to boil away.

She was beautiful, I couldn't help but find her attractive. Brian was a lucky guy.

And now Brian was about to get even more lucky. I glanced up at my sweet, naked wife, and she blew me a kiss before stepping over to Brian and Jessie.

Jessie was already kneeling in front of her boyfriend, but now Juliette joined her. And I watched from the sidelines as my wife's best friend offered her my friend's cock.

Brian seemed to tense up as he felt his girlfriend pass his cock to her best friend.

As I watched my wife take hold of his shaft in one hand and caress the tip with her other, before ducking down to take him in her mouth, it took me a few moments to realize what was going through his head.

Juliette was toying with him — putting his tip in her mouth and then removing it again, swirling her tongue around the bell-shaped glans, then slipping it back inside.

My realization was that, at least right now, Brian knew it was Juliette sucking on his cock. I was sure Jessie had replaced his blindfold correctly. Even so, I suspected that as they had returned their attention to him, he had recognized some small difference between how they treated him. Until things got heated and mixed up later, for now he knew Juliette was servicing him.

I'd first met Brian at Juliette's high school reunion. Since then, we'd become really good friends and hadn't talked much about him being at high school with my wife. But that first night I'd spoken with him, I found out he'd had a massive crush on Juliette in high school. She had been a cheerleader — and the prom queen — after all.

And now his high school crush was holding his hard cock and slowly, sensually licking his shaft. Stretching her lips around his tip, then sinking down to engulf it in the heat of her mouth.

Brian moaned long and low, and I could sense his excitement at receiving a blow job from the girl he'd had wet dreams about as a teenager. Did Jessie know about his crush on her BFF? She had to — they talked about everything and didn't believe in keeping secrets.

Jessie seemed delighted to share her boyfriend's cock with her BFF. She was beaming, ear to ear, as she knelt beside her friend, watching as Juliette teased him by slipping his hardness in her mouth, taking it out again, flicking her tongue around it, rolling his tip around her soft lips.

For me, it was just plain hot watching my wife being naughty with another guy. For Brian, it was a whole different level of excitement.

My own hard cock wavered a little, bobbing gently in the air as my excitement continued to maintain a constant stiffness while I watched my wife pass my friend's cock back to her friend.

Like Jessie, Juliette was draped all over one of Brian's legs, so she could continue to be close to his cock even while Jessie was taking it in her mouth. She momentarily turned to me and flashed me a wicked grin — loving that I was watching everything, enjoying the show.

Then she turned back, easing her head close to Jessie's, Jessie welcoming her presence, allowing her to share Brian's cock, both of them using their mouths on him at the same time, kissing his tip, stroking him with their tongues, grazing their noses against him, brushing their cheeks against him.

They had obviously done this before.

Both of them kissing the tip of his cock together, a kind of threeway kiss, their lips touching each other as well as Brian — they were practically making out with each other, with a cock there in the mix too.

If I thought about it, Juliette had never talked in detail about what kinds of things she got up to with Jessie in college. I knew that they had practiced kissing on each other back in Freshman year, mainly because Jessie had come out of high school an innocent virgin.

They were so comfortable together; I could imagine Juliette showing Jessie the ropes back then, teaching her how to go down on a guy when they were just starting out in college. It was so much fun watching them play with him. Smiling and giggling as they passed his cock between them, rubbing their hands all over him, their faces. All that soft, blonde hair tumbling over his thighs and his lap.

I watched Jessie stand and lean over him to reach for a kiss on his lips while Juliette took his cock deep in her mouth, and then to my surprise, the women switched places and I was watching my wife making out with my friend. Sensually sucking on his lips, slipping her tongue into his mouth.

It made me burn with adrenaline, my cock quivering as the excitement made it throb like crazy.

Still standing, Juliette turned to face away from Brian, then slowly lowered herself as though about to go into a crouch. She placed her hands on his knees, and her behind pushed out over his crotch like she was giving him a lap dance. She was giving him a lap dance.

I caught my breath.

Jessie made way, of course, and we both watched as my wife's bare pussy touched down lightly on Brian's cock — just pressing against his shaft so he could feel the heat of her sex on his manhood.

Jessie moved around to his side and leaned in to claim a kiss on his mouth as Juliette slowly gyrated her hips and gently ground her pussy against his length.

Then the two of them traded places, taking their time to get in place so that Jessie could provide her man with a little lap dance, and Juliette could kiss his mouth. I was just mesmerized as they switched a few times. Both of the beautiful blondes taking their turn to make out with my friend — or grind their pussy against his stiff shaft.

They were getting a little more serious grinding against him now. Actually pushing down on him, using him to pleasure themselves.

I had to be careful not to come to a premature end, watching my wife rubbing her pussy up and down Brian's full length, coating him with her wetness.

But now they were changing again — both on their feet. Urging Brian to get up from his chair. Untying his wrists.

'No moving the blindfold,' Jessie told him as he stood and briefly stretched the soreness out of his limbs. 'Or the game ends.'

It was a fairly straightforward way to police the policy. Neither of us wanted this game to end before it had to.

I watched, riveted to my chair as the women led my blindfolded friend over to the couch, and had him lie down along its full length. I held my breath. Was I going to get to see my wife fuck my best friend?

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.14)

by *Max Sebastian*



They made sure my friend was comfortable lying on the couch, and then my wife knelt in front of him before draping herself all over his lap, taking his stiff cock in her hands.

I had a good view from my kitchen chair as Juliette brushed her long, golden hair back out of her face and began to slowly pump his shaft. She briefly turned to flash me a sultry smile, her eyes connecting with mine to share the thrill with me, to see how I was responding to the sight of her handling my best friend like that.

She was so unbelievably sexy.

As my wife teased Brian with her hands, gazing at his cock like it was the secret to eternal life, Jessie carefully climbed onto the couch, positioning herself directly over his face so she could gently touch her bare pussy down to his mouth.

Brian had to be in Heaven, with two beautiful blondes all over him like that.

Jessie cupped and fondled her breasts as she gently stirred her sex against her boyfriend's mouth. I could hear them both moaning quietly, enjoying the experience. Jessie flashed me a flirtatious smile as she gently ground her pussy over Brian's face. I guess our relationship was forever changed after tonight. She was no longer merely a friend, no longer merely my wife's best friend. We had kissed. A lot. She had taken my cock into her mouth over and over again. We were intimately familiar with each other now.

Juliette didn't seem to have a problem with that, though her focus at this point was on Brian, squeezing his shaft as she stretched her lips around the tip of his cock.

But while I relished the sight of the two beautiful women naked and pleasing themselves on my friend's recumbent form — and in particular the sight of my wife enjoying another man's cock — I could also draw some pleasure from how Brian was enjoying himself.

As I watched, Jessie leaned forward and lay down on Brian in a classic sixty-nine position. The women were smiling at each other, Juliette holding Brian's cock up for Jessie to swirl her tongue around.

After a few moments, Jessie offered it back to Juliette, who took it back into her mouth while continuing to stroke his shaft.

I watched them share his cock between them for a while, but then Jessie gave Juliette a very provocative smile, one eyebrow raised. My wife grinned and nodded, and I was impressed they could communicate that without a word.

Jessie sat back to make way as Juliette climbed up onto the couch, lifting her leg to straddle Brian. I held my breath as my wife hovered there above my friend's crotch — and Jessie grasped his cock to hold it up to Juliette's pussy.

I could see her wiggle her hips, and then she slowly sank down — taking my friend's hard cock inside her. It made me gasp, though my pride made me stifle the sound.

Juliette was wet enough to take him fairly easily, though she took him inch by inch until she was all the way down.

I was finding it difficult to breathe, seeing her like that. Filled up by my best friend. I heard Brian groan underneath Jessie. Did he know it was Juliette fucking him? I got the sense he did. He had his girlfriend's pussy grazing his mouth, he would know that was her. And now his high school crush had impaled herself on his dick.

I watched closely, mesmerized, as Juliette began to slowly rise and fall again on Brian's shaft.

Jessie watched for a few moments, too, before seeming to remember where she was, and that she had Brian's head between her thighs. I watched her and Juliette grinning at each other, highly amused at sharing a guy like this. It seemed certain to me that they used to do this kind of thing in college. That it had been a while.

Juliette leaned forward as she worked her hips to move on Brian's pole, supporting herself with her hands pressed against his solar plexus. My wife was leaning right into her friend while Jessie gently stirred her hips to move on her boyfriend's face. Brian was holding both arms up to grip Jessie tightly — he had to know who was who.

Jessie and Juliette seemed delighted to be doing this together.

They were even being affectionate toward each other — I noticed Jessie run a hand gently down Juliette's arm, then run her fingers through Juliette's long, blonde hair. They giggled a little; there was a real sense of camaraderie between them as they made use of the man beneath them.

Jessie brushed Juliette's hair out of her face, and they gazed into each other's eyes.

Then they were kissing, and it seemed like the most natural thing in the world. I watched, transfixed, as Juliette worked Brian's cock, and Brian worked his mouth on Jessie's pussy, and Jessie cradled Juliette's head in her hands and sucked on her lips.

Were they going to switch so that Jessie got to fuck her boyfriend?

But it went on and on for a long while. I felt like my heart was about to explode, it was pumping so hard — and maybe my cock, it was throbbing so hard.

When the two women finally pulled themselves off Brian, I assumed they would switch places and take him to orgasm — but now Juliette padded over to me. She picked up my blindfold from the floor and put it over my eyes, blocking out all the light again as she fastened it around my head.

Oh.

'No peaking,' Juliette said quietly.

Then I felt her unfastening the binding around my wrists, and I was urged up onto my feet — my joints aching since I'd been sitting in one place for so long.

I heard Brian being guided back to his kitchen chair.

'Lie here,' Juliette said softly, leading me over to the couch. When I lay down, it was still warm from Brian's body heat.

I felt hands on my thighs, sweeping up to take hold of my cock — I had to assume it was Juliette, since I knew she was here with me. But then she gently slipped the end of my cock into her mouth, and I really couldn't tell.

Then, I felt another pair of hands on my head, and a set of lips touched down on mine. Was that Jessie? By now, she was so confident with me that I could not easily determine who was kissing me, either. How had Brian managed to tell between them? I guess I couldn't be certain he had — but while I'd been watching, only Juliette had actually fucked him. Jessie had remained there, grinding her pussy on his mouth.

There was movement around me again, and whoever had been clutching my cock released it, and moved away.

Somebody climbed on to straddle my thighs — and now, somebody else knelt beside my face and lifted her other knee over my head so that she was astride me there.

My hands were free — they hadn't bound them again after I'd escaped the kitchen chair. I could reach up and touch the thighs of the woman now sitting on my face. However, the two blondes were so similar in build that it didn't really help me. My assumption was that it was Juliette now pressing her pussy down over my mouth — because when I had been watching it had been Jessie doing the same to Brian.

Was Brian now watching his girlfriend straddling my thighs? That was my belief.

Well, it made sense — when I had been watching the two women share Brian, it had been for me to watch my wife fucking him — that was the point. And now that he was watching the two women share me, it seemed certain the purpose was for him to witness Jessie fucking another man. After all, tonight was all about Jessie getting used to the idea of having sex with another man with Brian's approval.

I wondered whether Brian had come to the same conclusion I had — that it only really made sense for Juliette to fuck him if I was going to watch.

Well, now he was able to see everything. He would be watching Jessie shuffle into place over my hips, taking hold of my cock in her hand, guiding the tip to the intense heat of her sex. She was taking her time — moving bit by bit, getting used to the situation, leaving ample time for Brian to voice any objections.

But I knew Brian well enough to know he would have no objections.

I felt Jessie put her hands down on my chest, and then she sank on my cock, engulfing it in her hot, wet pussy. It felt so good — and yet the physical thrill for me was also enhanced by the knowledge that, in this moment, I was allowing my good friend to enjoy what he'd been after for a long time, a woman he cared about who would be willing to explore his deepest fantasy.

How was he responding to the sight of Jessie fucking me?

I also found myself wondering what Juliette thought of watching her best friend fucking me. I suppose it was for a good cause. She certainly seemed soaking wet as she rubbed her pussy against my mouth. I have to admit I'd been tending to her a little on autopilot while mulling things

over in my head, processing all those thoughts from another woman riding my cock. But now it struck me that I was sucking on my wife's pussy just after I'd watched her fucking another guy.

So there was that.

I'd never been in this game to sleep with other women, but this was an incredible night. To have two beautiful women pleasuring themselves on me at the same time was a little astounding. My jaw probably would have dropped if it hadn't been jammed between my wife's thighs.

But wait — now Juliette lifted off me. I felt suddenly cold, the wetness smeared all over my face, evaporating to take some of the heat out of my cheeks and chin and around my mouth.

Jessie also paused and then lifted off my cock — were they going back to Brian?

I couldn't determine how long they'd been on me. Perhaps it was his turn again. As good as Jessie had felt on my pole, I don't think she'd hit orgasm while there. Maybe she needed to go back to Brian. Perhaps Brian had had his fill of watching her fucking another man.

I lay and waited for instruction, waiting for one of them to guide me up from the couch and back to my kitchen chair.

The two women were moving around me, not in any particular hurry for whatever came next. They whispered to each other here and there, but I think much of their communication was non-verbal. I thought perhaps one of them was getting Brian up from his chair so they could lay him down here on the couch.

Except — now one of the women was climbing onto me again, straddling my thighs.

Was this Juliette reclaiming me for herself?

Now, I was guessing that Jessie had returned to Brian — but the rule would be that he had to wear a blindfold again.

Then, two things happened that made me completely confused.

Firstly, the woman straddling me sank down on my cock, and I suddenly knew for certain I'd been wrong before that Jessie had been fucking me while Brian watched.

Secondly, I felt a hand curl under the back of my head, and then a woman's lips gently touched down against mine. I knew now that I was kissing Juliette.

I'd got it completely wrong before. My basic assumptions had been upside-down. I'd had Jessie grinding her pussy against my mouth while Juliette had been fucking me.

It reminded me of that old Penn & Teller magic show on Saturday Night Live, where they appear able to magically defy gravity with their card tricks and sleight-of-hand illusions — only to reveal at the end that they were actually hanging upside down the whole time, the camera flipped 180 degrees.

And now that Jessie was riding me, jamming herself down on my cock, I could tell it wasn't Juliette. The two women were so difficult to tell apart in so many ways — but her pussy felt different from the woman's who had been fucking me before.

I could tell this was Jessie, and not Juliette. She was so much tighter, really squeezing my girth as she took me inside her.

I'd fucked my wife regularly enough — and recently enough — to know for sure this wasn't her.

No, my wife was now lifting her leg over my face and kneeling in position above my head, wedging herself down so her beautifully smooth pussy was pressed against my mouth. It struck me that some time ago she had been as tight as Jessie was now while she fucked me. Recently, though, she'd been enjoying a lot of sex — a lot — with Cory Fallon, a guy with an enormous dong.

It kind of turned me on, recognizing that fucking him so much had stretched her out like that.

As Jessie got going with her groove, I reached up to put my hands on my wife's behind and pull her down against my mouth so I could ravish her

as she sat there. I reveled in the fact that I was sucking on a pussy that had taken her huge ex and my smaller best friend recently.

I couldn't get enough of her.

Jessie was going wild on my cock, however. It felt good, I can't deny that, though my focus was on servicing my sweet Juliette with my mouth. Was Brian enjoying the sight of his sweetheart riding me? Now that it was actually her on my manhood.

I felt her come just before I felt my wife coming on my mouth. With my ears compressed by Juliette's hot thighs, I didn't hear anything, but I could sense the shaking, the shuddering of two women hitting climax on me at the same time.

At that moment, I couldn't stop myself — I was so massively stimulated, and after such a long process, my own orgasm was an unstoppable force.

As the incredible power of my climax triggered deep within my loins, I suddenly realized that throughout this game we had not been using condoms — despite the scare Juliette and I had been through recently.

But it was too late. Jessie stayed exactly where she was, rocking her hips back and forth over me as the monumental explosion detonated within me. I started jerking, my hips pumping, my body bouncing Jessie as my big, hard cock began to erupt inside her.

It felt so good, but so wrong to be pumping my hot come deep into our good friend Jessie — my best friend's girlfriend.

I just hoped Brian was okay with it all.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.15)

by *Max Sebastian*



After that, it was time to retire for the night since energy levels were dwindling, at least for Juliette and me.

Thankfully, we hadn't turned our guest bedroom back into an office yet, so Brian and Jessie didn't have to go anywhere. But now Juliette and I lay in our bed listening to our friends reclaiming each other.

From the sound of things, Brian seemed delighted that Jessie had finally put points on her hotwife board.

'You didn't get to see him come inside me,' Juliette said.

'It was never about that, was it? It was about getting Jessie comfortable with it all.'

'I guess so.'

'Brian watching me finish in her — that was the point.'

We were just lying there, gently running our hands over each other's bodies as though we'd never seen each other properly before. It was strangely wonderful, even though I'd had my orgasm — that usually made me sleepy, but not tonight.

'Was it weird, watching someone else with me?' I asked my wife.

'Weird?' She said it as though she couldn't quite understand why I would get such an idea. Then she added, 'It's just Jessie.'

'She doesn't really count?' I chuckled.

Juliette smiled. 'We used to share guys all the time.'

I loved stroking her belly. Her skin was so soft there. I was lying with my head beside her knees, my knees by her head. She'd put on a pair of panties since the evening's main activities, but it was still a gorgeous sight gazing up her body. I could smell that strange tang of sex on her, which tickled my arousal button even though I was usually done for the night after coming like that.

I said, 'When you said that, I thought you meant you just dated the same guys. Not that you had threesomes...'

She smiled. 'It wasn't a big deal. When we were freshmen, we practiced kissing on each other. And some other stuff.'

'Some other stuff?'

She giggled as I stroked the soft skin around the edge of her panties.

'What?' she said. 'It wasn't a big deal. We were grown-ups.'

I put my fist on my forehead and suddenly opened my hand to signal that my mind was blown, and made her laugh some more.

'So when there was a guy you both liked, you just... had him together?'

She shrugged. 'Saved time.'

'You never told me any of this,' I said.

'You never asked.'

That was such an unfair approach to take with secrets. Ah, well. I gently stroked the thin pink cotton covering her pussy — was it a little damp, even now? She didn't seem to have any objections to me touching her there — she lay back against the pillows, legs slightly parted, watching as I toyed with her.

I said, 'Do you remember any of the guys you shared?'

She shrugged. 'Sure.'

There was a glint in her eyes that was a little thrilling.

'Facebook friends with any of them?'

She laughed. 'Maybe.'

'We should arrange a reunion.'

Her eyes flashed at the prospect.

'You're such a pervert,' she joked.

'I know, it's terrible, isn't it?' I grinned, and as though to demonstrate my credentials, I ran my hand under her panties and then tugged them down. She smirked but lifted her hips to allow me to take them off.

Once they were off, I was rewarded with a stronger hint of that sex scent, which drew me in to touch my mouth to her bare pussy.

Hugging my thigh, Juliette moaned softly as I kissed her sex.

I parted her legs a little more for easier access, my cock thickening as I took in the sight of her freshly-fucked pussy and then nuzzled my face against it. For a while, she just lay back, eyes closed, and moaned as I sucked on her pussy lips and explored her with my tongue.

It was a real buzz with the fresh memory in my head of another man taking her here.

After a while she was pawing at my crotch — and I was actually hard again.

'You liked having two of us at once?' she asked me.

I smiled, 'Well... it was Jessie. So I guess I felt comfortable with her.'

'And she is beautiful,' Juliette said.

I sensed a trap.

'She's so similar to you,' I said. 'It was like being with two of you.'

Juliette laughed. 'We taught each other everything we know.'

I turned around so that I could kiss her mouth, my hand still naturally drawn to her exposed pussy. I slipped a finger inside her, coating it in her oily juices before stroking her there.

'Maybe it should be our next step — finding a guy to share,' Juliette said, moaning as I nudged her clit with my thumb.

'You already shared me, didn't you?'

She gave me a look. 'Somebody who isn't you.'

'And now I don't count, is that it?'

She kissed me. 'She already knows you, she's already comfortable with you. It's not a big deal.'

'I'm not a big deal?' I joked, pausing so we could listen to Brian and Jessie moaning so loudly as they had sex that I wondered if our neighbors might start complaining. 'Sounds like Brian thinks it was a big deal.'

Juliette giggled. 'He's so turned on because you fucked her. You came inside her.'

We lay there and just lazily made out — she was stroking my cock now, gently squeezing it, slowly pumping it, while I gently strummed her pussy. I guess we couldn't help being caught up in the sexual atmosphere

in that apartment. Brian and Jessie making their bed creak, practically making the floor shake as they fucked, their moans more like yells now.

'Was it weird seeing your friend fucking me?' Juliette asked me after a while.

I smiled. 'A little. At first. I never thought you'd go for a guy like him.'

She squeezed my cock affectionately. 'I went for it with you, didn't I? You know nerds get kinda hot as they get older.'

I laughed. 'You know he had a huge crush on you in high school?'

'Poor guy, I probably didn't even know he existed. I was too obsessed with Cory.'

'I think you've more than made up for it,' I smiled. 'Did it feel good?'

'Oh yes, it felt wonderful,' she said, turning on her side before pushing out her ass — signal for me to spoon up against her and slide inside.

'He's bigger than me?' I asked, kissing her shoulder blades. Curious, not envious or insecure.

'No,' she said. 'I mean... he's so much like you, in so many ways. Including that.'

'Not like Cory, then.'

She twisted her shoulders a little so I could see her smile as I stroked the tip of my cock against her soaking wet pussy. 'It's not size that counts — didn't anyone ever tell you that?'

I slid my hard cock easily into her, as though to prove a point. Though what the point was, I couldn't say.

She let out a blissed-out moan.

'Could you tell me and Jessie apart?' she asked as I began a slow rhythm thrusting into her.

I said, 'Not for the most part.'

She said, 'Guys used to say we were exactly the same. It was like fucking twins.'

'But she hasn't been fucking Cory Fallon for a while,' I said — not wanting to offend her, but thinking perhaps she might be interested.

She giggled. 'You noticed a difference?'

'A little.'

'It still feels good, right?'

'Of course. It feels incredible. How about for you? It's better with Cory?'

'It's different with Cory.'

'He makes you come.'

I hugged her tight, kissing her beneath the ear as I squeezed my hardness into her from behind.

She said, 'You make me come. And Brian, as it turned out.'

I laughed. 'Brian made you come?'

She beamed. 'It was so sexy, having you watch me fuck him — and having Jessie watch me, too. I could tell how excited you were, watching it.'

She turned to lie on her front so I could thrust into her from on top, straddling the backs of her thighs, plunging my stiff cock into her over and over again.

I was fucking her, and front and center in my mind was that my friend had just fucked her before me.

It seemed so wrong.

It seemed so wicked.

It was absolutely exhilarating.

She turned around, and I continued thrusting into her, but now I could gaze into her beautiful, blue eyes as I fucked her so soon after another man had. After a while, I could sense her reaching her peak. I kissed her mouth, then leaned in to murmur into her ear, 'I want to watch you take two guys at the same time.'

And that was enough to send her over the edge into another orgasm — and for her to take me along with her.

I didn't hear from Brian for a couple of days, and I started getting a little concerned that things might be weird between us after that crazy night.

I mean, I wouldn't have been surprised it felt weird to deal with me as just another drinking buddy after he'd watched me fuck his sweetheart. And after I'd watched him fucking my wife. I wouldn't have blamed Brian if he needed a little time to figure things out.

But I sent him an innocuous text suggesting we have lunch sometime, and then a couple of hours later, there he was, waiting for me outside my office, a huge grin of victory spread across his face.

We hugged like brothers.

'So you guys are good?' I said as we walked away from the building, heading toward the subway station to go somewhere work people wouldn't overhear us.

'Oh yeah. Jessie's been on fire ever since that night. Me too, I guess.'

'She had a good time, then?'

'Oh, yeah. She's been asking if she can visit you and Juliette for some more practice.'

'Wow,' I chuckled, glancing around to make sure there wasn't anyone close by who I recognized.

'She wants to see if I can handle it when she sees a guy, and I don't get to go along with her to watch.'

So much for going somewhere we wouldn't be overheard by people from work. But, hey, I was pleased he was so happy. He didn't seem to be too

concerned about being overheard.

I replied, 'But it's really about whether she can handle being away from you while she's with another guy?'

'Of course,' he smiled.

We crossed the street, weaving between the motionless traffic, then ducked into the subway station.

When we got to the platform, he said to me, 'You don't have to — I mean, I know the deal. You're more about watching Juliette.'

I laughed. This was one of those almost surreal conversations.

'I don't have a problem helping you guys,' I said. 'If that's what you need.'

'Hey, thanks, man.'

As we stepped onto the train, I felt things thickening up in the pants department at the thought of Jessie wanting me and Juliette to help her practice cuckolding Brian. Well, Jessie was attractive.

I said to Brian, 'I guess it's up to Juliette — I mean, I never got into this whole thing to sleep with other women.'

My friend nodded. 'Juliette already said it's fine.'

Over lunch, I thought we'd just reminisce about our wild night being tied to kitchen chairs — or even discuss any thoughts Brian might have for what should happen when Jessie visited Juliette and me for a little light cuckolding practice.

But as we started on our pastrami sandwiches, Brian asked me if I'd looked at Facebook recently, and he was wearing his serious face.

'I try not to look at it if I can,' I said.

'Yeah, I hear you,' he nodded. 'But yesterday, one of the few people from high school I still keep in touch with asked me if I'd heard about Juliette and Cory getting back together. And it seemed like a weird thing for someone to be saying.'

'Very weird,' I agreed. 'Particularly since Juliette's kind of through with him.'

He sighed. 'I got really busy at work — distracted — but then you texted about having lunch, which reminded me again. I took a look on Facebook.'

'Uh-oh,' I said in response to his ominous tone.

He gave a little nod. 'He's been writing a load of stuff on Facebook about dating Juliette — and, you know, sharing pictures of them having dinner and doing couple stuff together, and unless you knew the behind-the-scenes, it does seem to track.'

'Shit,' I said. 'I guess Juliette could have been clearer with him that she's not seeing him anymore. But why is he putting it all on Facebook?'

'He's trying to manipulate her into leaving you for him.'

'Jesus. What makes him think he can do it like this?'

'He's put all this stuff on there about Juliette wanting to make it official with him, but that her husband isn't allowing her a divorce.'

'Uh... *whatnow?*'

'He's saying you're the great impediment to their happy ending.'

'I can't believe it.'

I texted Juliette, of course, and then had her on the phone sobbing her heart out because everyone in her high school circle believed she'd left me ages ago — and that somehow I, as her husband, had mistreated her.

She said, 'Even if I try to tell them Cory's full of BS, it's only a matter of time before everyone we know thinks I've been cheating on you.'

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.16)

by *Max Sebastian*



Juliette went over to Cory's place to make it clear that their little affair was now over — and to demand that he stop spreading lies and rumors about her and about our marriage.

I felt so nervous as I waited for her to come back.

I mean — I trusted her; I knew she'd return to me. She would tell him what needed to be said if she hadn't made her point clear enough the first time.

But this was Cory we were talking about. The man who had taken her virginity, who had introduced her to all the pleasures of sex. Did she love him? I wasn't sure. Yet she definitely still desired him, even after all these years.

He was a huge temptation for her.

Man. I might not have had such a magical loss of innocence as Juliette had with Cory, but there was definitely a woman from my past I would have dearly loved to see again had I not been with Juliette. I thought about how it might be to get back into a passionate relationship with her again — and then have to suddenly end things as Juliette was having to do.

I could feel her pain. I could also sense the danger.

And yet the dark, depraved, perverted part of me seemed to crave that danger. I can only try to describe it by alluding to the draw of extreme sports. The adrenaline, the rush of exploring serious risks.

Here was my beautiful wife venturing into the lion's den — a private audience with a man who had publicly stated his desire to steal her from me. And I just wanted her to succumb to any temptation she might have to sleep with him again.

There was a disconnect between the part of my brain that could logically assess a threat to my well-being and the part that drove me to satisfy my perverted desire to share my wife.

I wasn't proud of myself, but I sat on the couch waiting for Juliette to return to me, stroking my hard cock as I imagined Cory trying to seduce her. Cory succeeding in seducing her.

And the longer she spent away from home, the more exciting it seemed to me because the more chance there seemed to be that the two of them were getting up to something wicked.

I kept staring at the clock on my phone, calculating and then re-calculating how long I thought it would take Juliette to get to Cory's home, then how long they would need to argue about what Cory had been saying about her on Facebook. Then, I would add an estimated time for Juliette to return to me.

I set a time in my head: if Juliette wasn't back by 9.30pm, I would start believing something was happening between her and Cory.

It was ridiculous. Stupid. The longer my wait extended, the more I was hoping that Juliette was actually cheating on me with her ex some more.

As 9.30pm actually arrived, I had to be careful not to get so excited that I came before Juliette returned home to me.

I didn't want my wife to lie to me, to do things with other men behind my back — and yet it was so unbelievably hot to me to think that she might be unable to avoid the temptation to be really wicked with him. I didn't want Cory Fallon to have the reward of another night of sex with my wife after what he'd been writing about us on Facebook — and yet, I could not stop hoping that Juliette would come home freshly fucked.

10pm arrived, no Juliette.

What could they have been talking about all this time?

I knew break-ups could be emotionally messy. In my Freshman year, that girl I'd liked more than anyone — before Juliette had come along — I'd spent an entire night trying to persuade her not to break up with me.

I hoped it wasn't going to be like that.

Juliette sent me a text message just after 10.30pm. I nearly came all over my phone as I read it.

Juliette: Would you be mad at me if I had sex with him one more time?

Oh, man.

The words that immediately sprang to mind were 'thin end of the wedge.' I noticed that she hadn't asked me to let her have sex with him one 'last' time, but one 'more' time. Did that mean there would be the possibility of yet more in future?

Oh, man oh man.

But that dark, despicable part of me couldn't help but say yes to her request.

I texted her back:

Nick: Not mad, no. A little concerned, maybe.

Then she came back with:

Juliette: I'll be quick, I promise. Then I'll come straight home and you can have me for yourself xx

Well, now the wait was going to continue — and I was so hard I had to refrain from touching myself in case something somewhat terminal happened to my evening's libido.

I sighed and decided to go take a walk to see if I could get my mind off things.

While I was out on my walk, Juliette's high school friend Becky texted me. At first, I thought she'd made a mistake — sent a message to me instead of Juliette. Becky rarely even talked to me — I hardly ever went out with Juliette when she saw her high school friends.

But then I focused on the words she'd sent me:

Becky: You should just let Juliette do what she wants. It's obvious she wants Cory and not you.

I felt a jolt of fear shoot through my chest.

Was there something Juliette was keeping secret from me? Had she designs on running away with Cory after all? Why would she pretend to be seeing him tonight so she could break up with him and demand he stop harassing us on Facebook?

Instead of responding to Becky, I shot Brian a text message asking his advice — asking him whether I needed to go break down Cory Fallon's door and retrieve my wife from his evil clutches.

Brian said Juliette's former high school friends were still discussing Cory's claims on Facebook, and it looked like they'd formed some kind of activist group to campaign for Juliette's freedom.

I groaned.

I asked him if he thought I needed to go on Facebook to counter Cory's lies, but he said only Juliette would have any credibility to do that — and even then, people might believe she was somehow coerced by the evil husband.

I told him Juliette had gone to see him to break things off — and persuade him to stop spreading rumors about us.

Brian asked if I'd given her permission to have break-up sex.

Well, that made me laugh. Great minds think alike, I told him, adding a winky-face emoji.

Break-up sex.

It was just break-up sex.

As I walked home, I felt some reassurance — though I don't think anything would have dispelled that underlying unease that Cory would somehow win Juliette over and take her away from me forever.

Before I reached our building, I received another text message — this time from someone who was not in my contacts list. That wasn't a big surprise, assuming it was one of Juliette's ex-high school friends, since I only had numbers from a few of them at most.

The text read: *If your marriage is obviously over, why do you feel the need to stop Juliette doing what she wants?*

I know it was based on lies, but that text message still felt like someone pouring boiling oil into my stomach. I felt hot under the collar — embarrassment from knowing people were talking about me behind my back in less than glowing terms.

I didn't want to dignify the text even with a 'who dis' reply.

I got home and found myself peering at Facebook, where Cory Fallon had changed his status to 'in a relationship' with Juliette Morrison.

Jeez. Social media could be so powerful at creating a completely different reality.

All of Juliette's former high school friends were under the impression that she was in some kind of horrific marriage, and that Cory was valiantly battling to rescue her. I could look at all of their discussions, and each point someone made backed up a completely false picture of

the world. And yet I had to concede that the narrative was so intriguing, so beguiling, it was just irresistible.

It felt like there would be no easy answer to turn the tide of misinformation about me.

God. I couldn't help what I was. I sat on the couch and stroked my cock, thinking that right then, my wife was having sex with another guy. A guy who wanted her desperately — so much so that he would lie about his status with her on Facebook.

It was getting close to 11pm.

Was she going to stay with him all night?

Earlier that night, I'd been feeling that the longer she took before she came home, the better it would be because it would mean there was more chance she would get tempted to sleep with him. Now, however, I felt distinctly the opposite — the longer she stayed with him from this point, the worse it would be. The fear was growing inside me.

Then I heard the front door close.

I looked up to find Juliette there.

'Started without me?' she said.

She was wearing the same short dress I'd watched her putting on earlier this evening. That had been when I'd imagined she was just going to go over there and yell at Cory for being a prick. She

She stood in front of me, and I could already smell a hint of sex on her. The longer she stood there, the more obvious it was.

She was also looking flushed, a little sweaty. Her hair unkempt, and what was left of her makeup smeared.

It was so obvious that she had just had sex. As she stood there, completely unfazed by me seeing her that way, I felt a strange and unexpected burst of self-confidence — which meant I continued to sit there and stroke my cock as I ran my eyes all over her instead of trying to hide what I'd been doing while she'd been gone.

'Cory changed his Facebook status to 'in a relationship' with you,' I said.

She groaned. 'He hacked my account. You know you're supposed to get someone's approval before you can say you're in a relationship with them? He guessed my password.'

I flashed my eyes at her. 'I guess you need a new password.'

She reached for me. I couldn't believe how good she looked. I wanted to pull her down and ravish her. But I tried to control myself.

'Did you break up with him?' I asked her, taking hold of her hand. Guiding it to my hard cock.

'Yes,' she said solemnly, curling her fingers around my stiff shaft.

'Before you had sex with him or after?'

'Before.'

She stroked me a few times and then moved to pull open my pants and pull them down my thighs to free my cock completely. She stood and gazed at it for a moment or two, admiring it. Controlling her lust for it. Then she slowly pulled up the hem of her dress, showing me more of her shapely legs, her taut thighs, her panties.

I caught my breath as I noticed the little trail of moisture running down her thigh.

Another man's come was trickling down her leg.

I watched, transfixed, as she reached under her dress and then slowly tugged down her panties. They were already soaking wet.

'How did he take the break-up?' I asked her.

'Not so great,' she said, stepping out of her panties. 'He said he moved to the city for me. That I'd given him the impression I would move in with him. That we'd get back together permanently.'

'He stayed in our apartment,' I said. 'And he thought you'd just leave me for him?'

She smiled, sharing my feelings about how crazy her ex-boyfriend was. Then she slowly folded up her panties and leaned forward to touch them to my nose. I inhaled the strong scent of sex.

She pressed them to my face, clamping them against my mouth and nose so every breath I took was saturated with the pungent aroma of their adulterous sex. As she did this, she climbed onto my lap — feet on the couch, knees either side of me — and sank into a crouch.

Her hot, juicy pussy engulfed my hard cock as she dropped down onto me.

It felt incredible. I could feel my wife's pussy full of my rival's come; it coated my cock as I slid into her. She groaned at the feeling of the second cock in the same night filling her — even though mine was the smaller of the two. She moaned and circled her hips to move on my pole, her hand mimicking the motion as she ground her sodden underwear against my face.

'You want to hear what he did to me?' she asked.

'Mmm-hmm,' I said.

She smiled, enjoying her effect on me. 'I told him if he didn't delete his comments about us on Facebook, he wouldn't ever get to sleep with me again.'

I murmured, though I couldn't be understood through her panties.

'I told him he could have me one last time, and if he was a good boy, maybe I'd pay him a visit occasionally.'

She worked her hips extra hard to bounce up and down my cock. I could feel Cory's come leaking out of her around my shaft.

'I figured you'd probably let me fuck him again sometime,' she said. 'You know... every now and then. And I needed leverage to get him to stop being a prick on Facebook.'

What could I do — I liked that my wife had just fucked the guy.

She seemed to enjoy how hard I was.

She said, 'I told him I'd fuck him, but he had to do it quick — and hard. I started taking off my clothes right there, and I was already wet thinking about you waiting back home while I fuck him.'

I pulled her panties out of my mouth. 'When did you text me asking to fuck him?'

'When we were arguing about whether he was going to stop putting BS on Facebook,' she said and snatched her panties out of my hand before balling them up to stuff into my mouth.

I moaned as my cock slipped out of her creamy pussy, and she had to reach down to put it back in place.

'I told him he was going to do exactly what I wanted if he wanted to fuck me. Then I just had to fuck him.'

God, she was so hot. I was helpless in her clutches. She told me she was wearing nothing but the panties currently stuffed in my mouth as she'd knelt on his bed, and he had tugged them aside before shoving his massive tool inside her pussy.

She told me how creamy she got while he was plunging that giant dick into her again and again. How incredible it felt. How hard he fucked her.

His sense of betrayal infused in every thrust.

How they had tussled, as though fighting to be on top. How physical he had been with her, shoving his big cock into her with all the force he could muster. How he had finally laid her on her back and put her to the sword, shaking the floor as he pushed her to a powerful orgasm before pumping her full of his come.

She told me about how she'd felt his load inside her as she'd taken a taxi back home to me. How she'd felt him leaking out of her, seeping into her underwear, dribbling down her legs.

I grasped her hips and plunged into her myself, releasing a fresh flood of hot come deep within her.

How would I ever be able to resist her when she decided she wanted to fuck somebody like Cory?

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.17)

by *Max Sebastian*



Cory Fallon scrubbed his Facebook page of any reference to getting back together with Juliette, and his status returned to 'single.' Clearly, he was motivated to leave open the possibility for future booty calls.

However, at least among Juliette's former high school crowd, it seemed like the damage was done.

There was no question among any of them as to whether she had been seeing Cory. There was a debate about whether she had been justified in cheating on her husband — and about what was going on now. Was she trying to desperately save our marriage? Had I threatened her with physical violence and coerced her into forcing Cory to delete all his recent comments about her?

Rumors were flying. Juliette tried to douse some of the flames with comments and rebuttals where she could, but among those who were

sure the Big Bad Husband had her under lock and key, her comments wouldn't dissuade them from their beliefs. Well — a hostage could be forced to say anything her kidnapper wanted her to say.

That next day, Juliette was on the phone with her closest friends — Becky, Zoe, Sarah, and so on — trying to get them to understand what was happening and help halt the rumors. But the trouble was that she didn't feel comfortable opening up to them about the truth.

'It's really awkward,' she told me the next evening. 'I can't deny I was seeing Cory. So now they think I cheated on you, and it's whether or not they think I'm justified doing that. I guess at least I could make it clear you're not forcing me to do anything, to say anything, to lie to them.'

'Well, that's something,' I shrugged.

She sighed. 'I can't really tell them you let me have an affair. They're not going to understand that.'

'No, probably not.'

'They'll think our marriage is in trouble. Or that we're... I don't know... swingers or something.'

I thought of our little adventure with Brian and Jessie. Technically, you would be hard-pressed not to give it a label like swinging. When Juliette and I had talked about it since, it seemed we both thought of it as a kind of double cuckolding — like a perverted kind of double dating — because Brian and I had both gotten to watch our wives fucking another guy, but when it came to being fucked by another woman, we had been blindfolded.

I knew Juliette well enough to appreciate that in her mind — and those of her friends — the term 'swingers' brought up images of sweaty, animalistic hedonists with no standards and zero inhibitions engaging in shockingly uncontrolled orgies with a bunch of aggressively sexual creeps.

I said, 'I suppose they're not going to understand if we tell them we're into cuckolding.'

'They'll think that's even worse,' Juliette moaned.

I gave her a squeeze as we cuddled up on the couch in front of the TV.
'What have you told them so far?'

'Nothing,' she said with yet another sigh. 'I just kind of avoided the question. Changed the subject. You know — saying it was just between you and me and that no one was forcing anyone to do anything. I mean... at least they didn't come right out and demand to know if I was cheating. They kind of skated around that subject, too. They don't want to have to outright disapprove of what I did.'

'But they're still thinking that you probably were cheating?'

She shrugged. I could tell she was close to crying. This was her reputation being shredded. Mine too, in a way, but I felt a little shielded from it because I wasn't really friends with her high school cronies anyway.

The rest of the evening, we just watched TV together, snuggling up on the couch trying not to think about the bad stuff.

I texted Brian, naturally. Juliette texted Jessie. There weren't any easy answers as far as they were concerned, although they invited us out to see a movie the next evening to try to offer us distraction.

We watched Novocaine, which was a fun enough movie, and then all went for a drink together afterward.

It was nice to get a little alcohol into the system and just chat about the movie — or anything, really, other than Cory Fallon and the various rumors he had inspired on Facebook.

It was a weeknight, so we didn't stay out horrifically long. But when it seemed like a sensible time to head home, and I was walking beside Brian on the way to the subway station, he said quietly, 'What d'you think about... if maybe Jessie went with you guys tonight?'

'With us?' I said, a little startled at Brian's suggestion coming right out of the blue like that.

'I mean... obviously, if it's not a good night...' Brian stammered.

'It's just a bit of a surprise, that's all.'

'We thought maybe... you might enjoy a little distraction...'

I said, 'I'm not saying a little distraction wouldn't be good right now. I'm just not sure Juliette...'

I looked at Juliette, trying to guess whether she would welcome the kind of distraction Brian offered. I could understand that now might not be the time for her to help out her BFF to prepare for making Brian's fantasies come true. She had been bad-mouthed all over Facebook, after all.

But Juliette suddenly grabbed Jessie's hand and giggled excitedly, then turned to face Brian and me.

'Jessie's coming home with us,' she said, her eyes blazing with excitement.

I smiled at Brian, indicating that if Juliette was so adamant this was happening, then who was I to stand in the way?

Well, I did welcome some distraction. Anything to keep our minds from wallowing in the gloom of being publicly outed as either a couple with a ruined marriage or a couple who were rampant swingers.

And so. At the subway station, Brian kissed his sweetheart farewell and crossed to the other platform to wait for a train going in the opposite direction, toward Brooklyn. Jessie came with Juliette and me to jump on the train heading up to the Upper East Side.

As our train pulled out of the station, we could peer out the window to see Brian standing there on the other platform, alone. We waved at him. He seemed happy — nervous, but no doubt thrilled at the prospect of sharing Jessie.

*

We broke out a bottle of wine when we all got back to our apartment. We all needed just a touch more cushion for our inhibitions, even after that double-cuckolding experience.

It was late, but not stupidly late for another drink.

Jessie seemed nervous, though excited, and seemed to blush a lot whenever I was looking her way. It was cute. Even though I'd been inside her — I'd fucked her, I'd come inside her — it was still a little strange to be talking about taking her to bed with us after all the time we'd been just friends.

Juliette surprised me by how animated she was — she was eager to do this, even though she wouldn't get to have another guy tonight.

We chatted about how Brian must be feeling, going home alone, and it seemed to me that Juliette was thrilled to be helping our friends explore this fantasy. And I also got the sense she found it wild to be sharing a man with her BFF — it was a nostalgia thing, reliving the past, jumping back in time to their wild college days.

Juliette suggested that Jessie give Brian one last phone call to check on him — mainly, I think, for Jessie's own benefit because it was pretty clear that Brian was okay with all this.

Then my sweet wife dragged me into the bedroom while her BFF called my friend.

'How do you want me?' I asked, not quite believing this was happening to me.

'Naked,' Juliette said, her hands on me already, working to pull off my clothes.

Well, who was I to disoblige my wife?

She left my boxer shorts on, but then she had me lie down on the bed — and she pulled something out of her underwear drawer. It was a sleep mask.

'Oh, again?' I said.

She giggled. 'We're not swingers,' she grinned and tossed me the sleep mask as she began to peel off her clothes.

'No, we're not, but...' I said, and she flashed her eyes at me to compel me to put on the sleep mask as I lay there on the bed.

'We're just role-playing you're some other guy Jessie's sleeping with before she goes home to Brian, right?' she said.

I put on the mask. I even put it on properly. I wasn't going to cheat because this seemed to be how Juliette wanted it to be if she was going to let her friend fool around with us.

'Did you make guys at college wear blindfolds when you shared them with Jessie?'

'Nope,' Juliette said, knowing it wouldn't make a difference anyway.

I felt her climb onto the bed and crawl up beside me, one of her hands gently brushing against my chest as she moved up. Then I felt her putting something around my head — a necktie or maybe a scarf — before tying it tight. I guess she didn't trust I wasn't going to cheat with the sleep mask.

I felt her soft, warm breasts press against my face as she reached behind my head to tie the knot.

She stroked my chest and kissed my lips briefly. 'Can you see anything?'

'Nothing at all,' I insisted.

She giggled and then climbed onto me, straddling my crotch to press down on my hard cock. I could feel the heat of her pussy through her panties and my boxer shorts. She kissed me again, moaning quietly as she ground against my hard-on. Her lips were sweet, with the hint of the wine we'd just been drinking.

Then suddenly, I felt Juliette climb off me — and there was another pair of hands sliding up my bare legs that could not possibly have been hers.

I guessed that Jessie had gotten clearance for take-off.

Her hands moved up my chest as Juliette made way, and then I felt her lips touch mine. She was wearing a different perfume than Juliette this

time. While I wasn't allowed to see her, I could at least tell her apart from my wife this time.

'Hi,' she said after our little kiss, and I could hear her smiling broadly in her voice.

'Hi,' I said in return, smiling back.

Then there were four hands on my chest. I felt Juliette put her face right over mine, her soft hair draping all over me. I heard her whisper, 'I'm going to put your cock in her mouth.'

Then I felt Jessie pulling off my boxer shorts. It must have been Juliette who grabbed hold of my erection first — because Jessie was still removing my underwear. Then I felt Jessie lie over my thighs — I could tell she had stripped off to her underwear, like Juliette.

I felt my wife holding out my cock for Jessie, who then began gently running her tongue around the tip and the shaft.

I moaned gently to show my approval. Louder as she took it into her mouth and sank down on it. As she sucked on my cock, I could sense Juliette beside me, up by my shoulders and head. Was she watching her friend bob down on me?

I reached for her, glad they had not decided to bind my wrists like last time. I touched her hot thigh and felt her hand land on mine, guiding it up to her crotch. She pushed my fingers against her damp panties, and I began to stroke her there, tracing little circles of pressure over her pussy and her clit.

Jessie was talented with her mouth — it felt so good.

I sighed, 'That feels amazing... did you guys practice blowjobs together at college as well as kissing?'

I heard Jessie's lips smack as she withdrew from my cock to say, 'Juliette taught me everything I know.'

Juliette leaned down to kiss my mouth as Jessie continued to suck on my cock.

I thought of how Brian must be feeling. He would be wanting this. He would be hoping for it. My guess was that he felt safe doing it this way. There was no chance of me wanting to steal his girlfriend, even if Jessie was objectively gorgeous.

After a while, Juliette pulled away from me, and then I felt Jessie lift off my cock again. There was only a hand now, gripping my shaft tightly, slowly pumping it. I got the sense it was Juliette's, though.

Then I heard the unmistakable wet sounds of kissing — and I knew it wasn't me involved.

I grinned. 'Don't you guys think you've had enough practice at that since college?'

Juliette and Jessie giggled. But then they were making out some more. Was this something new? I mean, I knew they'd practiced kissing at college as Freshmen, but.

Then I felt the unmistakable feeling of two mouths on my cock at once. One of them — I'm going to guess Juliette — stretched her lips over the tip and took my upper few inches into her mouth. The other one was lashing my shaft with her tongue and then gently sucking on my balls.

Man, it felt wicked. I could reach down and gently place my hands on two women's heads as they tended to my dick with their mouths.

There was lots of slurping and giggling and moaning. Pretty wild.

Then Juliette kissed my mouth before offering me a taste of her breasts, leaving my cock to Jessie. Of course I recognized my wife's perfume, I enjoyed sucking on her small but perky tits, which had always been nicely sensitive.

Not long after that, I felt Juliette lift up, and this time, she was standing, I thought. I heard the characteristic sound of her taking off her panties, and then she was lifting a leg over me, straddling my upper chest, lowering her pussy onto my mouth.

I loved how soaking wet she was. I savored her flavor as I lapped at her soft folds. She was facing toward my toes, toward Jessie so she could

watch her friend sucking my cock.

Moaning as I licked her delicious sex.' Oh fuck, yeah...'

It wasn't long before they were sharing my dick again, only this time I was feasting on Juliette's gorgeous pussy.

'You wanna fuck him?' I heard my wife say.

'Oh yeah,' Jessie replied.

My wife was pumping my dick with both of her hands and I could just about hear the sound of Jessie removing her panties.

Then Jessie straddled my thighs and eased into place over my cock. I felt her trembling as she brought the tip of my cock to her searing hot entrance.

'Just take it slow,' I heard my wife murmur to her friend.

Jessie moaned and I felt the tip of my cock slip inside her — and then my full length was slowly engulfed by her drenched pussy.

'Oh yeah... oh yeah...'

Jessie bounced on my cock — were the women making out while she fucked me? It sounded like it. Juliette wiggled her hips and ground her sex against my mouth, flooding me with her juices.

We were all working up the same rhythm, all three of us aligning our movement so that we were one pulsating mass of flesh.

'Feels so good... oh yes...'

'Take it, baby... fuck him...'

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.18)

by *Max Sebastian*



As it turned out, it was tough to counter a scandalous rumor once it had taken flight on social media. The whole putting a Champagne cork back in the bottle image sprang to mind.

Halfway through the week, I started getting messages from some of our mutual friends — that is, people both Juliette and I were good friends with, outside of her ex-high school circle — saying they were sorry I was going through such tough times at the moment. Asking whether I needed help.

As much as I tried saying in reply that I was fine, that there was really nothing going on — that some stupid rumor had started on Facebook and now it had gone viral among people we knew — everyone seemed to think I was just putting a brave face on things.

People seemed to want to believe the worst.

As the week progressed, I had every expectation that Juliette would get increasingly upset, depressed, and angry at our situation.

But while clearly frustrated by it all, she somehow managed to keep fairly upbeat.

'We'll just get some new friends,' she even joked when I showed her yet another text from some well-meaning friends saying, in this case, that if I needed a couch to sleep on I would be more than welcome.

'Once it all dies down... people will understand...' I said.

Juliette shrugged. 'They might just about believe it if we say it was all lies put out by Cory. But it wasn't all lies.'

'Maybe I have to fall on the sword and just say... you know... I like it when you're with other guys,' I said.

She shook her head. 'People don't understand that. And some people can't understand it.'

'I don't know... our friends are pretty liberal. They'll accept anyone for who they are.'

She sighed at that. 'Sex is just... different. And when it comes to cheating — even just the suggestion of cheating — people are quick to judge.'

At least we had Brian and Jessie as friends.

We could all hang out together and exist in a judgment-free zone. Over the next couple of weeks, we went out to bars together, had lunch, and even went to the new Lin-Manuel Miranda show on Broadway together.

And as it turned out, we could have sex together.

*

I guess you could say that when the world went crazy, Juliette and I retreated to the safe space — a nuclear bunker, you might say — to hang out only with Brian and Jessie.

That's not to say we ignored the problem. We did discuss what was going on, and Jessie acted as our spy in the enemy camp, giving us updates on how the rumors were spreading among our circle of friends.

The solutions to our ravaged reputations appeared to be either denying everything, embracing our apparent deviancy, attempting some kind of reputation-cleansing counseling program, or getting ourselves a whole new circle of friends.

The first of those options seemed closed off to us already — Cory, in his petulant bitterness, had already revealed sufficient evidence, including photographic, that he had been seeing Juliette shortly before her coercion had shut down his rumormongering.

The second option — letting the world know we were shunning the confines of monogamy in our relationship — also seemed off-limits. Juliette thought a few of our friends might accept that we were simply expressing ourselves and that it was all good, but most would stick to the impression that Juliette was just a cheating so-and-so. And she was worried that word of our sexual deviancy would reach work, where our standings as respected lawyers would suffer.

The option to cleanse our reputations with some kind of marriage counseling, and treat our little adventure as some kind of addiction to be dealt with by therapy and remorse, was not something Juliette could countenance.

'I am not treating this as though it's something we should apologize for,' she said. 'We haven't done anything wrong.'

The last option offered some scope for discussion initially, but after talking it over, we realized that in this phone-obsessed, post-pandemic world, making new friends wasn't as easy as it used to be.

'I mean, name a person you really would call a genuine friend, who you didn't know from school, or college,' Juliette said.

'There's a couple of people at work I hang out with sometimes,' Jessie insisted.

Brian said, 'I have a few friends at work.'

Juliette nodded. 'But the people I work with are either seriously uptight or outright alcoholics.'

Jessie pointed out that I hadn't known Brian before Juliette's high school reunion, and now we were best buddies. I patted Brian on the back and said it was like the exception that proved the rule — and reminded them that he knew Juliette in high school.

It did seem like we would have to work harder on building friendships at work.

Meanwhile, the four of us got to talking about the progress we were making toward fulfilling our cuckolding fantasy. That was a little excitement with which to distract ourselves.

And as the night seemed to draw to a conclusion, we started feeling that same kind of horny vibes we'd felt before our little double cuckolding game had happened.

It seemed almost inevitable that the suggestion would emerge for us all to head back to our apartment on the Upper East Side and re-attempt that crazy game.

'Do we have to do all that showering again so you can't tell who is who when we fuck you?' Jessie laughed.

I said, 'Can Brian and I just promise not to think about who is fucking us?'

We were a little bolstered by alcohol. I don't think we could talk like that otherwise, even between the four of us.

Brian said, 'Does it matter if we know who is who when you're fucking us?'

Juliette giggled. 'You're missing the whole point, Bri. It's not an orgy. It's cuckolding practice. It's about me and Jessie getting to fuck other guys. It's not about you and Nick getting to fuck other women.'

'Hmm,' Brian grinned. 'I realize that.'

Jessie said, 'If I just went home with Nick, and Juliette just went home with you, Bri, then we wouldn't need blindfolds or anything.'

Brian scratched his head at the massively flawed logic in that suggestion.

But then Juliette took his hand and flashed her eyes seductively at him, saying, 'That does seem like it would be a lot easier.'

I guess logic gets a little tangled and dizzy when you've been drinking.

Brian said, 'But — !'

But somehow, before he could voice his view that simply going home with each other's partners was nothing like actual cuckolding, the women seemed to have come to an agreement.

And that left me standing on the curb with Jessie as we watched a yellow taxi containing Brian and Juliette disappearing off in the general direction of Brooklyn.

'Hi,' she said to me once the taxi had gone, and it was just us.

'Hi,' I said with a nervous chuckle. 'So here we are.'

'Just the two of us,' she smiled brightly.

'Shall we?' I offered her my arm like some Nineteenth Century gent, and Jessie merrily linked hers with mine as we started walking toward my apartment building, which was only a few blocks away by then.

'You know, I never got into this to sleep with other women,' I said.

'Of course not,' she agreed. 'Neither did Brian.'

'Right,' I agreed, feeling the awkwardness between us.

I know we'd technically already had sex, but that had been part of something else — a kind of game in which our other halves were also playing. This felt all sorts of different — me taking Jessie home without Juliette at all.

'I mean... maybe it would be better if we just... you know... I mean... what I'm saying is...'

Jessie giggled. 'What are you saying?'

I took a breath, trying not to be flustered. 'What I'm saying is... we don't have to... you know... do anything... if you don't want to.'

Her eyes widened with mock alarm. 'You know Brian is counting on you to fuck me,' she said.

God. I felt my manhood thickening up. But along with it came all kinds of feelings of guilt. Jessie was attractive — gorgeous, in fact — but couldn't help being uneasy about bedding another woman.

'But this is about making sure Brian's all right with you being out with another guy, right?' I said.

Jessie said, 'This is about me being all right fucking another guy. And Juliette being all right fucking another guy.'

This was the point where it struck me that this whole thing of fooling around with Brian and Jessie wasn't merely about helping Jessie take the next step in challenging the boundaries of her monogamous relationship with Brian. It was also about helping Juliette to move on from the easy connection she had forged with Cory.

I'd almost missed that Juliette was in the same boat as Juliette, because my wife's brief affair with her ex-boyfriend had been so easy.

The prospect of dating other men was somewhat intimidating, regardless of whether we shared the ultimate aims of the cuckolding fantasy. Juliette needed her confidence building as much as Jessie did.

'She's going to sleep with Brian,' I said, which might have seemed a stupid thing to say, but Jessie could tell that I was finally joining all the dots.

'It's easier that way,' she said. 'She'll have some fun with Brian... and she'll be able to move on from Cory.'

'But you don't mind that she's sleeping with Brian?' I asked Jessie.

The pretty blonde smiled broadly. 'You have to understand — between her and me, it's not really like someone else is sleeping with him. She's so much like me. And I'm like her. I *am* her. And she's me.'

Hmm. Okay.

I said, 'You wouldn't let Brian sleep with any other woman, though? Right? Other than her.'

'God, no!' she declared. 'What if he liked her more than me?'

'I don't think there's a chance of that.'

'I don't want some other woman getting her filthy hands on him.'

I was surprised at the edge in Jessie's voice. She was genuinely jealous at the thought of some other woman going after Brian — but apparently not at all that Juliette was just about to sleep with him that night.

She seemed to think of herself as Juliette's twin. And, I was guessing that my wife was treating the prospect of me sleeping with Jessie with a similar kind of jealousy exemption.

I texted her, just to be clear.

Nick: So I am supposed to sleep with Jessie tonight, right?

I assumed she was still in the taxi on the way to Brian's place, because her response came right on back.

Juliette: Of course. What else would you be doing taking her home with you while I'm going with Brian?

What we have here is a good old-fashioned wife-swap, I thought to myself. Except that Jessie wasn't technically Brian's wife, of course. Man, I did not see this one coming. Not when I was in a very ordinary marriage, not when I begrudgingly agreed to accompany my sweet wife to her high school reunion. Not even after I'd witnessed her banging her ex on the night of the aforementioned high school reunion.

I sent another text back to Juliette:

Nick: You're not going to suddenly get jealous that I've been to bed with your BFF?

And in reply:

Juliette: Why would I get jealous? It's practically the same as you going to bed with me.

Practically the same. Except that it wasn't my wife, it was her friend. Our friend. Someone I had known and maintained a consistent platonic relationship with for about six years, give or take.

There was no message from Juliette asking me whether it was okay for her to sleep with my friend.

Ah well, it's what I would have wanted.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.19)

by *Max Sebastian*



'You can put on a blindfold if you like,' Jessie said as she dragged me to the bedroom.

She was joking because this wasn't the first time we'd had sex — though the previous time, I'd been unable to see her.

Tonight, I was a little nervous to be taking my wife's best friend to bed. I guess it gave me a whole new perspective on the fantasy of wanting my wife to sleep with other men. This was educational for me regarding why Juliette might be anxious about dating other men, even though you might think any woman would just jump at the chance to bed other men while their husband approved.

'I don't think I'm supposed to wear a blindfold for this,' I said.

Jessie pulled me onto the bed, so I lay over her, beaming from ear to ear. 'No, you're not supposed to wear a blindfold tonight,' she confirmed, curling an arm around my head to pull me in for a kiss.

As much as my wife seemed to like to think of Jessie as her identical twin, the pretty blonde was certainly not *identical* to Juliette. It was fun to be with someone new, even if it wasn't a fantasy I craved as I did the thought of letting Juliette bed someone else.

Jessie's kiss was sweet, and her technique learned directly from Juliette — so that I might have closed my eyes and imagined it was Juliette kissing me, except that her perfume was different, her breasts a touch larger as I pressed a hand against them.

'Brian's going to want me to tell him about all of this,' Jessie said, breathless between kisses.

Her hands made a sandwich of my face as she kissed me, and in her excitement, she seemed to want a lot more tongue than Juliette usually did.

'Are you thinking about him right now?' I asked her.

She smiled. 'It's a whole added level of excitement knowing he's thinking about me doing this,' she said. 'I mean... God, it's so deliciously dirty — getting to fuck another guy and having a horny husband turned on by the thought of me doing it.'

The funny thing is, I could totally imagine Juliette being the same way while she was with Brian — although I was fairly sure the two of them hadn't reached Brian's apartment in Brooklyn yet.

'Are you thinking about Juliette right now?' Jessie asked me.

'Yeah... but I don't think they can've got to Brooklyn yet.'

'No, we've got a head start,' Jessie beamed and pulled me back for another deep kiss.

We were making out for a while, just getting our heads around the thrill of being with someone else, someone who had always been just a friend,

off-limits.

Jessie sat up and peeled off her top to reveal her pale blue lacy bra. 'D'you ever think about what would have happened if you'd met me first, before Juliette?' she asked.

I chuckled at her hypothetical. 'I don't know,' I shrugged, my hands sprawling over her lace-covered breasts. 'I suppose if you and Juliette are so similar...'

'We might have ended up married instead,' she said, working to loosen and open my belt.

'Possibly,' I said with a little shrug as she lay back on the bed offering me a come-hither stare. 'Do you think we'd be happily married?'

'I think so,' she smirked, then moaned as I kissed my way down her soft neck, then down between her breasts.

'And Juliette would be married to Brian?' I asked.

Jessie giggled. 'Much as I'd like to think he would end up with the girl he had such a crush on in high school... I don't think it could have happened. Would have happened. I don't know.'

We laughed at not quite knowing how to phrase discussion of a hypothetical scenario that could only have happened in an alternate universe.

'You met Brian at the reunion,' Jessie said. 'And you guys got talking. If you weren't married to Juliette, you wouldn't have gone to that reunion, and you wouldn't have ever met Brian.'

I slipped her breasts out of their lacy confinement. Her nipples were seriously hard and begging for my mouth. She moaned as I sucked on each one, swirling my tongue around them.

I said, 'Maybe if Juliette was single when she went to that reunion, she might have run into Brian and... I don't know... sparks could have flown...'

Jessie smiled. 'But Cory was there. If Juliette had gone there as a single woman, she would have just met up with him and taken him back to her motel there.'

I knelt up and pulled off my shirt, and Jessie sat up to remove her bra. After so many years of her being my wife's BFF, it was extraordinary to see her getting naked right in front of me.

'Maybe Juliette would have some other guy with her when she went to the reunion.'

'And would he have chatted with Brian? And then would he go back with Juliette and Cory and watch them fuck in the motel?'

Jessie was sitting up, reaching for me as I pulled off my jeans, groping my cock through my boxer shorts.

'But then how would Juliette end up with Brian?' I asked, laughing because we couldn't find a way to bring our hypothetical scenario full circle so that Brian would be dating Juliette while I was married to Jessie.

'I don't know...' she said, pulling me in for some more tongue-on-tongue action while she grasped my hard cock through my underwear. 'Maybe... Fate... would find a way...'

Off came her skirt. Underneath, she was wearing matching pale blue lace panties and black stockings that reached just above her knees.

I lay her back down on the bed and kissed her hard, enjoying her excitement and the way her body responded to me.

'If we were married,' I said, kissing my way down her breasts, sucking on her nipples on my way down, 'would we even have discovered the whole cuckolding thing?'

'I don't know...' Jessie moaned as my kisses progressed down her stomach, and I eased down between her thighs. 'I wouldn't ever have said I was the type to just settle down with one guy forever...'

She lifted her knees, and I kissed along her hot inner thighs, breathing in the gentle spice of her arousal as I went.

'So you're saying you would have cheated on me?' I laughed.

She smiled and bit her lip as I kissed along the edge of her panties, gazing at her beautifully hairless pussy through the sheer lace of her underwear.

'I would have tried not to,' she said with a naughty grin.

I rubbed my face along the damp groove of her pussy through her panties, enjoying her intimate scent. 'So I guess that means I would have a cheating wife...'

She giggled as I grabbed hold of her panties and pulled them up her raised thighs, then down past her shins and feet. 'You would have loved it,' she said with a mischievous smirk. 'You would have come home early from work one day and discovered me banging some guy in our bed... and you would've just stood there watching him fuck me...'

I nuzzled into her snatch, and she groaned at the contact between my hot mouth and her bare pussy.

'I probably would have,' I grinned, noticing her respond merely to the vibrations of my voice on her sensitive folds.

She gasped when I sucked on her pussy lips and grabbed hold of the sheets as though concerned that gravity might fail at any moment.

'Oh God...'

She made little squeals of delight as I slipped my tongue inside her, which was cute but something Juliette never did.

Whispering, 'Yes...' and trembling as I nudged her clit with my nose.

When I gazed up at her while sucking on her pussy, she gave me this sexy smirk — a sort of flirty acknowledgment that what we were doing was completely wicked, given that I was her best friend's husband, and she was my best friend's sweetheart.

When I slid a couple of fingers inside her as well, that was enough to push her over the edge, her whole body shivering and quivering with an orgasm that seemed like I'd just plugged her into the mains.

I slid up beside her just to watch her consumed by her climax. It was kind of interesting to watch another woman after I'd gotten so used to Juliette. Jessie screwed up her eyes as the force of her orgasm tore through her, as though braced for impact.

When things died down, she opened her eyes to find me lying with her, gawping. She grinned at my obvious fascination.

'Do you think they're still in the taxi?' she asked me.

'They must have arrived by now, surely.'

'What do you think they're doing right now?'

I pondered a moment. Then I said, 'They probably didn't get more than a few feet inside the front door. Juliette's on her knees with Brian's dick stuffed down her throat.'

Jessie giggled. 'Show me what they're doing,' she said.

We got off the bed, and she knelt on the floor, pulling down my boxer shorts before grabbing hold of my hard dick with one hand.

'Like this?' she said, smiling brightly before guiding my dick to her mouth.

'Uh-huh... feels good...' I groaned as I felt her hot mouth engulf the end of my cock.

She really went to town on my cock. Could she get more of it down her throat than Juliette? Possibly. She was so smiley, taking my cock out of her mouth, stroking my shaft with her cheeks, lashing it with her tongue, somehow getting contact with her entire face as though reveling in the wickedness of toying with a new dick.

I could imagine Juliette doing the same right now, on the other side of the East River. Enjoying the gift of a new dick.

Was Brian enjoying fucking the face that had haunted his dreams all through high school? I liked to think he was.

'What do you think he's thinking about right now?' Jessie asked me.

I leaned down to kiss her mouth, urging her up off the floor now. 'Right now, he's probably thinking about you,' I said. 'Hoping you're getting well fucked.'

'He's so thoughtful like that,' she giggled. 'We better not disappoint him.'

She turned away from me and climbed onto the bed again, kneeling on the mattress to present her gorgeous ass.

I could imagine Juliette doing the same with Brian. My sweet wife presenting her fine derriere, asking my friend to fuck her.

I stood by the bed, leaned in, directed my hardness to Jessie's pussy — and then penetrated her. I sank into her easily; she was soaking wet. Tighter than Juliette, having not been entertaining a man the size of Cory recently.

'Oh yes...' Jessie breathed.

I put my weight down on one knee and drove my full length into her, filling her completely.

I watched my shaft disappear into her heart-shaped rear and pictured the same thing happening to Juliette. Man, why should people think wrong of her because she'd been seeing another guy? It was beautiful, allowing your partner to experience the thrill of dating other people.

People thought she'd done wrong to me; that was the main thing, wasn't it?

Whatever they thought about us as a couple for wanting to bring other people into our marriage was none of their business. But the main thing was, they needed to know that Juliette had not cheated on me, that she hadn't betrayed me.

'We need to tell people that Juliette hasn't been cheating on me,' I said, lying over Jessie now so that she lay flat on the bed on her front. I was

straddling the back of her thighs now, still penetrating her from behind.

It felt so good, but now I could nuzzle into her soft neck, kiss her just below the ear as I slowly drove my full hardness into her again and again.

'We need people to know she hasn't been cheating on me,' I told Jessie.

'Mmm-hmm,' Jessie agreed.

'It doesn't matter if they think I'm a cuckold... or an idiot... or whatever...'

We switched, Jessie urging me down onto my back so she could climb on top, ride me.

'We don't have to use labels,' she said. 'Especially not ones that bring so much baggage.'

She sat up on me, magnificent with her hands pressed against my chest, breasts so full, nipples erect. I pictured Juliette doing the same thing right now with another man. My gorgeous wife — not doing anything wrong, simply expressing her beautiful sexuality with the full support of her loving husband.

'No, we don't need to use labels,' I said.

Jessie smiled. 'We just say 'what's the big deal?' She had a little fun with her ex, and you didn't have a problem with it. So.'

I cupped her breasts with both hands as she began to bounce on my cock.

I wondered what our friends would say when they learned I had allowed my wife to sleep with her old flame. That I didn't have a problem with her seeing other guys when she wanted.

Perhaps they would be disgusted with us both. Perhaps they would ask how we could possibly want such a thing after we'd been so committed to each other for so long.

Perhaps there would be a chance to explain. Perhaps not.

It had to be better than uncontrolled rumors.

We'd lose our friends — or we wouldn't. Maybe we'd lost them already, anyway.

I came deep inside my wife's best friend and contemplated how to fall on my sword.

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The Man Before Me: Live-in Lover (Ch.20)

by *Max Sebastian*



I worked on the Facebook problem for a while. It was, you might say, an undertaking.

I really didn't know what I was doing — I was no expert in dispelling misinformation. At first, when I went onto the site, it had been a while since I'd looked around there, and I was a little shocked at how much people had been talking about Juliette and me.

I got the sense that because we hadn't commented on anyone's claims, people fell into the belief that we no longer used Facebook — that it was safe to just openly gossip about us.

It was overwhelming at first. It was easy to feel dispirited and believe nothing could be done about all this except some scorched earth policy of finding entirely new friendships. But I took a deep breath and tried to take a strategic approach — targeting key individuals.

I prioritized both people we knew fairly well and also those who were leading a lot of the gossip-mongering.

I started by focusing on actual lies that had been said, denying things outright if they were untrue. I didn't want to lie to anybody myself since that would undermine anything I was attempting. But at the same time, I did not use the word 'cuckold' or even 'hotwife.' I just gave people a sense that I did not consider Juliette to be in any way under my control — and that, as her husband, I celebrated everything about her, including her sexuality.

I guess you could say I left the impression that Juliette was free to see other people if she so wanted, and that it wasn't a huge deal in our marriage — but I didn't seek to impose labels on it.

There were some comments back from people, of course, seeking to clarify what I was saying by suggesting particular terms — none of them suggested 'cuckolding' or 'hotwifing', but they did ask if we had an open relationship now, or if we had decided on a 'don't ask, don't tell' policy toward marital infidelity.

Anyway. I feel like I definitely poured cold water on any talk that Juliette had cheated on me at any point, or that we were having problems in our marriage.

It seemed like it ended up being a lot of work. I sat at our kitchen table with my laptop, tapping away for a few nights. Several times, Juliette told me I didn't need to do it — but I couldn't say I agreed with her that the problem would just disappear after a while without anyone saying anything to argue our side.

Mostly, though, I think things went our way. The most difficult part was with people who knew and liked Cory well and could not bring themselves to believe that he would want to misinform people about Juliette. I had to tiptoe around that by saying he didn't really understand her, he didn't really understand what we were about as a married couple.

After a while, I started feeling like I'd reached the summit of my task, and it was downhill from there.

Some of our circle of friends ended up apologizing for having thought ill of us, but many of them just quietly stopped spreading those rumors, and that was enough for me to feel it was dealt with.

Then, a few days later, Juliette told me we'd been invited to a dinner party the following week. In fact, suddenly, people were talking to us again. Suggesting we go out for drinks and so on.

We had dinner with Juliette's old college friends Claire and Rob, along with Katherine and Doug, and it was almost as though nothing had changed. There was an atmosphere that was a little akin to how it might have been if Juliette and I had been out of the country for a few months, rather than merely being socially excluded.

We even had a night out with some of Juliette's ex-high school friends — Becky, Jon and Sarah, Zoe and Pete. We were even able to bring Brian into the fold, which, thanks to Jessie's presence, brought Juliette's two circles of friends — those from her high school days and those from her college days — more into union.

I think in that initial period of social reintroduction, the whole stuff about Cory and the false accusations of marital infidelity were simply not talked about. I guessed that I'd said what had needed saying on Facebook.

But at the same time, Juliette and I were able to use our body language to present evidence that our marriage was not in any kind of trouble. We behaved like a new couple, newly in love. Besotted, unable to be too far from each other at any time, constantly holding hands or smiling at each other or giving each other little subtle touches to show how much we loved each other.

And sure, it was a little performative — particularly given how long we'd been married, how confident we were in our relationship anyway. But it was kind of nice. I felt like maybe I'd needed reminding to be that way with her.

Things — I thought — were getting back to relative normality for Juliette and me.

But then an odd kind of over-correction started appearing while we were out with our new-old friends.

It was hard to notice at first. When we were involved in conversations about other people that were having affairs, or when the topic of discussion got anywhere near anything to do with cheating or infidelity, things would suddenly peter out, subjects would be changed, or distractions offered.

It was often quite subtle and quite random how it would come up. I even wondered if I imagined it or if I was being overly sensitive to it.

And it wasn't always just that certain conversations were now awkward. Sometimes, it went the other way — we would be talking about a movie, or maybe a new government policy or something, and our friends would suddenly be very interested to hear our point of view on it. Because they thought we had a different point of view.

We were different to them now.

Oh, they weren't unfriendly to us — they treated us as though they wanted to include us in the group and also hear us, and all the other nice, cozy liberal attitudes toward those who were not in the majority group. But now they thought of us as part of a minority group, somehow.

There were two main thrusts to this new treatment as I saw it: a desire by our friends to avoid offending us, and a need to seem to embrace us by singling us out for interest in our particular perspective, whatever it might be.

I talked to Juliette about it, and she agreed with me.

'They do, don't they? They think we're... I don't know... special, somehow. They want to know what I think. I mean more than they used to.'

'It's not a hostile thing... but it does make you feel somehow... not quite the same as things used to be.'

'We don't fit in with the rest of the group in quite the same way,' Juliette nodded.

'Somehow, we have a different identity than we used to — in their eyes.'

Juliette laughed. 'We were talking about the Pride March... I don't remember why it came up... but then Katherine told me that for some reason, she thought I wouldn't want to miss it this year...'

'She thinks we're part of the whole LGBT+ spectrum?'

We stared at each other, and it kind of clicked what had been going on. Our friends were generally very liberal — that was just how it was in our circles. And when it came out that Juliette had apparently been cheating on her husband, they reacted with moral outrage at her betrayal. But in trying to explain that everything had been misinterpreted and confused — that Juliette had never betrayed anybody, and that as her husband I supported her in everything she did — we had established a belief in our friends' liberal minds that this was an identity thing.

It was simply who we were: that Juliette had dated Cory for a while, and that it wasn't an issue that had caused any grief in our marriage.

'So what do they think we are?' Juliette asked me.

I gave her a blank face.

The answer came from Jessie and Brian, who had been able to get the scoop because people would leave conversations unguarded while they were present, unlike when Juliette or I were with them.

When we asked them, Jessie was smiling as though she'd been just about to tell us that she'd noticed this weird thing, and here we were just asking her about it.

'They think you're polyamorous,' she said to Juliette. 'Well, they think you both might be, but that Juliette definitely is.'

'Polyamorous?' Juliette furrowed her brow.

We were in the Irish pub where I used to hang out with Brian before he'd really gotten into dating Jessie. Dark and cozy, and good for intimate conversations.

'I've been noticing it,' Jessie explained. 'But you know, at first, it was so subtle it was difficult to really put your finger on it. Then Katherine said that weird thing about Pride... and I guess I started figuring it out.'

'So you talked to them about it?' Juliette asked her.

'Well... yeah, I mean, I tried to be careful. You don't want to offend them. They do mean well.'

Brian said, 'They're just trying to be careful in case they offend you.'

'But polyamorous...' Juliette said.

I said, 'You can see why they might think of that. There is some overlap.'

Juliette asked Jessie, 'And you didn't try to... dissuade them about this polyamorous thing?'

'No — I was heading out the door when they told me. I didn't get the chance.'

We all sat there a moment, looking at one another, not entirely knowing what to say. I felt a little strange knowing that our friends somehow considered us to be polyamorous — or, Juliette at least. And that, in their minds, it was a kind of sexual identity along the same lines as bisexuality or something like that.

Jessie said, 'Well, at least they don't hate you for it.'

'Thank goodness,' Juliette said with a wry grin.

'They're very supportive,' Brian pointed out. 'Even behind your back. They just think you've somehow come out of the closet.'

'Great, I always wondered how they'd act if I ever decided to come out of the closet.'

I took a big swig of drink. 'But what does it mean?' I said. 'I mean... does it even matter that they think we somehow have a different sexuality than them?'

Juliette said, 'It's none of their business.'

I said, 'No, it's not. But if they believed you were poly... I could see how it explains the whole Cory thing in their eyes. And if they don't see that as shameful, that it's just part of your identity, and as generally liberal people, that's something to celebrate, not feel bad about...'

Juliette said, 'I'm not poly. I mean... I don't want to fall in love with anyone else.'

Brian said, 'I don't think polyamorous has to mean you fall in love...'

Jessie said, 'I, but I think people would believe you're open to it.'

I said, 'Okay, I'm not sure what the whole difference is. But if our friends just happened to believe we had a slight difference of opinion with the mainstream regarding monogamy, would it matter exactly what our precise definition was?'

Juliette shrugged, 'We wouldn't have to talk about it with them...'

I said, 'But if you happened to want to chat about... you know... some new guy you were seeing... it wouldn't completely shock them.'

I could see the idea worming its way into my wife's acceptance. Her face seemed to slowly brighten as she realized the ramifications of the approach.

Jessie said, simply, 'It's always easier not having to hide things from people. Not having to lie about where you are or who you're with.'

Brian said, 'The definition's close enough that they'd never tell the difference. They won't suddenly confront you about why Nick's not dating someone else, too. You know, call him a *cuckold*.'

Jessie said, 'He's not really a cuckold anyway. He doesn't go in for the whole humiliation thing.'

I chuckled at that — it seemed to me that Jessie had been reading around about the subject. 'It's fine,' I said. 'I can just say I'm not really polyamorous, but Juliette is. That for a while we just ignored it... but now we've come to accept it. You know. She can express who she is... I don't need to feel insecure or jealous about it.'

They all kind of nodded. It made some kind of sense.

I said, 'For some reason, 'polyamorous' doesn't have the same negative connotations as 'cuckolding' in our particular social circles. So what's the harm in adopting it as a label?'

There was a moment of silence.

Then Brian said, 'Maybe they'll just forget about it after a while. You know... once it's no longer all shiny and new.'

At first, we just tried to ignore the issue for a while. I caught little glances from friends sometimes — you know, those little moments when they look at you for a moment or two too long after you've noticed. You can tell they've been staring. But I figured they were just trying to get their head around this new thing they knew about Juliette and me. The fact that we'd apparently kept it hidden all these years.

We didn't seek to dispel the polyamorous label if ever it came up, but for a while, it didn't seem to come up — at least not publicly, not to our faces. We didn't go onto Facebook to deny any rumors about polyamory.

But it didn't really come up. Not for a while, at least.

In the meantime, Juliette and I had some fun nights out with Brian and Jessie — and some fun nights in, as it happened — and the two blondes even started exploring the possibility of using Tinder or some other dating app to begin looking for possible dates. Jessie had much more experience there, since Juliette had never really used dating apps or websites.

They found it quite fun flicking through profiles, deciding which guys they'd date and which ones they wouldn't — even though the prospect of dating a complete stranger was still a little intimidating for Juliette.

Juliette and I got to talking about how it would be for her to actually date someone else — and it seemed like one load off her mind that she wouldn't necessarily have to keep it all secret from our friends.

I even found that I quite liked the idea of my wife openly dating someone else. Somehow, it tickled that dark cuckold part of me deep

inside. It's difficult to fully understand why it would appeal to me, but the thought of her bringing a date out to socialize with friends... or even just to talk openly about some new guy she was seeing... somehow would emphasize my sharing. It would provide a kind of confirmation that was just sexy as far as someone with my kink was concerned.

Then, a few months after the whole polyamorous revelation came out among our friends, something rather unexpected happened.

Juliette and I were invited to another dinner party by some of our friends, Katherine and Doug, along with Austin and his wife Amber, and Ryan and his girlfriend Melissa. Katherine, Doug, Austin, and Ryan were all part of Juliette's circle of college buddies. But when we arrived at Katherine and Doug's loft over in Queens, there was also another couple present — Ethan and Brooke — who we did not know.

Katherine introduced the new couple almost the moment we arrived — no doubt making sure nobody would be strangers around the dinner table that evening. However, in laying out who Ethan and Brooke were — Ethan was one of Doug's co-workers — one of the first things Katherine happened to mention was that they were polyamorous.

The word just kind of froze there, right in mid-air between them all, as soon as Katherine had uttered it.

I think neither Juliette nor I — or Ethan or Brooke — could quite believe that Katherine had said that as the central part of her introduction. But there it was, right there, out in front.

'Hi,' Brooke smiled, shaking my hand just before Ethan did, and it was all very friendly and so on. We all blushed slightly that Katherine had felt the need to hang our laundry out in public like that. But, hey. I guess she felt we all had something in common.

And then, at dinner, it was all there on the table for us to chew over.

'So Ethan, you and Brooke are also dating other people at the moment, right?'

'Well, Brooke has a couple of other boyfriends, yes. I was seeing someone, but her company decided to relocate her to San Francisco...'

I guess it was kind of interesting, meeting some real poly people. They didn't seem too bothered that the monogamists around the table wanted to grill them about their lifestyle; they were happy enough to talk about it.

Ethan was a handsome guy, and seemed very chilled about the fact that his attractive girlfriend was in relationships with two other men at the same time. In a way, he made me feel almost civilized about my dark desire to share my wife.

I suppose it was nice for Katherine and Doug to try to make Juliette and me feel so included within the group by demonstrating that they had other friends in other forms of romantic attachment as well.

And when it came time for me to discuss my particular position within the monogamy-polyamory spectrum, it was probably helpful for me to lay it all out there — that I wasn't really poly in the same way that Juliette was. That I was mainly happy being married to my wife, and supporting her in whatever kind of romantic exploration she felt she needed.

I used the term 'romantic' where complete honesty probably should have made it 'sexual,' but this was a civilized dinner party here.

Anyway. It was nice.

But it was only a couple hours into a relatively relaxed and leisurely dinner and a number of glasses of very agreeable wine down the road to inebriation before I realized — and I think Juliette realized, too — that something was going on.

It appeared that our dear friends, Katherine and Doug, were trying to set Juliette up with the rather handsome Ethan.

(Stay tuned for details)

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